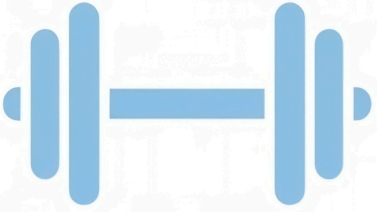
# ACHIEVE GREATNESS

## FITNESS



# BOOK 2

# Achieve Greatness
# (Book 2: Fitness)

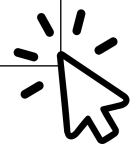
# Table of Contents

**Book 2:**


- **Chapter 1: Everything I Learned As A PT About Fitness**
- **The Power Pyramid**
- **Warm Ups**
- **Cool Downs**
- **The AG4 System**
- **Cardio Workouts**
- **Advanced Training Systems**
- **Old School Bodybuilding Secrets**
- **Modern Bodybuilding Secrets**




This is an interactive table of contents.
Click on a chapter to be taken there.



# Chapter 1: Everything I Learned As A PT About Fitness

## How To Pick A Good Gym

The point of bodybuilding training is to develop your body in a **balanced** and **proportionate** way.

It takes a certain amount of different kinds of equipment to do that, no matter who you are.

You may not need a gym with dumbbells going up into the extremely high weight zones, or every single machine, but there should be an **adequate** amount of equipment for you to progress.

It will simply be better for your progress if you put yourself in an environment with a lot of **variety** and **access** to equipment.

You can get by with just your bodyweight and the outdoors, but having a good gym environment with equipment can fast track your progress.

I also recommend that you find a **clean** gym, with a **wifi** signal, that is open **24 hours** if possible.

This way you can go for later sessions when it is not busy. Crowded gyms mean less focus, and waiting for machines.

When an environment is clean, modern, and peaceful, you will actually enjoy going to the gym. I know a lot of gyms are considered "rich people" gyms, but sometimes it is worth making the **investment**, as you will enjoy going to a gym that is upmarket and modern.

Finally, I try to find gyms that have **punch bags**, so I can practice my marital arts, as that is my preferred form of cardio and is a part of the **AG training system**.

Finally, the **closer** it is to your **accommodation** the better. Let it be close to your house, or part of your route back from work.

It is not 100% necessary, but when you find a well equipped gym, that is

nearby in distance, that does not get busy, you will make **extreme** gains and have a lot of fun.

I would spend **twice** my money, to sign up for a gym that met the above requirements, over a gym that was **further** away, busier, and less equipped.

If you are a beginner, I do not recommend martial arts gyms, or dirty **hardcore** bodybuilding gyms, or gyms that are less equipped or super busy.

Get a clean, high-end, less busy, **modern** and friendly gym, so you get the full gym experience, where you feel safe and comfortable.

The working wifi is **important**, so you can watch your videos to keep you entertained whilst doing cardio and browse your internet courses for form videos and other tips.

For those **anxious** about starting the gym, don't be! First things first — gyms are safe. In 15 years I have never seen a fight or anything serious happen in one. Nobody acts up in a gym because they will **lose** their membership and everyone is a lot more friendly than you would think.

It is a place of self improvement. It will only feel **hard** to go two or three times at most — maybe a little more if you have had a long break.

The first two or three days, everything will feel a little harder and the exercises slightly more uncomfortable. After that, the feeling **disappears** completely.

After one or two sessions of figuring out and learning where everything is, it just becomes your gym.

The place you go. Simple as that. Once you spend enough time there it will even feel like **home**.

To start, go to Google Maps, search "gym," and join one close to you. Proximity is everything.

The closest gym to you is the best gym for you — because the easier it is to get there, the more likely you are to

actually go. Do not overthink the **membership** options.

This is where people get **overwhelmed**. Buy a month. Do not join a specialist MMA gym or an underground bodybuilding gym to start with.

Just join a normal, branded gym with regular people. Once you sign up they will send you a PIN code by email with all the instructions.

It is straightforward.

When you get to the gym, you press the code into a keypad and the doors open. You don't even need to speak **English**, or speak to anyone, it's so easy nowadays.

The monthly fee — usually around £30 — is worth every penny. To own the equipment yourself would cost you thousands. Once you realise the value of what you have access to, you will never question it again.

Try and get a gym that is:

- Modern, Clean & The Type Of Place You Would Spend Time
- Not Overcrowded
- 24 Hour For More Access
- Near Your House For More Access
- Well Equipped Gym Equipment
- Well Equipped Cardio Equipment
- Friendly Regular People

If you need to spend more to get this, I wholeheartedly think it is worth it.

No one goes to the gym that is far away, no one likes going to a whole other gym just for a punch bag because they do boxing and their home gym doesn't have one.

No one likes going to an environment that feels dirty, people prefer upmarket environments that make them feel they are living a good life, especially consider this when you know you will be spending a significant portion of your week in this environment.

## Facing Gym Anxiety

If you are worried about being judged in the gym, here is the truth: nobody is looking at you. Not in the way you think.

Someone might **glance** in your direction for about one second and then look away. That is it.

The thought of people pointing and laughing at the overweight person or the new person — it does not happen. It is **not** going to happen to you.

People **respect** each other and follow the rules as gyms are a place to **improve** oneself.

Even if someone does **physically** look your way, they are not **psychologically** looking at you and thinking **negative** thoughts in the way you think.

Whatever is in their head, it is probably neutral or even **positive** — "new person, good for them," "nice

shoes," “I respect that person for coming to the gym,” nothing more.

Meanwhile they are plugged into their music, dreading their next super set on the leg press, completely in their **own** world.

That could be a reason they are not smiling lots and that has nothing to do with how they feel about you! They met eyes with you for half a second. That is genuinely all it was.

Get rid of the thoughts of people **judging** you for being overweight, or old, or skinny.

A thought process that everyone has when they first go to the gym is that everyone is looking at them and

thinking some kind of **negative** thoughts.

The truth is everyone is looking at each other in the gym, and we can all get **paranoid** that someone is thinking bad things about us.

But in reality, everyone in this environment is looking at each other with **positivity**. They are thinking "wow I really respect that person for coming to the gym."

Everyone looks at each other with a basic level of respect for simply being in there.

We all think there is more to it than there really is or think of the negative options and not the positive options.

Some of the scariest looking, giant men with tattoos in the gym are actually the nicest people, and **secretly** hoping you don't judge them or think negatively about them.

The truth is everyone has the mindset they are getting judged, until they realize that in the gym, everyone **respects** each other, every person who steps in the gym trying to improve themselves gets respect when they show up and walk through the doors.

Don't make the mistake of thinking everyone is watching you in a negative way, when they are likely watching you with a **positive respect** for being a part of the gym.

People might be thinking some really **amazing** and positive things about you, so don't be put off!

**People are so much more friendlier than you think.**

Your perception is everything. Perceive the situation in a **positive** light and not a negative light!

In your first session, just look around. Check out the machines, see what they have, get comfortable with the layout of the gym. Then start your workout.

Any exercise you do not know, YouTube it. Watch some videos. Learn the equipment.

It is that simple. Give it two or three sessions and then you will be completely settled.

This is an amazing & beautiful journey you are on.

Go through the **initial pain** of spending the money on your gym membership, don't worry about the monthly sign up fee.

Just get yourself signed up, **ignore** the pain of making that purchase, because building your dream physique is going to be one of the biggest returns on your investment you will ever make.

## What Is An Aesthetic Body?

An **aesthetic** body simply just means a good looking body.

This is a topic best covered in my YouTube video, search Achieve Greatness on YouTube - Aesthetic Body Lecture.

This will allow you to actually **visually** see and compare the body types.

For a good looking body it is in my opinion best to do a **bodybuilding** style workout. Don't get distracted doing **powerlifting**, and beware of focusing too much on other sports if your goal is to get a great looking body.

Sports such as basketball, fighting or marathon running, are great as a side sport, but beware they contain a lot of cardio and are not conductive to muscle growth if you are doing them 5 days a week.

It's ideal to find a **balance** between sports and bodybuilding to find a healthy body.

## The Aesthetic Body

The sports you choose and the type of workouts you do are going to lead to a slightly **different** looking body.

For example, I do not particularly think the body of a **marathon** runner is most healthy. They can be extremely skinny. I also think training like a **powerlifter** is not the best option for aesthetics.

Powerlifters may be able to lift a lot of weight, but most of them build bodies with quite a **high** body-fat percentage so they can lift more.

Repetitions of **1 - 6** are not as conductive to putting on muscle, and it's the powerlifters we often see with a lot of injuries, eating in huge surplusses.

If your goal is just to get an aesthetic and healthy body, so that your mind is sharp and you can perform at most sports, then it is good to focus on

**bodybuilding** techniques in healthy ranges of body fat.

Most of the really ripped people you see on YouTube who do sports too and seem to do great at whatever they do, usually got a really good conditioned body through **bodybuilding** first and then transitioned to their chosen sport.

The aim of these programs are to bulletproof your body and make it strong and **muscular** first, because after that, you will do well at anything and nearly all sports.

The sports you pick can **really** make a difference.

Women for instance, when taking up a sport such as **gymnastics** tend to get a great body composition considered as aesthetic.

Sports such as **trampolining** can leave an athlete very **bottom heavy** and often not in the glutes but in the thighs, which may not look as aesthetically pleasing when over built.

# Aesthetic Sports To Try

These are some sports to try every once in a while for **aesthetic** looking muscles, these are high calorie burn sports that produce great results:

Boxing
Volleyball
Swimming Front Crawl 50m Races
Gymnastics
Sprinting 100m
Trampolining
Basketball
Cycling (Racing)
Decathlon
Rock Climbing For Forearms

Check out my video: **Aesthetic Body Case Study** on the Achieve Greatness YouTube which takes a look at the bodies of Olympic champions from each sport.

You will see how good the bodies look of champions from different sports and this can help you see how **not all sports are created equal** when it comes to the target of looking good!

## Training Splits

There are different **training splits** to train a person on. This refers to how you split up your days of training in

the gym. In the AG4 Programme, we offer three main training splits:

- Full Body
- PPL (Push Pull Legs)
- 3 Lower 2 Upper

**1 day full body -** at this stage if a person wants to train once a week, the least they can do is work their **full body** with the 5 main compound lifts.

But perhaps more importantly, they should just do the session they enjoy so they come to the gym **more often**. If a person is at the stage of coming once a week, as a coach I would be **experimenting** with finding out workouts they like, and **challenging** them to question within themselves

why they cannot commit to 3 days a week.

***Realistically, a person will not gain much off one day a week,*** and even if a person was injured I would still prescribe them 3 days a week as they could work **stability** and light movements.

Ultimately, a person should be finding it within themselves through these single weekly sessions to build up a **love** and **commitment** for health and fitness, and then eventually commit to a minimum of 3 sessions a week to achieve the full benefits.

**2 day full body** - This is good for people who work a lot physically, or are beginners to the gym who feel like they need a lower frequency of

training. Ideally, you would push them towards enjoying working out and motivate them towards 3 sessions a week.

**3 day full body** -This is good for those that want to build a solid base of training. In the first year or two of training, a full body programme is very valid and can build a great base of mass.

Eventually, you will realise there are certain smaller muscles that you are not hitting **completely**, as full body sessions focus on compound lifts and large muscle groups.

In 3 full body sessions a week, there are slight gaps in development because it takes a long time to work full body, even just the main

compound lifts, so some smaller muscles tend to get **forgotten** about or only worked once a week in these programmes.

If a person wants to take the bodybuilding style of training seriously, they will often switch to a different split down the line.

However, full body 3 days a week is an effective and widely used form of training for athletes and those that practice other sports and still wish to **build** in the gym 3 times a week.

### Push Pull Legs

This is a great **bodybuilding** programme I use mainly for males. I use PPLPPLR in my AG programmes.

This means Push, Pull, Legs, Push, Pull Legs Rest. That has you in the gym 6 days a week.

You can also do PPLRPPLR which gives you 5 days in the gym a week and 2 rest days.

You will be working all major muscle groups 3 times a week with this method, the days are **focused** and **specific** so you can hit some isolation exercises that you likely wouldn't have time for if doing 3 days a week full body.

All in all this is a **great** programme.

**3 Lower 2 Upper -** This is a very effective programme for women. For

aesthetics, a women tends to need more days working the **lower body.** This is the split I often programme for women.

**5 day full body -** A five-day full-body split can work for advanced bodybuilding athletes whose physique is a requirement of their profession.

Some may split their work into a morning and evening session, while others complete it all at once.

You can build an **exceptional** physique training this way, as muscles are stimulated frequently and no area is left neglected across the week.

However, this style of training is only doable for those who can recover from it.

That usually means pacing yourself, limiting lower-body work to one main lift per session, and adjusting the number of sets based on how your body is responding.

This approach suits athletes who treat bodybuilding as a **sport** rather than a casual pursuit, and who are willing to listen to their body, **manage fatigue**, and regulate effort rather than push every exercise to its limit.

Hitting every machine in sight across your **whole body** all day is often met with recovery concerns, but advanced lifters who pace themselves in higher rep ranges and who understand the

limitations of their body can run these programmes.

**Bro split** - Bro split is when someone has a “chest day” then an “arm day” then a “shoulders day” and a “leg day.”

My issue with doing things this way is that too much time goes in between training the same muscle groups.

You may only hit a muscle **once** per week using this method. That simply isn’t enough to grow it meaningfully.

PPL style programmes, upper lower programmes and full body are the way forward over this style of training, at least for a **naturally** built body.

# Programming

**Macrocycle -** The total length of your programme.

**Mesocycle -** Usually 2-6 week blocks of your programme picking a particular aim. In the AG programme we are not fond of **shorter** mesocycles, many other programmes will change every 4 weeks.

I am not a fan of this, because I feel like the change is too early. Just as an athlete is making progress and getting the benefits and **momentum** of the programme they are being switched over.

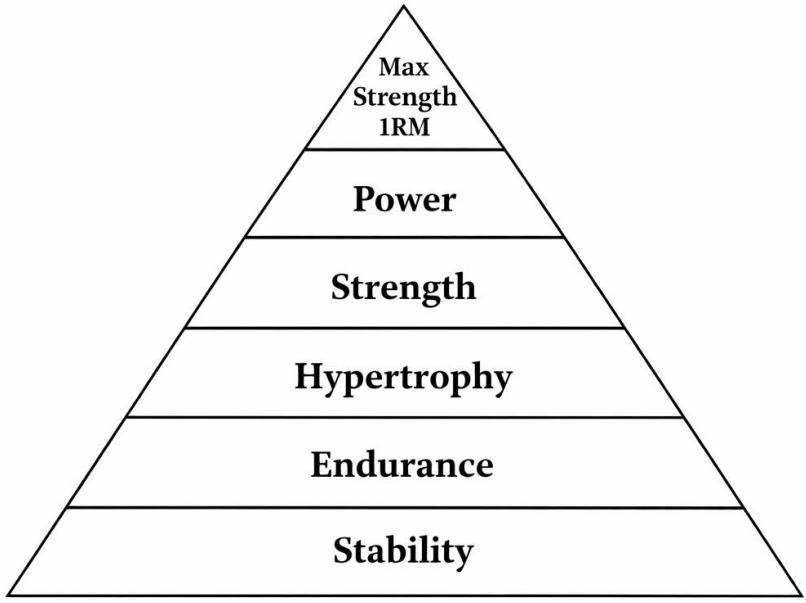
We suggest you run our AG programmes as they are for as long as

you can, using the supplied advanced training techniques for variety. The AG programmes are designed to be ran **indefinitely**.

There are times where you may wish to change up your programming, introducing different lifts such as barbells instead of dumbbells for bench presses, changing your compound lifts, or maybe switching from full body to PPL.

Try not to make changes like this in short (under 8 week) mesocycles. Don't be that person **forever changing programmes**, stick with your programme for a longer period of time to see consistent gains.

# The Power Pyramid




Take a look at the ***Power Pyramid.***

| Exercise | Reps/Load | Rest | Speed | Sets |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1RM | 100% of 1RM | 1 rep | Very low velocity | 1 set |
| Power | 1–3 reps / 75–90% 1RM | 3–5 min rest | High velocity | 4–5 sets |
| Strength | 3–5 reps / 85–90% 1RM | 2–4 min rest | Low velocity | 3–5 sets |
| Explosive Power | 6–15 reps / 30% 1RM | 1 min rest | Very high velocity | 2–5 sets |
| Hypertrophy | 8–12 reps / 70–85% 1RM | 1 min rest | Medium velocity | 3–4 sets |
| Endurance | 12–15 reps / 50–75% 1RM | 1 min rest | Moderate velocity | 2–3 sets |
| Stability | 20 reps / under 50% 1RM | 30 second rest | Moderate velocity | 2 sets |
| Speed | 5 reps / 0% resistance | Max Rest | Max Velocity | 5 sets |

Don’t worry if this information is confusing at first. Take a look below.

**1rm** - First we have 1RM Maximum Strength. This is 100% of our 1RM. Our 1 rep maximum. This is the **most** we can lift in **1 repetition.** We only test this every once in a while, because it takes so much strength to do so and a **long time** to recover from.

**Power** - Power is 1 - 3 reps with a very **heavy** weight. We do this with long rest times, 4-5 sets, and we don’t use quite as much weight as our 1 rep max, because we want to achieve our reps with ***high velocity.*** Basically we explode the reps quickly. But we still go really heavy, this is an Olympic powerlifting style of training.

**Strength** - Strength is again with very **heavy** weights. We lift the weights more slowly. For the last set in our strength workout, we aim to be failing on the last rep of a set of 3-5.

**Explosive Power** - Another form of training Power. This is slightly different to the power training method referenced above. The aim is to use a **moderate** weight and perform a lift **explosively**. It is not like the olympic power lifting with really heavy weights for 1 - 3 repetitions, but based more around plyometric and functional movements, against 30% of your 1 rep max resistance.

Athletes use exercises like Jump Squats with Dumbbells, Landmine Punches or Resistance Banded Punches, as well as slamming

weighted fitness balls as hard as they can against the floor, for 6 - 15 repetitions.

Those all fall under the category of explosive power. These exercises are designed to make you a more **explosive** athlete, and use a **lighter** weight than Olympic based powerlifting.

**Hypertrophy -** This is the "bodybuilding" range that I keep my clients in most often in order for them to achieve **aesthetic** bodies. Most bodybuilding programs stay in this range most often and differentiate every once in a while for variety, but here is where the most mass is built. 8 - 12 reps with a **moderate** weight. We can take each set to failure or close to failure.

**Endurance -** Science shows you can still grow in this range. It's less **effective** in most cases, but more a range that can be explored for variety, especially on **isolation** lifts. It works well for calisthenics as well and athletes that need to use muscles for longer periods of time.

**Stability -** This is the range to resolve injuries, warm up joints, build flexibility and start off elderly persons or pure beginners. You can perform reps of 20.

**Speed -** This is done in 5 reps at a time, with **no resistance** whatsoever. Performing repetitions at maximum speed. As fast as you can go. For example, **sprinting**, punch combos as **fast** as you can, and fast jump squats.

This improves the speed you can perform an exercise.

For aesthetics only, you can get by with just doing ***hypertrophy.*** Some endurance, and some strength used sparingly will help break through any **sticking points** by adding **variety**.

Power and speed are more for athletes, and stability is more for beginners, warming up, rehabilitating those with injuries or elderly people with **barriers** to exercise.

However, there is something about a body that trains in the hypertrophy range, that also trains power and speed to become **powerful** and **fast**, that in my opinion seems to take the edge when it comes to aesthetics.

It's as if people can just tell your body is great for so many **different** things, that you are functional and are able to perform well in all areas of sports. This results in a body that simply **looks** great. A small percentage of Power and Speed workouts are added to the programme.

If you are an athlete, Power and Speed are non-negotiable. I have now explained the different training repetition ranges. Now, can you **imagine** how each of these are **useful** in the sense of being an athlete?

***Power,*** for instance, in sports such as shot put where you have one shot to produce as much power as you can?

***Strength*** - Imagine taking 5 seconds to grind a really heavy weight to the top.

If you are **wrestling** and you have another muscular human being on top of you that you are wrestling with, imagine you are both pushing hard against each other for 5 seconds trying to get them off you, those 5 second pushes of heavy weights you did in strength training will pay off.

What about ***explosive power***, being able to jump really far or high for a long jump or high jump, or being able to grab someone and knee them in kickboxing (medicine ball slams work that same action)

Or throwing really fast punches or sprinting as fast as you can? (***speed*** works that)

Then ***hypertrophy*** for example, which grows your muscle mass so that you can take more punishment, absorb blows, lift heavy objects and generally just have the muscle **required** for sports to begin with.

***Endurance*** lets you maintain and lift things for **longer periods of time,** imagine if you ran out of leg endurance in your cycling race or your shoulders got **tired** from swinging a tennis racket.

***Stability*** allows you to **bulletproof** your body to avoid injury, and build **flexibility** to help you in sports.

Can you see how one could want all of these and how someone with a balance of all of these will probably have a functional, balanced body that looks **great** and performs well in a variety of sports?

## How To Test Your 1 Rep Max

You can test your **1 repetition max** using the compound power movements only, such as squat, deadlift, bench press, and shoulder press.

Testing a 1RM should be used for those that are considered **intermediate** or **advanced**. Not those in the first few months of lifting, or

elderly people. You can instead take your 10RM for more safety in this situation.

Start with a **light** warm up weight and do 10 reps.

1 min rest.

Do 3 - 5 repetitions of a weight that is **slightly challenging** but leaves you with at least 5 more repetitions left to give.

Take 2 minutes of rest.

Do 2 - 3 repetitions of a weight that is **challenging** but leaves you with 2 or 3 more to give.

Take 4 minutes of rest.

Add 5kg (upper body) or 10kg (lower body) to the total weight, and start to test the 1 rep maxes.

If successful, keep adding either 2.5kg(upper body) or 5kg(lower body) until you fail.

The 1RM is the **highest possible** weight you can get to.

If you **fail** the first 1RM test, **drop** the weight by 2.5kg(upper body) or 5kg(lower body) and try again.

Repeat that process of dropping the weight until you find your max.

If you fail a test, but then succeed at a lower weight, and want to come up in weight again and try one last time, you can.

But, only allow a total of **5 testing sets**, we call it quits after this point for safety.

## How To Test Your 10 Rep Max

Start with a **light** warm up weight and do 10 reps.

Take a 1 minute rest.

Do **10 reps** of a weight that is slightly challenging but allows you to finish 10 reps with at least 8 more repetitions left to give.

Take 2 minutes of rest.

Pick a weight that you could finish 10 reps of but have 3-5 reps left to give after.

Take 4 minutes of rest.

Add 2.5kg or 5kg (upper body) or 5kg - 10kg (lower body) to the total load based on how you performed your last set.

Test your 10 rep max, if you complete the set add 2.5kg - 5kg based on performance and keep testing until you fail.

Record the highest weight you could do 10 reps with.

Don’t do more than 5 testing sets.

If you **fail** the first testing set, take away 2.5kg to 5kg and try **again**.

You might have a **bad** first set, but if you lower the weight you may get 10 reps still. This will likely be your 10RM.

You can up the weight again if you succeed in increments of 2.5 - 5kg if you want to keep trying, but after 5 testing sets you have to call it quits for **safety**!

Stick to the same **process** and **rest times** each time you test for a 10RM. Why is this? Well, giving someone a 10 minute rest time on one test and a 4 minute on the next test in a month's time is **no good**. It will lead to **inconsistent** results.

If you want to conduct the test in a professional way, this is the way to do it. It gives you enough time to warm up and allows you to be **safe**, whilst not **burning out** with endless warm up sets that are too heavy.

Your 10 rep maximums can be good to know as there are tables online where you can **estimate** your 1 rep maxes from your 10 rep maximums.

It is a safer method of testing for the **elderly** and those that are **injury prone** to know their 1 rep max so they can take percentages of it and apply it for lifts in their programmes.

# RPE Scale

If you ever hear someone refer to the RPE scale, don't get confused. It is simply a scale that refers to **how hard** you feel an exercise is pushing you out of ten.

So if you take an exercise to RPE7, you are feeling you are working at 7/10 **intensity**.

You can use the RPE scale for **cardio** or for **weight training**, don't **overcomplicate** it, it is simply like a person asking you: "how much do you **feel** this exercise out of 10 right now?"

For example, when doing cardio on the treadmill machine:

**RPE 1** - I'm sitting on my sofa eating bon bons.

**RPE 2** - I'm comfortable and I can maintain this pace all day long.

**RPE 3** - I am still comfortable but I am breathing a bit harder.

**RPE 4** - I feel slightly warmer but I can still maintain this pace for hours.

**RPE 5** - I am just above comfortable. I can talk easily. I may start to sweat.

**RPE 6** - I can still talk but I am slightly breathless, and slightly sweating.

**RPE 7** - I can still talk but I don't really want to, I am more focused on the exercise and beginning to feel the

effects of sweating and being out of breath.

**RPE 8** - I can grunt in response to questions and can only keep this pace for a short time period.

**RPE 9** - I cannot sustain this pace for much longer than 20 seconds.

**RPE 10** - In 10 more seconds, I will be completely unable to continue.

If you apply the RPE scale to bodybuilding, it pretty much is the same, but just with how heavy you are finding the weight.

**RPE10** would be total muscular failure where you simply cannot lift the weight anymore.

**RPE 7- 9** would be when you have a few more repetitions left short of failure.

If you ever come across the term RPE, this is what it means! Just think of it as how hard you are working out of 10!

## How to Know You're Ready for a Weight Increase

One of the most **common** mistakes in the gym is going up in weight too soon.
When you jump up in weight before you are ready, you end up **struggling** with a weight that is too heavy, your form breaks down, and progress actually slows rather than speeds up.

Because the **AG programme** focuses predominantly on the 8–12 rep range, the rule is simple: build up to 3 sets of 10, or a 12, 10, 8 progression at minimum, before moving to the next weight.

Once you can hit 12 clean reps with a given weight, you can more than likely hit 8 solid reps on the weight above.

If you are using **Reverse Pyramid Training** (where you start your first set heavier than the sets after) then a good safety zone is 13 reps in your heaviest weight before you increase your heaviest weight.

Once you have  reached 13 repetitions on an exercise, you have genuinely mastered that weight — and the

chances of struggling on the next step up are greatly reduced.

A **strong, stable 8** reps at the new weight is worth far more than a **shaky, grinding 6**. Always pick the easy 8 over the difficult 6. If that means being more patient, then it is worth it!

If you move up too early on an exercise like the **shoulder press**, it will humble you back down very fast week after week and create a frustrating cycle.

Because once you are stuck at 6 repetitions, it can take a while grinding to turn it into a 7 while training outside the **hypertrophy** zone, which is the **focus** of the programme.

## What Happens When You Go Up In Weight Too Soon

If you **do** move up in weight before you are ready and find yourself hitting only 5 or 6 reps on your first set, here is how to work through it:

Your **goal** becomes adding **1** repetition to your first set each session. Your second and third sets will use a slightly lower weight in the meantime.

You may find yourself in a **slow grind** — gaining one extra rep per week, until your first set finally reaches 6, then 7, then 8.

At 8 it starts to feel more **controlled,** and from there progress feels quicker again.

If you are really **struggling** with adding repetitions to your first set, what you can do is try and add repetitions to your second and third sets instead of your first sets.

Your second and third sets are using a **lower** weight so they are easier to add repetitions onto. For example:

**Day 1:**

Set 1: 5
Set 2: 5
Set 3: 5

**Day 2:**

Set 1: 5
Set 2: 5
Set 3: 6

**Day 3**:

Set 1: 5
Set 2: 6
Set 3: 6

**Day 4:**

Set 1: 6
Set 2: 6
Set 3: 6

The problem with staying in those **lower rep ranges** for too long is that you drift into strength territory — 5s and 6s — where a completely

different type of training, technique, and approach is needed to progress.

It seems to take **longer** to turn 5 reps into 6 than it is to turn 8 into 12. On a **diet cut** or **maintenance** period, I have also found reps in the lower ranges to drop quite fast, whereas repetitions in the 8 - 12 range seem to **sustain** themselves reasonably well.

Everyone's body is **different**, I find I hit a brick wall and that I have to use a lot more brute force if I go up **too soon**, whereas if I am patient and wait until I have a higher rep count on a weight, I find this **works better** for me for quick progression.

In fact, I rarely run into **plateaus** anymore, because I am still working

the strength range on my power days. I have one heavy day a week to work heavier anyway.

This is where I work in the rep ranges of 5 3 and 1 to build my **strength**. Then when I go to my **muscle building day,** I find my strength in the 8-12 repetition range climbs up very fast.

This is why I don't wish to go up too fast in weight on my hypertrophy days, or my programme will become too **biased** towards strength training in lower rep ranges of 5 and 6.

On your **power days**, you can play the slow grind game of slowly adding 1 rep to your strength workout using

low repetitions, but it's best to **focus predominantly on the goals of the programme** and **base the majority of your programme around the 8 - 12 rep range.**

**20–30% strength work**

**70–80% hypertrophy work**

That's the money range.

# How do I Avoid Injuries?

## A Warm Up

The first thing to know is this programme is designed to give you an **effective** warm up for each day so that you stay safe from injury.

I was once that guy who **never** did warm ups! I wanted to just go straight into the gym, and get it all done in half an hour.

When I pictured a warm up, I felt I would have to learn a **bunch of stretches** and felt like it would take a **long time.**

It mentally felt like a lot to add it to my workout when I already had to learn a ton of new exercises.

But then I realised just how **simple** it could be. It takes less than 3 minutes and it **bulletproofs** you.

Young people, when they are **beginning** at the gym, want to spend their hour in the gym getting the **most** muscle possible.

They think that if they spend 20 minutes doing lighter lifts and stretching it **isn't** going to get them muscle.

It is true, a lot of the stretches don't really get you muscles, and that's why people feel like they are a waste of time.

But sooner or later without fail you will get **injured** in periods that you train with no warm ups.

Young people that don't stretch will get **overconfident** because they have done 2 years of lifting without stretching and they haven't got injured yet.

I was one of those young people, I never used to stretch and the funny thing is I would **never** get injured somehow, and all my friends who did stretch **all** got injured.

Until one day as I got **older** it started to change.

**It is definitely a good idea to warm up!**

In fitness we often see the **cool bits** on YouTube, the people we follow that we look up to smashing the heavy weights together and getting really strong.

We don't often see all the **extra** work they do as professionals with professional coaches to look after their body and **protect** them from injury.

The average gym goer just goes in and lifts some weights, a study showed that only 50% of gym goers actually stretch for a warm up.

- **Younger lifters** rely on natural tissue elasticity and recoverability

- **Beginners** don't yet feel the downside of skipping warm-ups
- **Older or advanced lifters** warm up more consistently because they've learned the cost of not doing so.

It's not until a few years in where you feel your shoulders start to **hurt** that you start to consider what you are doing wrong.

As your shoulders start to hurt, it actually means you can lift **less** on your shoulders.

This is where young people realise warming up is **important**, not even because they feel the pain, but

because the pain finally stops their lifts from improving.

They get **frustrated** because they stop seeing the weight increase each week, and deep down they realise the **quickest** way of improving is not having the pain get in the way of their lifts.

For the sake of 2 minutes it is best to **protect** your body, learn warm ups and build good habits within yourself!

Even if you are like me and are one of the lucky people who never got any serious injuries, not warming up will **eventually catch up** to you with slow increasing pains that just hold you back from achieving your best.

This message is for **two groups** of people.

If you are one of those people who **just started** at the gym, then don't pick up bad habits. Build 2 minutes of proven PT qualified stretching into your routine!

If you are one of those people who has been garage style lifting, going heavy and hard for 2 years with no guidance, no stretching, then it's time to make a change.

You picked up this programme because you wanted to start taking gym **seriously** right? It's time to take it seriously, move in a **professional** manner, and do things the right way.

When warming up on upper body days, we mainly want to strengthen the **rotator cuff** muscle.

This area is one of the most ***commonly*** injured. And it will stop you lifting your best on your chest and shoulders lifts which are some of the best looking muscles on your body to build.

If the stretching area of fitness confused you before, don't worry. You **don't** have to stress. This section will bring you to a **professional** level.

I'll give you the routines: you can do ***ankle and hip mobility on leg days***, and ***shoulder mobility on push and pull days.***

# AG Push Day Warm Up (2 Minute Stretching Workout)

Band Dislocations - Works Your Rotator Cuff Muscles
Band Pull Aparts - Works Your Rotator Cuff Muscles
Band External Rotations
Band Internal Rotations
Arm Circles
Band Face Pulls Or Y Raises

Do ***2 sets of 20*** of each exercise. Note: You should not be completely dying or even struggling to finish these 20 reps, we are working *stability* and not a heavy lift.

At the **minimum**, do the band dislocations, the band pull aparts, and the arm circles.

**Band Dislocations -**

Pass the band behind your head and pass it slowly around your back, trying not to touch your back. You should pass the band to around chest height behind you, and pull it apart gently.

Do the movement slowly over the course of 5 seconds. Then bring it back. This works your stabiliser muscles and increases your shoulder mobility.

## Band Pull Aparts

Pull a resistance band apart. You can do it with dumbbells too, but due to the gravity and resistance a resistance band provides, it is better to use bands. Do one set overhand and one set underhand.

They work your external rotator cuff which is great for bulletproofing your shoulders.

## Band Face Pulls

Overall a great exercise to strengthen your shoulder mobility and health. Attach the band to a pole type surface in your gym at head height or just above head height. Or just use the rope attachment on a cable machine.

## 2kg Dumbell Y Raises

These are again a great exercise to strengthen your shoulder mobility and health. You can use a band for these too if you find a place to attach it.

## Band Internal Rotations

Hook up a resistance band to a pole type surface, basically you wrap the band around the vertical metal post of a cable machine or something similar in the gym.

Do this by wrapping the band around it, then feeding one end through the other and pulling tight so it tightens. It will create a loop and tighten for you. Use a set of resistance bands so

that you can pick one with a light weight.

Then perform the exercise grabbing the cable with one hand and moving that hand inwards towards your belly with your palms facing each other.

### Band External Rotations

Same setup as the Internal Rotations. But you want to pull your hands away from your sides so they face outwards. These two exercises are best learned on the YouTube channel so you can visually see them. Search for the video “AG Push Day Warm Up”

### Arm Circles

Just hold your arms out like a scarecrow, and then move them in circles. 15 seconds forwards and 15 seconds backwards.

## AG Pull Day Warm Up (2 Minute Stretching Workout)

### Band Dislocations

Pass the band behind your head and pass it slowly around your back, trying not to touch your back. You should pass the band to around chest

height behind you, and pull it apart gently.

Do the movement slowly over the course of 5 seconds. Then bring it back. This works your stabiliser muscles and increases your shoulder mobility.

**Band Pull Aparts**

Pull a resistance band apart. You can do it with dumbbells too, but due to the gravity and resistance a resistance band provides, it is better to use bands. Do one set overhand and one set underhand.

They work your external rotator cuff which is great for bulletproofing your shoulders.

### Arm Circles

Do 30 seconds of arm circles, 15 seconds clockwise and 15 seconds anti clockwise.

## AG Leg Day Warm Up (2 Minute Stretching Workout)

### Bodyweight Squats into Toe Taps

Stand with your feet shoulder-width apart and hold both hands out in front of you at chest height.

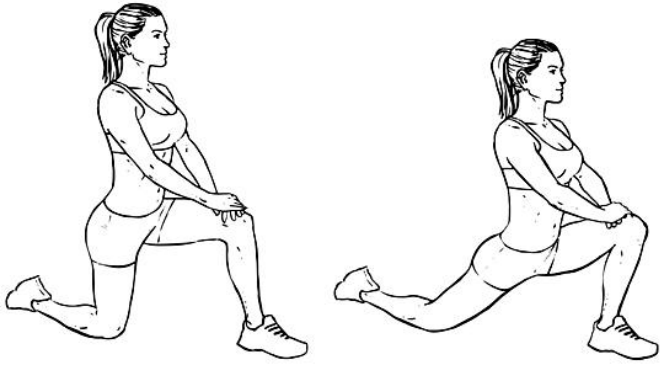
1. Lower yourself into a squat as you normally would, keeping your chest up and your weight in your heels.
2. As you drive back up to standing, lift one leg and tap your foot to the **opposite hand** — right foot to left hand, left foot to right hand.
3. Return to your starting position and go straight into the next squat, alternating the tapping leg each rep.

The cross-body tap is the key detail here. You're not tapping the same-side hand — you're reaching across, which adds a rotational challenge to your core with every rep.

For a video example of this exercise search the YouTube channel and type Squats To Toe Taps.

## Hip Flexor Stretch

1. Kneel on one knee — right knee down, left foot forward, like a proposal position.
2. Keep your torso upright and core lightly braced.



3. Shift your weight forward, pushing your hips gently forward and down until you feel a deep stretch through the front of the kneeling-side hip.
4. Hold for 30–60 seconds, breathing deeply. Switch sides and repeat.

**Worlds Greatest Stretch**

For a video example of this exercise, search on the Achieve Greatness Youtube channel for Worlds Greatest Stretch.

# AG Full Body Warm Up

### Band Dislocations

*Explained in above section.*

### Band Pull Aparts

*Explained in above section.*

### Arm Circles

*Explained in above section.*

### Squats into Standing Leg Raises

*Explained in above section.*

### Hip Flexor Stretch

*Explained in above section.*

# More tips to not get injured

Here are some more tips for not getting injured:

### Dumbbell Shoulder Press:

***Don't bring the dumbbells too far behind you***, keep them in front of you. (I saw someone's arms go behind them and make a very crazy click sound that had them out the gym for weeks)

### Lateral Pulldown:

Keep ***looking slightly down*** on the lateral pulldown back machine, never yank your neck back fast along with the bar as so many tend to do!

People lean far back as they pull to get more strength and with leaning back so fast they shoot their neck back fast too. Keep your chin positioned down to avoid this.)

## Bench Press

Always get someone ***to spot you on bench press*** (extremely dangerous otherwise, it's not worth the weight coming down on you alone with no help and being involved in a tragic accident)

## Sports

Do ***ankle mobility*** exercises before playing sports - the one I see a lot is when someone sprains their ankle when they land on it funny.

You can do ankle mobility on leg days.

## Boxing

Don't punch a heavy boxing bag your hardest without first working up on the lighter bags.

A heavy bag will feel extremely firm and not move easily when you push it. You need to build up to hitting these with power.

This protects you from ***wrist injury.***

## Overuse Injuries

If you feel your biceps and elbows starting to ache, this is usually an overuse injury, such as ***tennis or golfers elbow.***

Usually you need to stop doing such heavy aggressive bicep curls, and heavy explosive back pull ups.

It's usually when you do so many back sessions where you are pulling too much, and too explosively. In this situation, in a bodybuilding context, the answer is simple:

You don't need to be explosive all the time or lifting extremely heavy to make your muscle gains, dial things back just a little, perform your lifts with lighter weights and with ***slower repetitions*** for the burn, and you will still make gains.

If you get serious persisting pain on any of these injuries, you may have to rehabilitate. It is wise to drop down to

the ***stability*** rep range of 20 repetitions.

## Avoiding Imbalances To Avoid Injury

To avoid injury, we want to avoid imbalances too, and therefore you should understand ***a few rules.***

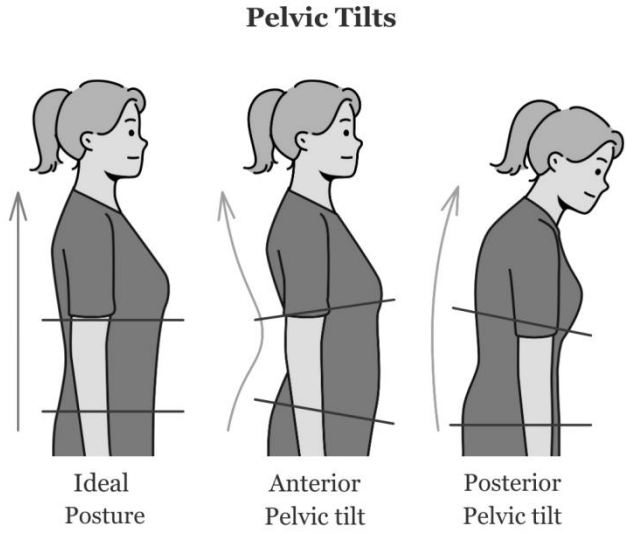
1. You need to work as much on your back days as you do on your chest and shoulders days.

2. You want to do ***back extensions*** and build the back of your core as much as your front of your core, which you build with ***leg raises*** and also ***ab crunches.***

3. As a man, you do want to **build** the glutes (many men avoid the glutes as they don't want to get a "Kim Kardashian bum") but you definitely want to be doing some kind of **Glute** exercises and doing Romanian Deadlifts or your body will get pulled backwards into **lordosis** (anterior pelvic tilt.)

Women, on the other hand tend to do so many Glutes and RDL exercises that they have a **strong** lower back.

But the common issue with women lies in the fact their **front** Abs are often neglected and this tips their hips forwards giving a certain look called **hyperkyphosis** (posterior pelvic tilt).



You need to train the front of your Abs as a woman to prevent this.

Overall, for posture, we should be doing exercises like vertical and horizontal **pushing**, vertical and horizontal **pulling**, a variety of leg machines, and working muscles like glutes, **front** and **back** core, traps, rear delts and neck, as well as rotator cuff **strengthening**.

It seems like a lot but, if you set your gym programme up like the AG4 system, it isn't hard to include it all.

I didn't just want to give you the programmes, but I wanted to *show you the why.*

Because I know that anything you don't see as beneficial, you will **cut**

from the programme in order to **simplify** it.

You need to know **why** you are doing things to stick to them.

As you can see from the images above, posture actually helps us to look better.

When you see a man training Glutes, it is not usually to get a feminine behind, but it is that he understands how bad **incorrect posture** looks.

It is why I do my Back Extensions and Glute exercises from time to time, and often the only men you will see doing these exercises in the gym are **qualified** PT's. What do you know, they always have **great** posture.

They know the **importance** and the *science*.

We love **simple** in the AG Training system, and we can easily apply the above in a simple way.

Even on your quick gym days where you are doing only half hour workouts, you can still do a **5 minute** block of core quickly.

Our programmes approach it **simply**, with Front Abs exercises on Push Day, Back Extensions on Back Day. This works both areas of the core.

If you completed that abs block and did even **5 minutes** on those exercises each session, you would balance your body out nicely.

# How To Deal With Injuries

As personal trainers, we are taught to use the RICE method once we identify the injury.

**R**est
**I**ce
**C**ompression
**E**levation

Most injuries are **minor** sprains, strains, and bruises.

Anything **worse** we would refer to a specialist. In the case of most minor injuries you can follow the RICE method.

According to the NHS, if someone is suffering from a sprain or strain of

any kind, you should stop exercise immediately, and follow these recommended guidelines:

**How to treat sprains and strains yourself:**

For the first couple of days, follow the 4 steps known as RICE therapy to help bring down the swelling and **support** the injury:

**Rest** - stop any exercise or activities and try not to put any **weight** on the injury.

**Ice** - apply an ice pack or bag of frozen vegetables wrapped in a tea towel to the injury for up to **20 minutes** every 2 to 3 hours.

**Compression** - wrap a **bandage** around the injury to support it.

**Elevate** - keep it **raised** on a pillow as much as possible.

## Common Injuries

Here are some other common injuries and how to deal with them.

### Knee Pain

Avoid **bouncing** at the bottom of Squats. Do your Squats controlled and paused.

You can also do your Squats on the Smith Machine with your legs positioned more **forward** to isolate your quads and protect your knees for a few months .

If you still have pain, use Leg Extensions to rehabilitate as well as High Repetition, Low Weight Squats.

**Pain In Upper Back Of Leg**

**Rehabilitate** with Straight Leg Deadlifts and Hamstring Stretches.

**Calves**

Warm up before going **heavy** on calves. **Stretch** between sets with Calve stretches.

## Groin Injury

Heal this by avoiding Lunges and giving it lots of rest.

## Back Injuries

Go very light and approach with care on Deadlifts, Straight Leg Sit Ups and Straight Leg Raises.

## Shoulders

Train your shoulders **lightly** until healed. Do Lateral Raises, but hold them out for Isometric Holds with lighter weights instead of doing powerful reps.

If normal shoulder presses hurt, try and do **palms facing** shoulder presses.

## Chest

Never **drop** the weight towards your chest too quickly on the Bench Press or Dumbell Flys.

You can explode **up** on this lift, but not down, try not to drop the weight fast, or bounce it off your chest.

## Biceps / Forearms

Reduce the **total amount** that you lift on pull day. No heavy deadlifts or explosive Pull Ups!

Do everything **slow** and **controlled**, with lighter sets of 12 and try to feel the burn instead of lifting heavy powerlifting sets.

Go easy on **cheat repping** Bicep Curls, go easy on **yanking** down the Lateral Pulldown with **force**, and go easy on **force repping** Lateral raises.

**Don't** focus on power, just focus on 8 - 12 reps of slow bodybuilding for a few weeks.

Avoid Reverse Curls and **replace** them for Reverse Wrist Curls instead. Try Hammer Curls **instead** of Barbell Curls, or use an EZ Bar.

Whichever exercise gives you **less pain** can be used to cling on to strength and keep building if necessary.

Try and do higher reps of **lighter** weights. Overdoing an injury in this area can lead to really painful elbows.

## Triceps

Rest and avoid behind the head extensions until you feel better. Start back up **slowly** with that exercise and use high reps.

The Tricep Extensions can cause an injury in the **elbow**. If presses and extensions give you trouble, you may be able to still **build strength** with Dumbell Kickbacks.

**Elbow**

Avoid **heavy** lifts for a bit and make use of Rest Ice Compression Elevation. (RICE therapy)

## How To Rehabilitate An Injury

What we get taught to do in personal training is to start off working the injury through the stability range of movement.

We don't sit around for months **magically** expecting an injury to heal on its own accord, as that wastes time.

We find the **balance** between getting back into action with enough speed so

that we are not sitting there idly, whilst also not pushing too hard.

To **rehabilitate**, we start with 2 sets of 20 reps which is working our injured muscle area through the **stability** range.

The 20 reps should not be to **failure,** just light weights. We use the 3 / 10 pain rule. Once you can do 2 sets of 20 with **under 3 / 10 pain**, you can move on to working your muscles through the endurance range.

This will be 3 Sets of 15 reps. Again wait until you can do the sets with **no more than 3 / 10 pain**, and then you can move to the hypertrophy range of 8 - 12 reps.

Do things **progressively**. Don't go straight back to strength training heavy weights, or **explosive** movements. You can still work and grow your muscles through **slow repetitions** and **time under tension** rather than heavy weights at this stage.

On average, when rehabilitating an injury, we should attempt to spend **2 weeks in** the stability and endurance stages, and 2- 6 weeks in the hypertrophy range before we get back to strength training (in the case of athletes that lift heavy.)

These numbers are **rough guidelines** to aim for, and have been put here to help you understand a period of

recovery should not be spent with zero progress, but also not rushed.

If you have been on the stability stage for 4 weeks for example, and unable to move on without pain, it is time to **evaluate your options with a doctor** and a range of professionals.

## What If I Get Injured?

If you feel really bad pain, it's time to reduce your intensity. You can go back to the ***stability (20 reps)*** rep range.

Ideally spend **2 weeks** in this area, doing 2 sets of 20 repetitions. But don't progress if you are feeling more

than 2 out of 10 on the pain scale when completing these 2 sets.

Once you are doing 2 sets of 20 with light weights and less than 2 out of 10 pain, you can slowly progress to the endurance (15 reps) range.

For around 2 weeks, do reps of 15. 3 sets can work for you here. Once you only feel around 2 out of 10 pain, you can move up.

Then move back to 3 sets of 12. Only once you can do this range pain free would I recommend moving into any kind of strength or power based training.

It is frustrating for athletes and even regular gym goers, but the more you

rush, the more you can get injured again.

Don't sit at home doing nothing! But accept an injury and don't try to lift through extreme pain either.

You can rehabilitate for a while. To feel like you are still **making progress**, it's a good time to learn more mobility exercises, skills, work on your abs more, and work on light technique for sports.

Don't feel like you have to give up the gym. For example if you have a shoulder injury, then learn more about s**houlder mobility** whilst rehabbing your shoulder.

This will actually help you in the long run to lift more and strengthen the

smaller muscles that you need to improve.

Maybe, it's time to **focus on your legs** for 2 weeks or so and hit records in this area **if your upper body is injured. Or** work on your boxing combos, or your shot at football!

There's always **something** you can work on for forward momentum in order to become great.

Here are some realistic timelines for how long it would take to rehabilitate injuries:

**Mild overuse:** 6–8 weeks total
**Moderate:** 8–12 weeks
**Chronic or recurring:** 3–6 months

# Cool Downs

Another way to avoid injury is a **cooldown.** It lets your body return slowly down to baseline from exercise.

After a workout is the perfect time to perform **static stretches** as a cooldown, which will increase your flexibility over time.

When we increase **flexibility** over time, we are less likely to get injured.

The people I see most **likely** to get injured in the gym are new lifters, who have poor **flexibility**, who want to gain fast and lift **heavy** and intensely with **poor form**!

**Cool downs** are sometimes missed due to reasons such as a workout dragging on for too long.

However, if we can, it is beneficial to spend **5 minutes** cooling down and improving our flexibility.

We should perform our stretches that stretch the **same muscles** we worked in our sessions.

**AG Push Day Cool Down**

Static Stretches Relating To Muscles Worked:

Deltoid Static Stretch
Triceps Static Stretch
Chest Static Stretch

## AG Pull Day Cool Down

Static Stretches Relating To Muscles Worked:

Hang From Bar Until Failure x 2
Biceps Stretch
Trapezius Stretch
Lats Stretch

## AG Leg Day Cool Down

Static Stretches Relating To Muscles Worked:

Lying Hamstring Stretch
Lying Quadriceps Stretch
Adductor Stretch
Glutes Stretch

Seated Toe Touch

**AG Full Body Cool Down**

Trapezius Stretch
Deltoid Stretch
Lats Stretch
Wall Chest Stretch
Biceps Stretch
Triceps Stretch
Hip Flexor Stretch
Lying Hamstring Stretch
Lying Quads Stretch
Glutes Stretch
Adductor Stretch

*(This cool down takes a little longer, around 5 minutes at 30 seconds a stretch, as you have worked your full body and have more to stretch!)*

For your free, detailed PDF of all the above stretches, visit:

achievegreatness.gumroad.com

Access the file: “Static Stretches.”

# The AG4 Programme

## How The AG4 Programme Works

This programme is built for one purpose — to make you both aesthetic and a genuine functional athlete at the same time.

Most programmes make you **choose** between the two. This one does not. Every day has a **goal,** every session has a reason, and everything works together so that by the end of a good week you are more **powerful, faster, better conditioned, and looking better** for it.

By the **end of this programme** you will be:

- **Powerful**
- **Aesthetic**
- **Fast**

- **Conditioned** across every range of cardio — making you a great all-round sportsman with excellent health
- **Capable** across a wide range of sports and physical challenges

## What a Full Week Looks Like At The Advanced Level

### For Men:

On a good week, the AG programme for men is structured like this:

- 1 hypertrophy push day or speed push day

- 1 heavy push day
- 2 pull days
- 2 legs and mini shoulder days
- Optional: a calisthenics full body or Arnold-style full body in place of a push or pull day

**What you are training each week:**

- Shoulders — 3 times
- Chest — 2 to 3 times
- Back — 2 times
- Triceps — 2 times
- Biceps — 2 times
- Legs — 2 times
- Cardio — daily
- Abs — daily

## AG4 Timetables Mens

Here are the timetables for the **men's AG4** workouts.

# Beginner AG4 Program — 3 Days Per Week (Male)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Beginner Push Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Beginner Pull Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Beginner Leg Day*** | REST | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | REST | AG Pull Day Warm Up | REST | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | REST |
| ***ABS*** | AG 6 Minute Abs Workout | REST | Back Extensions 3 x 12 | REST | AG 6 Minute Abs Workout | REST | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | REST |

***(Learn this programme for your first 2 months. We will be building on it soon! Build your cardio up to 30 minutes. Beat your records everytime you use the gym. For the 6 minute Abs workout, you may only be able to complete the first 2 minutes, that is OK!)***

# Intermediate AG4 Program — 4 Days Per Week (Male)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Leg + Shoulders Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Full Body Day*** | REST | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | REST |
| ***ABS*** | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | REST | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | REST |

***(Build up your love for the gym with this programme, Once you feel ready for 5 days a week, you may move on. Begin to select some Abs workouts from the Abs Library and do 5 minute blocks of Abs every session. Start to learn the Advanced Training Techniques in the exercise library and apply 1 - 3 of them per session. The Full Body Day can be replaced with the AG Outdoor Calisthenics sessions when you want to change things up.)***

***At this stage you are still building up a liking of the gym, and ocassionally after a long day of work, it is ok to carry out the AG Half Hour workouts if you feel tired. Go based on how you feel!***

# Intermediate AG4 Program — 4 Days Per Week Male (No Legs)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| SESSION | AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy | AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy | AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy | AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy | REST | REST | REST |
| WARM UP | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | REST | REST | REST |
| ABS | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | REST | REST | REST |
| CARDIO | Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | REST | REST |

* At the intermediate level, apply 2–3 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

***This is an optional programme for males that wish to build their upper body extremely quickly. Whilst it is not reccommended to skip legs, if you are going to do so and want to focus on your upper body, this is a viable programme to follow.***

# Intermediate AG4 Program — 5 Days Per Week (Male)

| WEEK 1 | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
| SESSION | AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy | AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy | AG4 Leg + Shoulder Day | REST | AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy | AG4 Pull Day 1 - Hypertrophy | REST |
| WARM UP | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | REST |
| ABS | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | REST |
| CARDIO | Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST |

***Congratulations! You have now built up to 5 times a week. After 6 months or so, when you feel ready to progress, move on to the next programme!***

# Advanced AG4 Program — 5 Days Per Week (Male)

| *WEEK 1* | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | ***MON*** | ***TUE*** | ***WED*** | ***THU*** | ***FRI*** | ***SAT*** | ***SUN*** |
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Leg + Shoulder Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Push Day 2 — Power*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power*** | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | 1,000 Steps Stair Climber | AG Pull Day Warm Up | REST |
| ***ABS*** | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | AG Power Cardio | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST |

| *WEEK 2 — then repeat from Week 1* | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | ***MON*** | ***TUE*** | ***WED*** | ***THU*** | ***FRI*** | ***SAT*** | ***SUN*** |
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Push Day 3 — Speed*** | ***AG Pull Day 3 — Biceps Focus*** | ***AG4 Leg + Shoulder Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Push Day 2 — Power*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power*** | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | 1,000 Steps Stair Climber | AG Pull Day Warm Up | REST |
| ***ABS*** | Decline Sit Ups 2×fail \| Ab Roller 3×fail \| Speed Sit Ups 4×fail | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | AG Speed Cardio — sprints / speed movements | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | AG Power Cardio | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST |

* At the advanced level, apply 3–5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

***Don't be intimidated by the programme card! It is essentially the same as the previous stage of the AG programme. The only changes are:***

***Now we operate on a 2 week system, where you implement athletic Power days, as well as athletic Speed days into your programme.***

***You will do an athletic Speed Day as well as a Biceps focused Pull Day once every second week.***

# Advanced AG4 Program — 6 Days Per Week (Male)

| *WEEK 1* | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | ***MON*** | ***TUE*** | ***WED*** | ***THU*** | ***FRI*** | ***SAT*** | ***SUN*** |
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Push Day 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Push Day 2 — Power*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power*** | ***AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day*** |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | 1,000 Steps Stair Climber | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up |
| ***ABS*** | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library |
| ***CARDIO*** | Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | AG Power Cardio | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming |

| *WEEK 2 — then repeat from Week 1* | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | ***MON*** | ***TUE*** | ***WED*** | ***THU*** | ***FRI*** | ***SAT*** | ***SUN*** |
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Push Day 3 — Speed*** | ***AG Pull Day 3 — Biceps Focus*** | ***AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day*** | REST | ***AG4 Push Day 2 — Power*** | ***AG4 Pull Day 2 — Power*** | ***AG4 Legs + Shoulders Day*** |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up | REST | 1,000 Steps Stair Climber | AG Pull Day Warm Up | AG Leg Day Warm Up |
| ***ABS*** | Decline Sit Ups 2×fail \| Ab Roller 3×fail \| Speed Sit Ups 4×fail | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | Back Extension — 3 × failure | Select from Abs Library |
| ***CARDIO*** | AG Speed Cardio — sprints / speed movements | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | AG Power Cardio | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming |

* At the advanced level, apply 3–5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

***This is essentially the superman programme for those that take the gym really seriously. If you are completing this, you will have an elite body in no time.***

***This is a good programme to build muscle, aesethetics and a functional body if you are off season from your sports, and want to focus on building your body.***

## Why Shoulders Appear on Leg Day

For the **AG4 men's programmes**, we put a percentage of our shoulder exercises on Leg Day.

Shoulders are the **centrepiece** of a great male physique. Most men understand this in theory, but in practice they spend far more time on chest than shoulders and wonder why their physique is **not coming together** the way they want it to.

The **aesthetic** physiques you admire train shoulders with serious volume and frequency.

To reflect that, this programme adds extra shoulder sets on leg day. This keeps your chest-to-shoulder ratio in check and ensures shoulders get the attention they deserve without compromising your push days.

## Hypertrophy Days vs Speed Days

The **hypertrophy** push day and the **speed** push day are largely the same workout.

The **difference** is that the speed day is slightly more geared towards athletes — it includes Speed Bench Press, Speed Overhead Press, and some explosive speed-based ab movements at the end.

The two days are **interchangeable**, and mixing both throughout your training week is encouraged.

## Swapping Days — Calisthenics and Full Body Options

Every once in a while, feel free to **swap** a push or pull day for a full body **calisthenics** workout. These are a great

change of pace and have real carry-over benefits to your flexibility and strength.

If you swap a **push day**, lean into your **dips, push ups, handstand practice**, and resistance banded tricep work. If you swap a **pull day**, push harder on your **muscle up practice, pull up variations,** and resistance banded bicep curls.

If you have a week where you miss one or two training sessions, consider doing a **full body** session to catch your entire body up.

This keeps you hitting every muscle group at least **twice that week.** Let's say you missed a chest day and your next scheduled session is a back day — do a full body instead.

You will hit your chest, your back, and your legs all in one session. You are back on track to hit all muscles at least a minimum of twice for the week, and you

have likely hit legs three times that week instead of two.

That is a win, not a setback.

## How the Cardio Fits In

The cardio in this programme is **matched** to the training day on purpose.

**Power-based cardio** on heavy power days, **speed-based cardio** on speed days, and outdoor cardio — sprints, running — on calisthenics days where you are already outside anyway.

There is no sense in sending you outside for a calisthenics session and then telling you to drive to a gym for a fitness ball speed slam.

There is no sense in finishing a heavy leg day and jumping straight into

maximum intensity bike sprints when your legs are already spent.

Everything here is designed to work together, not against each other.

## The AG4 Women's Programme — How It Works

This programme is built around one goal — building a **strong, athletic,** feminine physique that keeps improving month after month.

At the advanced level you will build up to running it five days a week, Monday to Friday, and every session has a clear purpose.

There are also 3 day a week options for those that have other sports and commitments, as well as lower body

only options for those that just want to work their lower body!

## What A Full Week Looks Like At An Advanced Level

### For women:

Monday — Upper Body 1 (Hypertrophy)

- Tuesday — Lower Body 1 (Hip Thrust Focus)
- Wednesday — Lower Body 2 (RDL Focus)
- Thursday — Upper Body 2 (Speed)
- Friday — Lower Body 3 (Paused Squat Focus)

### What you are training each week:

- Glutes and Hamstrings — 3 times

- Quads — 3 times
- Shoulders and Back — 2 times
- Biceps and Triceps — 2 times
- Abs — every session
- Cardio — every session

## AG4 Timetables Womens

Here are the timetables for the **women's AG4** workouts.

## Beginner AG4 Program — 3 Days Per Week (Female)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Full Body 1 — Glutes Focus*** | REST | ***AG4 Full Body 2 — Hamstrings Focus*** | REST | ***AG4 Full Body 3 — Quads Focus*** | REST | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | REST |
| ***ABS*** | AG 6 Minute Abs Workout | REST | Back Extensions 3 x 12 | REST | AG 6 Minute Abs Workout | REST | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | REST |

***(Learn this programme for your first 2 months. We will be building on it soon! Build your cardio up to 30 minutes. Beat your records everytime you use the gym. For the 6 minute Abs workout, you may only be able to complete the first 2 minutes, that is OK!)***

## Intermediate AG4 Program — 3 Days Per Week (Female)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 3 Day Full Body — Day 1*** | REST | ***AG4 3 Day Full Body — Day 2*** | REST | ***AG4 3 Day Full Body — Day 3*** | REST | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | AG Full Body Warm Up | REST | REST |
| ***ABS*** | AG 6 Minute Abs Workout | REST | Barbell Weighted Back Extension — 4 x 12 | REST | Pick From Abs Library | REST | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | REST | AG Speed Cardio OR HIIT OR LIIT | REST | REST |

* At the intermediate level, apply 2–3 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

***(Build up your love for the gym with this programme, Once you feel ready for 5 days a week, you may move on. Begin to select some Abs workouts from the Abs Library and do 5 minute blocks of Abs every session. Start to learn the Advanced Training Techniques in the exercise library and apply 1 - 3 of them per session. Any Full Body Day can be replaced with the AG Outdoor Calisthenics sessions when you want to change things up.)***

## Intermediate AG4 Program — Lower Body Only (Female)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI | SAT | SUN |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Lower Only 1*** | REST | ***AG4 Lower Only 2*** | REST | ***AG4 Lower Only 3*** | REST | REST |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Light Legs Warm Up | REST | AG Light Legs Warm Up | REST | AG Light Legs Warm Up | REST | REST |
| ***ABS*** | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | REST | Select from Abs Library | REST | REST |
| ***CARDIO*** | Zone 2 OR 6 Rounds Boxing Bag OR Swimming | REST | Zone 2 OR 6 Rounds Boxing Bag OR Swimming | REST | AG Speed Cardio OR HIIT OR LIIT | REST | REST |

* At the intermediate level, apply 2–3 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

***Some women do not want to focus on their upper body, as some feel it is already developed enough. If that applies tot you and you just want to focus on Lower Body training, this split works for you.***

## Advanced AG4 Program — 5 Days Per Week (Female)

| | MON | TUE | WED | THU | FRI |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| ***SESSION*** | ***AG4 Upper Body 1 — Hypertrophy*** | ***AG4 Lower Body 1 — Hip Thrust Focus*** | ***AG4 Lower Body 2 — RDL Focus*** | ***AG4 Upper Body 2 — Speed*** | ***AG4 Lower Body 3 — Paused Squat Focus*** |
| ***WARM UP*** | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Light Legs Warm Up | AG Light Legs Warm Up | AG Push Day Warm Up | AG Light Legs Warm Up |
| ***ABS*** | Select from Abs Library | Select from Abs Library | Select from Abs Library | AG Speed Abs | Select from Abs Library |
| ***CARDIO*** | Zone 5 — Hand Bike + Boxing OR Ski RG + Battle Ropes | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming | AG Speed Cardio — sprints / speed movements | HIIT OR Zone 2 OR Punch Bag OR Swimming |

* At the advanced level, apply 3–5 advanced training techniques from the exercise library per session.

***Congratulations, you reached 5 days a week! At this stage, you are working a 5 day a week programme, building on what you have learned with many of the same movements.***

***We build in some upper body days, as well as some targeted athletic "speed" days to help you perform well in sports.***

The cardio in the women's programme follows the same **philosophy** as the men's — **matched** to the aim of the day.

Speed cardio on speed days, outdoor cardio on calisthenics days. Everything is designed to work together.

### The AG4 Beginner and Intermediate Programmes

These programmes will get you started on the way to your dream body.

They are built around three sessions a week and are designed to be time efficient — many of the workouts can be completed in **half an hour,** making them easy to fit in after a long day at work.

The goal, however, is to build towards five days a week over time and take your fitness seriously.

Especially at the **intermediate stage**, you are recommended to start pushing towards four and five sessions per week.

## Why AG4 Works

In the AG system, we stick to basic **non-negotiable** exercises. It is far better to go in and do three or four exercises as a beginner and overload them consistently than to have an ever-changing routine you never quite learn.

I do not want you stressing about learning ten different exercises when you are new.

I want you to build an easy, repeatable routine that you actually enjoy. I want working out to feel simple, fun, and free of mental stress. You will learn **new** exercises, new diet techniques, and how

to track your lifts — but at your **own pace**, one win at a time.

The way our programme works is this: **beginners** stick to the bread and butter exercises and build their routine around them.

No matter what kind of day you are having, whether you are a beginner or advanced, you can always fall back on the same four **base exercises** for your push, pull, upper, lower, or full body days.

Focus on getting stronger on those **non-negotiable** lifts and you will never waste a session. You will always grow.

At the intermediate and advanced stages, you will still be doing the same base exercises — but now you start adding to them.

I give you a **library** of finishers and advanced supersets to add on to the end of your non-negotiable lifts. Your

timetable looks slightly more packed at this stage, but it is still the **same** sessions you have been learning and building on.

Once you learn this programme, it is repeatable year round. It is not an ever-changing timetable that resets every four weeks — it is one **advanced** timetable that you learn once and keep for life.

From there, I want you to learn all the **finishers** and **advanced techniques** in the **library** provided and simply pick techniques based on how you feel, which muscles feel like they need more attention, what sounds fun in the moment, or what machines are available.

This is how variety gets added to your routine without stress. Shoot for roughly **one** technique per exercise.

On the main **compound** lifts that open your sessions, keep things simple — lift heavy and beat your records. Save the advanced training techniques and experimentation with new ideas for the smaller **isolation** lifts that follow.

Chase your " personal record" with the compound movements you start with, and then chase the "pump" with the isolations after.

You will get a **great workout** this way.

There will always be days where you do not feel like the same session. For those days I have added extra **variety workouts** you can drop in whenever you want.

But you will never have to follow a confusing, ever rotating timetable — you always have the solid AG4 base to return to.

One thing I have found **consistently** over the years: whenever my progress

stalls, I stop whatever side workouts I have been doing or whatever new routine I found on YouTube, go back to the AG4 basics, and my body starts responding again **every single time**. You always have a safe and proven programme to return to here.

## Learning Extra Skills

One of the things that sets the AG programme apart is what happens **after** the main session.

Every day you are encouraged to spend a few minutes learning a **new skill** connected to the muscles you just trained.

It might be a new cardio machine, a new exercise, a stretch, or a calisthenics movement. Over time, these small windows of learning compound into real ability.

**Beginner — skills to work towards:**

- X Trainer — 5 minutes
- Rowing Machine — 5 minutes
- Ski RG Machine — 5 minutes
- Mountain Climber Machine — 5 minutes
- Recline Bike — 5 minutes
- Hand Bike — 5 minutes
- All AG stretching routines
- Punch bag basics
- How to spot someone

**Intermediate:**

- Battle Ropes — 5 minutes
- Skipping — 5 minutes
- Skin the Cat
- Crow Pose
- Elbow Lever

- Resistance band assisted pull up variations
- Deadlift and Romanian Deadlift

**Advanced:**

- Muscle Up
- Handstand
- Toe to Bar Leg Raise
- L Sit

Try to match the skill you learn to the day. **Back day** — work towards muscle ups. **Push day** — practise handstands, crow pose, or elbow lever. **Leg day** — work on pistol squats and L sits.

**Boxing** and **calisthenics** are the two skills we push most heavily within this programme.

**Boxing** develops **sport-specific** muscles, burns an **enormous number** of calories, and keeps cardio intellectually engaging — there is always a new combination to work on.

Most gyms have a punch bag. Use it.

**Calisthenics** gives you a functional, flexible, and athletic body that carries over directly into your lifting. It gets you outside, keeps things varied, and builds **skills** you can take anywhere.

## Beyond the Gym — Making Fitness a Way of Life

The AG programme is not just about what happens inside **four walls.** Fitness, done properly, opens up an entirely **different** life. And we want you to live it.

We particularly encourage you to learn a **sport** alongside your training — something that engages your brain,

challenges your body in a different way, and makes cardio something you actually look **forward** to.

Most people give up on cardio because they are staring at the **same wall on the same treadmill,** session after session. It does not have to be that way.

Every cardio day, push yourself to learn something new.

Try a **new** cardio machine. Work a new combination on the bag. Progress a skill or sport, or work towards a race.

The gym becomes a completely **different** place when it is also the place where you are developing real athletic ability.

## How to Make Fitness Exciting

Beyond the gym itself, the way to truly make fitness a lifelong passion is to take it out into the world.

We encourage you to go on a **monthly adventure.** It does not have to be expensive or complicated — it just has to be different.

Go on a **sunset jog** through a new part of your city. Find the outdoor workout park and meet the people training there. Sign up for a race. Try a **new** sport.

And if you can dream bigger — do it.

Learn kung fu with the monks in China. Play football in Brazil. Run a **marathon** in your hometown.

Ski or snowboard in the Italian Alps. Skateboard in San Francisco. Go scuba

diving at the Great Barrier Reef or rock climbing on a mountain.

Train in a world-class gym in Dubai or Tokyo. Fitness will take you somewhere if you let it.

The only question is whether you are willing to make the effort.

Whenever life starts to feel routine, I want you to say three words to yourself: ***Make the effort.*** Go somewhere new. Try something **different**. Sign up for the thing you have been putting off.

Start the YouTube channel. Go to the event with your friends. Leave the house.

This applies just as much to your life **outside** of fitness — visit a meditation class, learn to cook healthy meals from different cultures, go to social gatherings, experience new things.

Build a **bucket list** and actually work towards it. The people I see who make

the most of this programme are not just the ones who train the **hardest** in the gym.

They are the ones who take everything they have built and use it to go and live a bigger life. An **exciting** life!

*Exercise: Write down your fitness bucket list. Make it ambitious. Then make the effort to reach it.*

## Daily Challenges

On top of your regular sessions, here are some standalone **challenges** to throw in whenever you want to push yourself or mix things up:

- **Cutting challenge** — Run 1–2 miles as fast as you can after your workout, three times per week
- **Bring Sally Up** — Go to the park on a sunny day, play the Bring

Sally Up track, and follow the workout

- **Swimming** — Excellent for cutting and active recovery
- **Kickboxing bag round** — 50 punches, 50 kicks each side, 50 knees, 50 elbows. All in one round
- **Mountain climber endurance** — 30 minutes on the machine listening to a business or self-improvement podcast
- **Outdoor dips challenge** — 10 sets of chest dips at an outdoor workout park
- **Bench press focus day** — Every once in a while, just do 10 sets on the bench press and nothing else
- **Push up challenge** — 250 push ups, spread across breakfast, lunch, and dinner
- **Decline sit up burnout** — Set a timer for 3 to 5 minutes and go flat out

# The AG4 Workouts

I will now explain to you the **AG4 workouts** going from **beginner** to **advanced**!

# Beginner Workouts

As a **beginner**, there are many workouts that can help you ease into it! The trick is that as a beginner you will get **tired** easy, and the beginners I train often feel that feeling of: “ok I’m ready to go home now!” so much faster than regular gym goers.

If I try and give a beginner a workout that is too hard, they will stop from **exhaustion** before getting a good workout.

The problem is people give beginners workouts that tire them out in **less than 5 minutes.** And then the beginner thinks right that was a great session! I've reached my limit, I'm **exhausted**, time to go home!

Wrong way to go! They aren't really burning **enough** calories or getting enough work in, they just did a period of high intensity way **too fast** instead of **pacing** themselves.

It is so easy to **exhaust** a beginner with the workouts a regular gym goer would use and I am talking within 5 - 10 minutes if that.

It's usually because they pushed too hard on a single exercise and it caused them to abandon the session early. Or did **cardio first** before even touching weights.

If you exhaust yourself **early**, you will get that feeling of wanting to go home, you will think you have done enough because you really pushed yourself to the **limit**.

But 5 minutes of high intensity isn't enough, you need to put your body through weights sessions, machines and less tiring cardio for a **longer period of time** for a workout to be effective.

This doesn't mean you have to make yourself completely out of breath for half an hour to an hour, weights and lighter cardio actually aren't all that tiring. But we do need to **complete** the full workout sessions assigned!

Therefore, try to pace yourself so you at least hit your **exhaustion point** half an hour to an hour into the workout at minimum. Try and give yourself and your body at least this time.

This can mean doing your push ups with the **knees to the floor.** Or bodyweight squats when holding onto something next to you. This can mean taking breaks or doing your **cardio last** in your workout if you are still building your stamina.

Even taking longer breaks to stretch and catch your breath with light movement can work. Try and build to a minimum of half an hour to an hour to see the best results.

Pace yourself through these workouts!

# Beginner (Male Specific Workouts)

## AG4 Half Hour Push Workout

## (Beginner)

I believe this is one of the **best workouts** of all time. Even though I do the advanced and longer versions of this workout now, this was the workout that got me from **not wanting** to go to the gym, to being really **consistent**.

I still use this on days where I am really busy with business work. Or days where I simply just only have the energy for a **quick** session.

If you do all these exercises to the best of your ability, you can **finish** within 30 - 45 minutes and still grow.

AG Push Day Warm Up

Dumbell Shoulder Press 4 x 12

Incline Chest Press 4 x 12

Lateral Raise 4 x 12

Triceps Pushdown 4 x 12

AG 6 min ab workout (Only do 1 2 minute round)

# AG4 Half Hour Pull Workout (Beginner)

AG Pull Day Warm Up

Pull Ups Max Set

Lateral Pulldown 3 x 15

Barbell Row 4 x 12

Pec Dec Reverse Fly 4 x 12

Bicep Curl 4 x 12

Medicine Ball Crunches 4 x failure

## AG4 Half Hour Legs (Beginner)

Barbell Squat 3 x 12

Leg Extension 3 x 12

Leg Curl 3 x 15

Lunges 3 x 15

Dumbell Shoulder Press 3 x 12

AG 6 min ab workout (Only do 1 2 minute round)

## Why Train Shoulders With Legs?

Pairing **shoulders with legs** allows you to hit shoulders once extra per week, they are often the most under looked muscles in a man's physique.

Nearly every **bodybuilder** that I admired, I realised that they were training shoulders a lot **more** than the average person would think. Arnold Schwarzenegger included, would even train shoulders **daily** in short bursts.

I don’t hear most bodybuilders say that about any other muscle. I believe this is for a **reason**.

If you neglect **frequency** on your shoulders, they loose a certain round look, and this can take you from the "superhero, undeniably strong, fitness beach body" look, to "just a **normal** looking guy" very quick.

Many will focus on the chest and back, but the **shoulders** are what will **make or break** your physique. Anyone I know that trains shoulders the most, are the physiques that look the **best** looks wise.

# Beginner (Female Specific Workouts)

## Complete Beginner Workout 1 - (Pull Day Female)

X Trainer 3 Minutes Listen To Favourite Song
2 Mins Stair Master
Rear Delts Machine Low Weight 2 x 20 - Fixes posture
High Straight Bar Face Pulls 2 x 20 - Fixes Posture
Assisted Pull Ups 3 x failure
Lat Pull 3 x failure
Row Machine 2 x failure
Bicep Curl Machine 3 x 15
Abs - 1 plank until failure
Leg Raises 2 x failure
Sit ups 2 x failure

AG Pull Day Cool Down

## Complete Beginner Workout 2 - (Leg Day Female)

Rower Machine 3 Minutes Listen To Favourite Song

45 Degree Leg Press Machine 3 x 12
Hip Thrust Machine 3 x 10

Abductor Machine 3 x 15
Leg Extension 2 x 10
Lying Leg Curl 2 x 15
Abs - 1 plank until failure
Leg Raises 2 x failure
Sit ups 2 x failure

AG Leg Day Cool Down

## Complete Beginner Workout 3 - (Shoulder's Day Female)

Shoulder Press 3 x 12
Lateral Raises 3 x 12
Rear Delts Machine 3 x 15
Press Ups - 1 Set To Max
45 Degree Leg Press 3 x 12
Abs - 1 plank until failure
Leg Raises 2 x failure
Sit ups 2 x failure

AG Push Day Cool Down

# Complete Beginner Workout 4 - (Simple Female Workout)

Do you want to have a **simple** workout you can default to that will grow you and **improve** you no matter what? Something you can do if the gym ever gets overwhelming? It can sometimes be too much for us as beginners!

You may not want to do **7 exercises** or some kind of complicated programme today.

You may be feeling **overwhelmed** with a programme where you are learning many new machines.

You may be feeling like you need a **break** from bigger sessions on your program.

Maybe you had a long session at work and the programme card in front of you looks **too much** to take in.

You don't want to have to **think** too much, or log everything on your app today. But deep down you still want to have a **productive** session and **grow**.

Don't worry, I have the answer. It's normal to have days like this especially starting out as you are learning **loads** and your programme is not **second nature** to you yet.

Whenever you feel an **overwhelmed** feeling, just go back to the **basics**. Start small and do:

Treadmill , Squats and Assisted Pull Ups.

The treadmill cardio will reduce your body fat, the squats will tone your lower

body, and the pull ups will build your upper body.

Even keeping it this **simple**, you will **grow** from this, it will be productive and even from this simple day you still achieve **growth** and a great victory.

For 99% of women **consistently** performing even this workout, will **build** them for sure. Women tend to have a higher body fat than men, and tend to look good when they build **specific** areas such as the lower body, so the treadmill and the squats are great to focus on.

Women are actually luckier in this regard. Their bodies are slightly **different** to men, who obsess with building calves and biceps, triceps and many different **smaller** muscles.

A man performs better with more **complicated** workouts due to the fact

that they have many smaller muscles to build if they are going for **aesthetics**.

Men tend to hit many **different** muscles hard, whereas women hit **specific** areas really hard.

A woman tends to look more **aesthetic** sticking to a basic set of movements for fewer muscles.

If you consistently and heavily train your lower body with **squats**, do your **cardio**, and some **pull ups** to tone your upper body, you are on your way to looking great, whereas a man has to shift his focus to a **larger amount** of muscles.

Make use of the basics if you just need to complete a nice **easy, productive** session.

## AG4 Beginner Half An Hour Full Body Workout 1 (Glutes Focus)

AG Full Body Warm Up

Hip Thrust Machine 3 x 12
Assisted Pull Ups 3 x 12
Shoulder Press 3 x 12
Abs - Leg Raises 3 sets x failure

Cool Down Cardio - Rowing Machine 5 minutes

## AG4 Beginner Half An Hour Full Body Workout 2 (Hamstrings Focus)

AG Full Body Warm Up

Romanian Deadlifts 3 x 12
Barbell Rows 3 x 12
Shoulder Press 3 x 12
Abs - Back extensions 3 sets x failure

Cool Down Cardio - Treadmill 5 minutes

## AG4 Beginner Half An Hour Full Body Workout 3 (Quads Focus)

AG Full Body Warm Up
Barbell Squat or Leg Press 3 x 12
Leg Extension 3 x 12
Shoulder Press 3 x 12
Abs - Leg Raises 3 sets x failure

Cool Down Cardio - Stair Climber Machine 5 minut

# Intermediate & Advanced Systems

## How Do The Intermediate & Advanced Systems Work?

Once you progress to the **intermediate** and **advanced** programmes, you will start to see some **changes** in the structure.

Instead of just doing general Zone 2 cardio on the treadmill like you would in your beginner programmes, the cardio begins to get more **structured** and **targeted** towards an athletic outcome.

This **outcome** relates to the **day** that you are performing for your weights session. You will see this change in cardio programming once you start to switch to the PPL (Push Pull Legs) or Lower

Upper (3 Lower , 2 Upper) style programmes.

The idea is if you are weight training for **power** on a particular day, your cardio exercises will also focus on **power** training.

If you are weight training for **speed,** your cardio exercises will also focus on **speed** training.

These are **trait based** days. The idea is that you work your muscles to the maximum towards **one** training aim per session to get the full benefits and **improvements** towards that training aim.

Targeted cardio training is better for your progression, instead of working **50%** towards two **different** training aims, you will work **100**% towards the chosen aim of the day, for **maximum** results.

Going 50% between too many goals is never going to get you the **maximum** results, to get results we need to **push hard**, which is why we maintain focus towards **single** objectives day by day.

In the Intermediate and Advanced Programmes, you will start to notice that the Push Day and Pull Days will start to reflect **different** training aims for your weight training instead of just having one Push or Pull day.

Your days will get more targeted, towards **hypertrophy, speed, and power.**

These are all elements that will translate over into giving you an amazing and also **functional** body.

And a **healthy** body in every way.

Some people are just healthy in a **muscular sense**, some are healthy in the sense they can carry out multiple

**explosive movements,** but we want to work **each** training aim, as they all carry different **benefits** for your health and sports performance.

Here is an example of how the **cardio** you perform pairs with the different days, at the Intermediate and Advanced stages, for a Male on the 5 Day Push Pull Legs split.

**AG Push Day (Hypertrophy)**
Cardio : Zone 5 (SkiRG and battle ropes or hand bike and punch bag depending on how legs feel)

**AG Push Day (Speed)**
Cardio: AG Speed Cardio or Sprints

**AG Push Day (Power)**
Cardio: AG Power Cardio

**AG Pull Days**
Cardio: HIIT,

or Punch Bag 6 rounds or Zone 2, or Swimming

**AG Leg Days**
Cardio: HIIT, or Punch Bag 6 Rounds, or Zone 2 , or Swimming

**AG Calisthenics Full Body Day**
Cardio: Sprints + Zone 2 Outdoor Jog

**AG Home Workout**
YouTube HIIT or Shadowboxing or 100 burpees

If you ever get exhausted or feel **over-trained**, default back to **Zone 2 cardio** or **swimming.**

These forms of cardio can be your **backup** any day you need. 50 or 100 burpees can also be used in 10 sets of 10 or 5 sets of 10 if you feel the need to save time on your cardio. Burpees are very quick to complete.

You will notice that your body will tell you what it **needs**, and when you can **push hard** and when not to.

The point of this programme is to give you **freedom** when you need it.

You will notice the **Zone 5 cardio** exercise selection is **dependent on how your legs feel.**

This is because it is **dangerous** and pushing a little too far if you do zone 5 cardio (which pushes you to your true limit) on your legs on the exercise bike after already hitting your legs hard on a heavy leg day.

For this reason we suggest you do upper body zone 5 cardio on leg day and lower body zone 5 cardio on upper body days if you decide to do Zone 5.

Zone 5 is where you simply perform cardio for 10 minutes at the most **maximum** effort you possibly can.

Sometimes your legs will even feel sore a day after leg day and you can switch to **upper body** zone 5 cardio.

The **upper body** zone 5 cardio is using the Ski RG machine, and the Battle Ropes.

The **lower body** zone 5 cardio makes use of an Exercise Bike in combination with a punch bag or another cardio machine.

Make the choice based on how your body and legs feel.

For **sprints**, you can perform sprints outside, or use a treadmill if you are in the gym. **If you are outside:** do 10 really fast sprints for 15 seconds each sprint. Rest and recover after each sprint for however long you need.

**If you are on the treadmill**, do 40 seconds of normal jogging, and then turn up the speed to sprint.

Do **10 sprints** in total. Sprint for 25 seconds on the treadmill instead of 15, as there is a **delay** in the speed of the treadmill adjusting to the speed you set it.

When you press the button to set a speed fast enough for you to sprint at on the treadmill, you do not **reach** that full speed until a few seconds later.

So start counting from the **moment** you press the button to increase the speed towards a sprint, and count to **25** instead of the **15** that you would count to when doing non treadmill sprinting, this **accounts** for the delay.

# Intermediate Workouts (Male Specific)

## AG4 Half Hour Push Intermediate -

Warm Up: AG Push Warm Up

Incline Bench DB 4 x 12
Lateral raises 3 x 15 dropsets (superset with machines, cables or bands)
DB Shoulder press 3 x 10 SS with Barbell Shoulder press
PICK Triceps Buster 1, 2 or Triceps Mega Set
PICK Abs Workout

## AG4 Half Hour Pull Intermediate

Warm Up: AG Push Warm Up

Pull Ups 1 Max Set To Failure
Lateral Pull - 3 x 15
Barbell Row - 4 x 12
Reverse Fly - 4 x 12
Bicep curl - 4 x 12
Incline Bicep Curl - 3 x 10
Bicep Curl Machine - 4 x 12
EZ Barbell drop set - 3 sets 15 reps drop
50% of the plates off another 15 reps
ABS - back extension 3 x 20

## AG4 Legs + Shoulders Intermediate

AG Legs Day Warm Up

Squats 3 x 10
Leg Extension 3 x 15
Lying Leg Curl 3 x 15

Lunges 3 x 12
Calves Destroyer
Shoulder Press 4 x 10
Lateral Raise AG Dropset 3 x 15
PICK Abs Workout

At this stage I like to throw in some **shoulders** on the male leg day, they are one of the most **overlooked** and **under trained** muscles for men.

Those that have **great** physiques always told me that they use the Run The Rack method with some shoulder presses or lateral raises pretty much every workout, **regardless** of what day it is.

And I have to agree, without adequate shoulders work, your physique will **fall apart** no matter how big your chest or legs are.

Shoulders are slightly smaller muscles so they recover **faster** and need a bit

more focus to grow to remain on par with the chest and back.

## Intermediate Workouts (Female Specific)

## AG4 - 3 Day A Week Lower Only (Intermediate)

A variation of the programme for women that **specifically** don't want to work their upper body and **just** want to work their lower body.

Many women feel their upper body is already **developed** enough, and wish to focus on just the lower body. This is completely valid and a **great** programme for such circumstances.

## AG4 Lower Only 1

Warm Up: AG Light Legs Warm Up

Hip thrust 4 x 12
Squat OR Leg Press 4 x 12
Lying Leg curl Machine or DB 3 x 15
Leg extension 4 x 12
Abductor - leg cables or machine 4 x 12
Back extension 3 x 12

Cardio - Zone 2 Cardio Or 6 Rounds
Boxing Bag Or Swimming

## AG4 Lower Only 2

Warm Up: AG Light Legs Warm Up

Romanian Deadlift 4 x 12
Hip thrust 4 x 12
Leg Press (Pauses) 4 x 12
Lunges 4 x 12

Abductor - Leg Cables Or Machine 4 x 12
Back extension 3 x 12

Cardio - Zone 2 Cardio Or 6 Rounds Boxing Bag, Or Swimming

## AG4 Lower Only 3

Warm Up: AG Light Legs Warm Up

Squat - Paused 4 x 12
Hip Thrust 4 x 12
Leg Extension 4 x 12
Lunges 4 x 12
Abductor - leg cables or machine 4 x 12
Back extension 4 x 12

Cardio - AG Speed Cardio, or HIIT, or LIIT

# AG4 3 Day Full Body Female Programme

This is a 3 day a week full body female programme.

## AG4 Full Body Day 1:

AG Full Body Warm Up

Hip Thrust 4 x 12
Pull Ups 4 x 12
Barbell Squat 4 x 12
Dumbell Shoulder Press 4 x 12
Romanian Deadlift 4 x 12

Abs: AG 6 Minutes Abs Workout

Cardio: Zone 2 Cardio, or 6 Rounds Boxing Bag, or Swimming

## AG4 Full Body Day 2:

AG Full Body Warm Up

Hip Thrust Machine 4 x 12
Barbell Row 4 x 12
Barbell Squat 4 x 12
Incline Dumbell Bench Press 4 x 12 x
Lateral Raises SS
Lying Leg Curl 4 x 15

Abs: Barbell Weighted Back Extension 4 x 12

Cardio: Zone 2 Cardio, or 6 Rounds Boxing Bag, or Swimming

## AG4 Full Body Day 3:

AG Full Body Warm Up

Barbell Hip Thrust 4 x 8
Barbell Row 4 x 8
Barbell Squat 4 x 8

Barbell Shoulder Press x Front Raises x
Upright Row SS 4 x 15
Lying Leg Curl 4 x 15

Abs: AG 6 Minutes Abs Workout

Cardio: AG Speed Cardio, HIIT, or LIIT.

## Advanced Workouts - (Male Specific)

At this stage, you should be **in tune** with your body. The workouts are possible to complete provided you focus hard throughout the workout.

As your workouts grow **longer**, you will start to be in situations where some machines may not be available, and you will want to add more **variety**.

Any exercise labelled with ***(nn) is non negotiable.*** Other exercises can be

changed around to your wishes if you feel you need **variety**.

I want you to start flowing and **adapting** your programmes to how you feel in the moment with the **library** of **supersets** and **advanced training techniques** provided in this book.

This prevents **boredom** and **slow progress** at this stage of your training. Your body needs controlled variety as well as progressing the main compound lifts.

Complete your non-negotiable lifts, but feel free to **switch** out some things, add some machines relating to the muscles you are working based on what is available at your gym, and start to apply the **advanced** techniques.

At this stage, start to apply advanced training techniques to every third set that you perform at **minimum**.

# AG4 Push Day 1 (Hypertrophy)

Warm Up - AG Push Day Warm Up

Incline DB Press (nn) 4 x 12
Shoulder DB Press 4 x 10
Incline Bench or Smith (nn) 3 x 12
Plate Loaded Incline Chest 3 x 8
High To Low Cable Fly(nn) 4 x 12
Dips (nn) 4 x failure
Triceps Cable Pushdown x Triceps Behind Head Cable Extension SS (nn) 3 x 12

Shoulder Press Machine Tri Set 3 x 12
Lateral Raises AG Dropset 3 x 15

Abs - 5 minutes of abs. Pick exercises from the abs workout library.

Cardio: Zone 5 Cardio (Hand Bike + Boxing or Ski RG + Battle Ropes)

## AG4 Push Day 2 (Speed)

Warm Up - AG Push Day Warm Up

Incline DB Press (nn) 3 x 12
Incline or Flat Bench Press (nn) 3 x 12
Machine Chest Press 3 x 15
Machine Chest Fly (nn) 3 x 12
Shoulder Press Machine Tri Set (nn) 3 x 12
Lateral Raises AG Dropset (nn) 3 x 15 x
Cable Lateral Raises Superset
Triceps Pushdown x Behind Head Cable Extensions Superset (nn) 3 x 12

Abs
Decline Sit Ups With Plate or Barbell 2 x failure
Ab Roller 3 x failure
Speed Sit Ups Exercise Ball 4 x failure

Cardio: AG Speed Cardio

# AG4 Push Day 3 (Power)

Warm Up: 1000 steps stair climber

Power Bench 6 5 4 3 1

Power OHP 5 5 5 3 3

Weighted Dips 3×5

Machine Chest Press 3×6

Heavy Lateral Raise 3×6–8

Heavy Tricep Pushdown – 3×5

Cardio: AG Power Cardio Session

# AG4 Pull Day 1

AG Pull Day Warm Up

Pull ups 3 sets x failure (wide normal commando) (nn)
Lat Pulldown 4 x 15 (nn)
Rear Delt Fly 4 x 12 (nn)
Barbell Row (AG Back Tri Set) x 3 (nn)
Cable Row 3 x 15
Back Extension 3 x failure

Static pull up holds and pull up negatives to finish. 2 bar hangs until failure.(nn)

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming, or HIIT, or 6 rounds on punch bag.

# AG4 Pull Day 2

AG Pull Day Warm Up

Dumbell Shrugs x Upright Row x Behind Back Barbell Shrugs SS 4 x 12 (nn)
Pull Ups 3 x failure (nn)
Lat Pulldown 3 x 15 (nn)
Machine Row 3 x 12 OR T Bar Row (Power) 3 x 5 (nn)
Rear Delts Machine 3 x 12
Rear Delts Cable Fly 3 x 12
Cable Row 3 x 15
Bicep Curl Machine 4 x 12 (nn)
Back Extension 3 x failure

Static pull up holds and pull up negatives to finish. 2 bar hangs until failure.

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming, or HIIT, or 6 rounds on punch bag.

# AG4 Pull Day 3

AG Pull Day Warm Up

Once every two weeks, hit a pull workout like this where you start with your biceps to focus more on the biceps muscle.

Biceps Machine Curl 4 x 12
Barbell Biceps Curl EZ Bar (Forced Reps With Partner or AG Military Dropset)
Incline Bench DB Curl 3 x 12
Hammer Curls Dropset 3 x 12
Reverse Curls Wrist Curls SS 5 x 15
Pull ups 3 x failure
Barbell Row 3 x failure
Rear Delts Machine x DB rear delt fly 4 x failure
Face pulls 3 x failure

Abs - Back Extension 3 x failure

Cardio - Zone 2, or swimming, or HIIT, or 6 rounds on the punch bag.

## AG4 Leg + Shoulders Day 1 (Hypertrophy)

Warm Up: AG Leg Day Warm Up

Barbell Shoulder Press 4 sets of 12 slow negatives
Lateral Raises AG Superset + Static Holds 3 sets

Squats Reverse Pyramid - 12 10 8 6
Leg Destroyer FST3 (Leg Press 15 reps, with no rest do Dumbbell Lunges and walk Over To Leg Extension machine, 8 reps Leg Extension Machine 3 circuits)

Leg Curl Machine 3 sets of 12

Standing or Seating Calves Machine 4 sets of 12

Abs - Choose From Exercise Library

Cardio: HIIT, or Punch Bag 6 Rounds, or Zone 2 , or Swimming

## AG4 Leg + Shoulders Day 2 (Power)

Warm Up: AG Leg Day Warm Up

Barbell Shoulder Press 4 sets of 5 first set is push press, slow negatives on the way down.

Lateral Raises AG Superset + Static Holds 2 sets

Shoulder Press Machine 3 sets of 12 one advanced training technique per set

Squats Reverse Pyramid - 12 10 8 6
Leg Extension Machine - 4 sets of 12
Hip Thrust Machine - 4 sets of 12
Romanian Deadlift - 3 sets of 12

Standing or Seating Calves Machine 4 sets of 12

Abs - Choose From Library

Cardio: HIIT, or Punch Bag 6 Rounds, or Zone 2 , or Swimming

## Advanced Workouts (Female Specific)

You are now at a stage where you are in tune with your body. Well done, keep up the momentum.

At this stage, you should start to apply advanced training techniques from the advanced training techniques section to nearly every set that you perform.

# AG4 Female 5 Day Bodybuilding Programme

We are getting to the **late-intermediate** and **advanced** stages now. I would expect a beginner to spend some time (maybe a month or two) on the half hour workouts, building up the desire to do longer workouts.

Then the 3 day a week **full body** sessions for a few weeks or so, until the motivation to be in the gym **5 days** appears.

Once this motivation appears, this is a **serious** programme that will get **serious** results. Learn this programme by **heart** and you will always have the ability to have a life changing body.

We are now **changing** to 3 lower, 2 upper for 5 days a week. Each day is targeted to an athletic training **outcome**.

## AG4 Upper Body 1 (Hypertrophy)

Warm Up: AG Push Day Warm Up

DB Shoulder Press 4 x 10
Lateral Raises AG Dropset 3 x 15
Lat Pulldown 4 x 15
Row Machine / Cable Row Machine 4 x 15
Rear Delts Machine 3 x 15
Bicep Curls Machine 3 x 12
Triceps Rope Pushdown 3 x 12

Abs - Any Workout From Exercise Library

Cardio: Zone 5 (Hand Bike and Boxing Bag or Ski RG and Battle Ropes)

## AG4 Upper Body 2 (Speed)

Warm Up: AG Push Day Warm Up

DB Chest Press 3 x 12
Pull Ups 3 x 12
Barbell Row 3 x 12
Rear Delts Machine x Face Pulls 2 x 15
Bicep Curls Machine x Hammers SS 2 x 12
Triceps Rope Pushdown x Behind Head Cable Extension Superset 3 x 12

AG 6 minute Abs Workout

AG Speed Cardio Day

## AG4 Lower 1

Warm Up: AG Legs Warm Up

Hip thrust 4 x 12
Squat OR Leg Press 4 x 12

Leg Curl Machine or DB Leg Curl 3 x 15
Leg Extension 4 x 12
Hip Abductor - Leg Cables or Machine 4 x 12
Back Extension 3 x 12

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6 Rounds Punch Bag

## AG4 Lower 2

Warm Up: AG Light Legs Warm Up

Romanian Deadlift 4 x 12
Hip Thrust 4 x 12
Leg Press (Pauses) 4 x 12
Lunges 4 x 12
Hip Abductor - Leg Cables or Machine 4 x 12
Back Extension 3 x 12

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6 Rounds Punch Bag

## AG4 Lower 3

Warm Up: AG Light Legs Warm Up

Squat - Paused 4 x 12
Hip Thrust 4 x 12
Leg Extension 4 x 12
Lunges 4 x 12
Hip Abductor - Leg Cables or Machine 4 x 12
Back extension 4 x 12

Cardio: Zone 2, or Swimming or HIIT or 6 Rounds Punch Bag

## AG4 Calisthenics & Home Workouts

## AG4 Beginners Home / Park Workout

Squats until failure
Lunges until failure

Planks until failure
Sit Ups until failure
Light Dumbell Curls until failure
Light DB Lateral Raises until failure
Light DB Shoulder Presses until failure
Light DB Calve Raises until failure
Air Skipping / Jogging On Spot 5 minutes

If 5 minutes of the cardio at the end is **too much** for you, you can **break the cardio up** into 5 sets of 1 minute each, with 30 seconds of performing a **dynamic stretch** of your choice in between.

For this dynamic stretch you can do **hip circles**, and also **arm circles**.

This is how I would start a client off if they **get tired** easily, or if I had **limited equipment,** or I was **outside**. You just need a pair of **light dumbbells** or **kettlebells** and a **mat**.

If you can't **squat** your **bodyweight** for the bodyweight squats, then you can hold onto something for **support** such as a parallel **bar** or between two **chairs**.

If you cannot perform a **plank** then you can perform the plank on your **knees**.

Don't worry about **perfection**, you will grow each time you perform this workout.

If you still don't feel tired at the end of this workout, try and do as many **push ups** as you can, on your knees if you have to. If you struggle still with push ups, you can do them on an **incline raised** surface, or even your **stairs.**

Try to beat your record every time. After you can do **25** push ups on your knees, start building towards normal form push ups.

I originally created this workout as a **pre workout** for my boxing clients, because I had a lot of beginners that wanted to start boxing, but they would run out of **energy** after the first **5 minutes** if I got them straight into the punching.

I had to learn to give beginners a workout like **this** first, so that they actually **paced** themselves through an entire half an hour of working out, getting the benefits of a longer workout, without **burning out too early** from going straight into boxing.

Then I would take them through the Beginners Boxing workout as detailed in a later section to **wear them out** at the end of their session.

Even for those that do not want to train boxing, this is an **excellent** workout to master for someone who gets tired easily who wants to **build up** towards half an hour of steady working out.

## AG4 Late Beginners Home Workout

Squats 3 x failure
Lunges 3 x failure
Resistance Band RDLs 3 x 12
AG 6 Minute Ab Workout
Resistance Band Biceps Curl 3x12

Resistance Band One Arm Biceps Curl 3x12
Resistance Band Triceps Pushdown 3x12
Resistance Band OH Tricep Extension 3x12
Push Ups 3x failure
Resistance Band Chest Press 3x12
Resistance Bands Shoulder Press 3x12
Resistance Bands Front Raises 3x12
Resistance Bands Lateral Raises 3x12
Resistance Band Pull Aparts 3x12
Resistance Band Rows 3x12
Resistance Band Shrugs 3x12

To get a **pump** from resistance bands you need to take short rest times of around 30 seconds. Even though this is a large list of exercises, you can get through them fairly **quickly** in your house with minimum rest.

Cardio: LIIT or HIIT or Boxing

YouTube Workouts

## AG4 Intermediate Calisthenics Full Body Workout

Warm Up: AG Push Day Warm Up

6 muscle up attempts
3 sets wide pull ups supersetted with
3 sets wide barbell rows
3 sets commando pull ups supersetted with 3 sets dips
3 sets chin ups supersetted with 3 sets push ups
3 sets hands together pull ups supersetted with
3 sets Leg raises into L Sits
Resistance Band Lateral Raises 3 sets
Resistance Band Face Pulls 3 sets
Pistol Squats 3 x failure (use a bar to support you if you struggle)

Cardio: Jogging & Sprints

## AG4 Advanced Home / Calisthenics Workout

This is a 1000 rep **calisthenics** workout. All you need is a **pull up bar** and **two CHAIRS** for dips.

100 dips
100 pull ups
100 weighted backpack push ups
100 dips
100 v sits
100 mountain climbers
100 burpees
200 lunges 100 squats (1 x plyo lunge 1 x squat in a row 100 times)

Split all the exercises into **10 sets of 10** and do the circuit repeatedly until you complete it!

The lunges count as 200 repetitions because you explosively **switch** legs on your explosive plyometric lunge, getting 2 reps of lunges (one on each leg) for every 1 squat that you do on 2 legs.

If this is confusing, check out the YouTube Channel for the workout titled - "1000 Reps Calisthenics Workout"

Cardio: The burpees and mountain climbers counts as the cardio for today.

## AG4 Advanced Calisthenics Workout

Warm Up: AG Push Day Warm Up

6 muscle ups
3 sets wide pull ups supersetted with 3 sets wide barbell rows
3 sets commando pull ups supersetted with 3 sets dips

3 sets chin ups supersetted with 3 sets backpack push ups
3 sets hands together pull ups supersetted with
3 sets Leg raises into L Sits
Resistance Band Lateral Raises 3 sets
Resistance Band Face Pulls 3 sets

Cardio: Jogging & Sprints

## Variety Workouts

Switch to these workouts whenever you need some variety in your training! They are ordered from beginner to advanced.

## Beginners Boxing

**Level**: Beginner
**Targeted For**: Males & Females

I found for a **complete** beginner, the usual 2 - 3 minute rounds a boxer can usually do would have to be **replaced** with 1 minute rounds and lots of hip circles, slips, and water breaks when the person gets tired.

Don't stand around doing **nothing** on your breaks as you will get bored, and a beginner needs a lot of breaks. Take **active** rests with the stretches and light movements provided.

I run beginner clients through a really **light workout** such as the AG4 Beginner Home / Park in the section above, and then give them the boxing **after** to avoid them burning out too fast.

At the **minimum**, run through some star jumps, squats, twist pulses, and light dumbbells, and build your cardio over a few weeks, until you can box for **30 minutes** without failure, only taking short rests in between 1-2 minute

rounds.

The workout is as follows:

Pad work 1 minute

Heel Circles stretch - 24 circles per foot

(12 each direction)

Pad work 1 minute

Lats stretch (lean to each side)

Pad work 1 minute

Arm circles

Pad work 1 minute

Dodges and Rolls

Pad work 1 minute

Standing Quadriceps Stretch

(Helps with balance)

This is a workout I find can really help someone get into boxing. Instead of the pad work with a partner you can also perform the rounds on the **punch bag** in the gym too.

If you can do **this** workout you can definitely move on to doing the 6 rounds on the punch bag workout **below**.

## Beginners Boxing 2

**Level**: Beginner
**Targeted For**: Males & Females

Warm Up:

Hang From A Bar For 1 Minute

1 Minute Skipping Rope or Air Skipping

Stretching:

Heel Circles stretch - 24 circles per foot

(12 each direction)

Hip Flexor Stretch 15 seconds each side

Standing alternating toe touches 15s

Stand and reach toes (hamstring)

stretch 15s

Hip circles 15s per side

Arm circles  15s

**Now, perform  6 2 -minute rounds on the punch bag:**

Round 1: Jab every 3 seconds and move around the bag.

Round 2: Jab Cross every 3 seconds and move

Round 3:  1,2,3 every 3 seconds and move

Round 4: 1234 every 3 seconds and move

Round 5: 12345 every 3 seconds and move

Round 6: 123456 every 3 seconds and move

Cool Down - Exercise Bike 1 minute

For an **example** of this workout checkout the AG YouTube channel for the video titled Beginners Boxing Workout.

We have **separate** videos for left handed and right handed beginners.

## Shoulders + Arms Death Star Delts SuperWorkout

**Level**: Late Beginner
**Targeted For**: Males

Barbell Overhead Shoulder Press 4 x 10
Arnold Press 3 x 10
Lateral Raise 3 x 15rep Dropsets
Machine Shoulder Press 3 x 10
Bicep Curl Machine 4 x 12
Tricep Extensions Machine 3 x 12

Overhead Tricep Extensions 3 x 15
Abs - AG 6 Minute Abs Workout.

## Heavy Lifting Strength Workout

**Level**: Late Beginner
**Targeted For**: Males & Females

A **full-body** workout for when you just want to lift **heavy** and get some hormones released. 4 simple lifts. Use sparingly. Good for when you've taken a few days off and feel slightly sluggish energy.

This will get you back in the game and heavy lifting will release a lot of hormones to boost your mood.

Deadlifts 3 sets of 10
Squat 3 sets of 10
Smith Incline Bench 3 sets of 10

Barbell Row Heavy 3 sets of 10

## Late Beginner's 6 Week Gorilla Program

**Level**: Late Beginner
**Targeted For**: Males

This is a full body programme that got me started training in the **bodybuilding** style.

You can do this 3 times a week. I used this, and the Thor workout on occasion, to build a **solid base** of training.

This program taught me the **importance** of working the full body and training in the hypertrophy range.

I learned which machines to go a bit higher on the repetitions for the best **pump** and **growth**.

Personally, I think this programme is **great** for a person who hasn't got their head around going to the gym 5 - 6 times a week.

Going 3 times a week, this will work your full body. I prefer the **momentum** of going more times in a week, using shorter workouts and a push pull legs style split.

The full body workouts can be **long**, and there are just those little muscles that you feel like you don't get as much **time** to work when you work your full body.

When you get to an **advanced level**, you tend to realise if you want **maximum** results, you should be in the gym daily and working on the smaller muscles as well.

The benefits of eventually moving over to a **5 day split** is that you get the

hormonal release of exercise every day, and the endorphins. You limit the “lazy mood” **feeling** you get when you skip too many gym days.

You also have more **freedom** to shorten your sessions, and tend to be able to hit some more **isolation** exercises and **smaller** muscles that you would be too tired to hit after a massive full body compound focused session.

If you do not do other sports, then consider this!

This is a **general** programme for those that wish to go to the gym 3 days a week and is **effective**.

You will still grow greatly off this programme,and it is good for **athletes** who have other **commitments**.

That said, if you wish to do 3 a week, the days that you do full body you have to WORK! If you are just going 3 a week. It needs to be a **big session**.

If you are committed to other sports and need a 3 day a week full body programme, this programme is one of my **best**.

It is great for **beginners** to get their full body used to lifting all the **compound** movements.

Monday -

Squats (Heavy) 4 x 12
Bent Over Rows 4 x 12
Lat Pull Down 4 x 12
Arnold Press 4 x 12
Incline Bench DB 4 x 12

Wednesday -

Underhand Weighted Pull Ups 3x FAILURE
Triceps Dips Weighted 3X FAILURE
Tricep Push Downs 3 x 15
Cable Row 4 x 12
Lat Pull Down 3 x 15
Lateral Raises AG Drop Set 3 x 15
Leg Curls 4 x 12

Friday -

Squats 4 x 12
Bent Over Row 4 x 10
Dumbell Flat Bench Press 4 x 12
DB Shoulder Press 4 x 12
Lat Pull Down 3 x 15

## Arnold Schwarzenegger Home Workout

**Level**: Late Beginner
**Targeted For**: Males & Females

This one is **recommended** by the great bodybuilding champion himself, as a way to build mass at home. Arnold actually recommends being able to **complete** this workout as a way to get your whole body strong before moving on to weights!

Push Ups x 50 beg 100 int 150 adv

Dips Between Chairs 5 x 20

Rowing With Broom Between Chairs 50 Total

Sit Ups With Legs Pinned Down 200 Total

Bent Leg Raises 50 Total

Bent Over Broom Twists 50 Total

Squats 70 Reps

Calf Raises 50 Reps

Close Grip Chin Ups 30 Total

## Thor Chest Workout

**Level**: Intermediate
**Targeted For**: Males

Incline bench 12 10 8 8 6 4 - 6 sets
Incline DB bench - 4 sets x 12
Chest Press Machine - 3 x 15
Chest Fly Machine - 4 x 12
Dips 4 x 15

## Sore Upper Chest Workout

**Level**: Intermediate
**Targeted For**: Males

Incline DB Shoulder Press - 4 x 10 plus barbell SS
Incline Smith Machine Bench - You do a weight that you can do 3 sets of 10 with. On the last set, do 10 reps with the normal weight, exploding with no pauses, then instantly lower the weight

by 10% to do another 10 pause reps with 3-4 second pause.
Incline Chest Machine - 4 x 12
Lateral Raise AG Dropset
Tricep Pushdown Straight Bar 3 x 12
Tricep Rope Pushdown With 2s Pause at Bottom 3 x 12
Behind Head Tricep Extension Cable 3 x 12

## Savage Workout

**Level**: Intermediate
**Targeted For**: Males & Females

One set max pull ups. (Really wide pull ups)
Lat Pull Down - Heavy! 3 x 15 (pull with force, not slow)
T bar Row 3 x 10
Cable Row - One Arm (pull with force, not slow) 3 x 15
Deadlift 3 x 10
Squats 3 x 10

This is a nice Back x Legs day. I don't usually pair Back + Legs but for a change it is nice. If your back is **lagging** you can pair it with legs.

## Legs Destroyer 2.0 -

**Level**: Advanced
**Targeted For**: Males & Females

Warm Up - AG Light Legs Warm Up

Squats 3 x 10

Leg Extension Machine 15 reps straight into dumbell lunges 6 reps per leg, straight into Leg Press 15 reps. 30 seconds rest after all 3 exercises are complete.

Finish 4 circuits of this.

Select 3 or 4 calves exercises from the following (standing calve machine,

seated calves machine, bodyweight calves raises standing on board, 45 degree leg press machine calve raises)

Hit all these Calve machines one after the other until failure in the 10 - 12 rep range with no rest.

Then take 30 seconds rest. Repeat this for 3 circuits. Remember to use a 2 - 4 second squeeze at the top of each repetition. Make sure you don't have too much to do the next day on your feet as you will feel this one in that area!

## Back Destroyer 2.0 -

**Level**: Advanced
**Targeted For**: Males

Warm Up: AG Pull Day Warm Up

Pull Ups To Failure.

Lat Raises. 4 x 15
Cable Row 4 x 15
Rear Delt Fly. (Heavy To Light, Leaning In) 5 10 10 15
Face Pulls x Y Raise SS. (12 reps each)
Barbell Row, superset into T-Bar Row. SS Into DB Row.

This day is **great** when you feel like your Biceps could do with a rest. We usually pair Back and Biceps on Pull Day but this is just for one of those days where we want to hit our **Back** hard.

The **last** exercise will really get you. I don't see many people in the gym do this one. It's my secret technique.

It really works and is time efficient because you can easily get your bar set up in front of a rack, bring over a dumbbell, and then you are able to hit 3 different exercises at once.

For a video of this exercise type in “Back Tri Set” on the AG YouTube.

## Thor Chest Workout Hard Mode

-

**Level**: Advanced
**Targeted For**: Males

This is the workout that Chris Hemsworth used to turn himself into the superhero Thor. It is very rewarding and one of my favorites.

Bench Press 12 10 8 8 8 6 4 4
Incline DB Press 4 x 8-12 Last Set Dropset.
Chest Fly - 4 x 8-12 SS if possible
Machine Press - 4 x 15 SSS Cable or Standing DB Upwards Fly
Dips 10 x 10
Incline Bench Plate Loaded Machine 3 x 10

## 1 Hour Push Workout -

**Level**: Advanced
**Targeted For**: Males

This is for when you have an hour to really focus and get a pump. This one isn't a joke!

DB Shoulder press 3 x 10 SS with barbell
Incline Bench DB 4 x 12
Smith Machine 4 x 12 last set pause rep pyramid up to 10 and back Down
Chest Fly Machine 4 x 12
Incline Plate Loaded Chest Machine 4 x 12
Cable Fly 4 x 12
Chest finisher - Dips 3 x 12 and superset them with Lateral raises where you do 15 DB lateral raises , rest 10 seconds, another 15 DB lateral raises, rest another 10 seconds, and then do 15 reps with resistance bands. After each set of

dips perform your lateral raises triple set and you will really feel it by the end)

Triceps Pushdown Cable 3 x 8
Rope 3 x 10 pause reps
Triceps Machine 3 x 10
Bench Dips 3 sets max SS dumbbell standing kickback

## 1 Hour Pull (Action Hero Biceps)

**Level**: Advanced
**Targeted For**: Males

Pull Ups Max Set
Lateral Pull - 3 x 15
Barbell Row - 4 x 12
Reverse Fly - 4 x 12
Cable Row - 4 x 12
BB Bicep Curl 1 heavy set of 6rm
Cable Bicep curl 1s pause - 4 x 12
Incline Bicep Curl slow - 3 x 10

Bicep Curl Machine - 4 x 12
EZ Barbell drop set - 3 sets 15 reps drop half plates off another 15 . Do 21s. With ez bar then dumbbell.

## Advanced Full Body Mega Session -

**Level**: Advanced
**Targeted For**: Males

This is for the **elites**! If I was to work my full body I would go from head to toe to make sure I don't miss a muscle. This is going to be one of those 2 hour sessions where you really want to actually work your **full body**.

If I was a person who only trained 3 times a week, I would ensure the sessions looked something like this if I wanted to look **great**.

It looks like a **big list** of exercises on paper, but at an advanced level, we are up against people who are in the gym 5 days a week trying to hit every machine in the gym, putting their whole body through a workout **consistently**.

It isn't that you can't build an amazing body by doing less, but to get that **top 10% physique**, you are up against people whose mindset is to go to the gym 1 - 2 hours a day every day.

To them they just see it as 14 hours out of 105 possible waking hours in their week. From **experience**, I know that the people that go to the gym 3 or 4 times a week can still build **nice** bodies.

No one will look at them and say they aren't looking great, some of them will be models with 6 packs and people will tell them they are really **fit** and strong.

But from experience it's the guys who go 5+ days a week and hit every machine in sight, who build those bodies you see on the **front pages** of social media.
We can for sure do less and still achieve great things, but for the **elites** this is one of many training forms that can put you in the elite category.

Once you understand fitness, once you understand how many little muscles get **imbalanced** if you don't work them equally, and once you realise there are so many different elements to training such as **mobility**, **power** and **flexibility**, different styles of **cardio**, you realise there is always something to work on.

The advice of 3 full body sessions of simple compound movements a week starts **not** to make sense when you understand bodybuilding training on this level.

Starting from the traps and neck down,
I would do:

Dumbell Shrugs 3 x 12
Dumbell Shoulder Press 3 x 12
Lateral Raises AG Dropset 3 x 15
Rear Delts Fly Machine 3 x 15
Incline DB Bench 3 x 12
Incline Dumbell Fly 2 x 15
Chest Dips 2 x 15
Lateral Pulldown 3 x 15
Barbell Row 3 x 15
Bicep Curl Machine 3 x 10
Triceps Cable Behind Head Extension 3 x 10
Roman Chair Sit Ups 3 x failure
Back Extensions 3 x failure
Leg Press 3 x 12
Leg Extension 3 x 12
Leg Curl 3 x 12
Calves Machine 3 x 15

You could do this workout **as many** times a week as you could manage to create an elite body.

I would also use it to catch up if I had a really bad week of **missed** sessions and felt like catching my **entire** body up.

## Holiday Workouts

To get good at working out on holiday you need to get good at making the best of what you have in **creative** ways. Some hotel gyms have rooms with 1 **single machine**. In many hotels the dumbbell weights don't go very **high** like in commercial gyms.

Therefore, make use of **slow** repetitions with your dumbbells. Go for 5 seconds up 5 seconds down movements. This is because you are using lighter dumbbells.

You can make use more of **abs** exercises, and **bodyweight** exercises. Pistol Squats

for example, on your legs. And using a **weighted backpack** to execute push ups.

Focusing on abs and high rep push ups will benefit you here, as well as bringing **resistance bands** with you for little pump circuits.

Finally if your hotel has one of those all in one machines, you can think outside the box.

You can try things like using the **lateral pulldown** machine for Tricep Pushdowns if you stand up instead of sit down, and if you **pull the handles** of a Chest Press machine towards you whilst standing opposite it, it becomes a Standing Row.

A lot of those "all in one" hotel gym machines have at least a **few** of those **attachments** that you can be smart with to work different muscles.

## Slow Holiday Workout 5 Seconds Up 5 Seconds Down

Lat Pulls - Slow Reps
Tricep Pushdown - You Can Use Most Lateral Pulldown Machines In The Hotel Gym For This
DB Shoulder Press
Lateral Raises - DB + Resistance Bands
Chest Press Pause Reps - DB Or Machine
DB Fly
Weighted Rucksack Push Ups
Bicep Curls x Hammer Curls
Legs - Pistol Squats
Abs - AG 6 Minute Ab Workout

## 200 Rep Holiday Workout

This 200 rep workout gets you sore.

(Once a month or so, do a high rep workout like this to rip your muscle fibers in a new way)

200 reps chest press 25kg dumbbells
200 reps bent over rows 25kg dumbbells
200 reps lateral raises 7.5kg dumbbells
200 reps goblet squats 25kg dumbbells

## Bodyweight Beast -

200 press ups for breakfast, lunch and dinner!

Beg - 50 press ups
Intermediate - 100 press ups
Advanced - 200 press ups

## Bring Sally Up, Bring Sally Down

This is one of those **military** style push up workouts where you do push ups to music. The song is called **Flower** by **Moby**.

You can search on YouTube for how to do the workout, essentially the words in the song say "Bring Sally Up" and "Bring Sally Down."

You **time** your push-ups with the lyrics:

When you hear "bring sally down" you **lower** yourself and **hold** your push up at the bottom with your chest near the floor.

Stay there until you hear "bring sally up" and then push back up.

The **intensity** from this workout comes from the fact that you **pause** your push

ups at the bottom in time with the music, which creates a great workout.

## Bleep Test

This one is always fun, it is used to test the level of a person's **endurance running** ability for jobs such as the Metropolitan Police Force.

You set up **2 cones, 20 meters** apart.

Participants run **back** and **forth** between the cones, keeping in time with a series of **audio beeps**. Each time the beep sounds, you must reach the opposite cone before the next beep.

As the test continues, the **time** between beeps gets **shorter**, meaning:

- You have to run faster
- There is less recovery time

The test is split into **levels**, and each level has multiple shuttles. As you progress:

- The level number increases
- The speed required increases

If you fail to reach the cone before the beep:

- You usually get **one warning**
- If you miss again, the test ends

Your final score is recorded as the **level and shuttle** you reached (e.g. Level 7.5).

You can download the **audio track** on the internet.

# Bonus Workout: How To Fix Your Posture And Look Like A Superhero

One of the most **popular** questions my clients ask me is how they can fix their posture.

Fixing things like "**nerd neck**" where your neck tilts so far forward, involves addressing the underlying **causes** of the posture **imbalance**, which often includes tight chest and shoulder muscles, weak back muscles, and poor overall posture habits.

The fix is actually **simple**, a well balanced back day repeated over time that targets a variety of back exercises with different grips.

Here is an example:

**Pull Ups** - 1 set to maximum effort at the start of your workout.
**Barbell Row** 3 x 12 - This is a nerd neck fixer. It pulls the shoulders back and improves posture.

**V Cable Row** - Again another nerd neck fixer hitting your back at a different angle.

**Deadlifts** - Excellent to strengthen your lower back and fix weak back posture.

**Tri-Set:**

**Cable Y Raises**
(low weight, high reps)

**Face Pulls**

**Resistance Band Pull Aparts**

(excellent Tri- Set to pull your shoulders back into a healthy posture.)

**Superset - Rear Delt Machine x Face Pulls:**

Place **one knee** or **foot** on the cable machine in front of you, this gives you balance so you can **lean back** more and give yourself more stability to pull the exercise with more power.

**Tri Set:**

**Cable Row**
**Cable Scapula Row**
**Resistance Band Pull Apart.**

**Note on Deadlifts** - Deadlifts put lots of stress on the lower back muscles, which tend to take up to a **week** to recuperate.

Therefore, I only use Deadlifts **once** per week if I am going to programme them. For an **example** of this workout, or if the description of the exercises is unclear to you, check out the video on YouTube titled:

"How To Fix Your Posture And Look Like A Superhero."

## Cardio Workouts

These are workouts for your cardio blocks.

## Zone 1 Cardio

Examples:

- Long Walks Outside
- Incline Walking On Treadmill
- Climbing An Easy Mountain Or Hike That Doesn't Make You Out Of Breath.

**Zone 1** cardio is the most **basic** level of cardio. Zone 1 is doing cardio at a rate

you could pretty much keep on doing for hours without tiring!

Such as a **slow walk**, or a really relaxed, **slow swimming** session with lots of rests on the walls in between laps.
It is just movement and will never make you breathe heavy or feel tired. It is good for those in **recovery**, boosts **relaxation**, and older exercisers can benefit from the reduced intensity of Zone 1.

For a **younger** exerciser, I consider this type of cardio to be part of the movement we typically do in our day, such as a half hour walk, the walk to and from work. When we look at our **steps count** that we do, generally this is considered zone 1 cardio.

Zone 1 **burns** calories, and **movement** in any way is a benefit to our bodies.

For an elderly person it can be especially worthwhile, and Zone 1 can even turn into Zone 2 if they start to feel out of breath.

Zone 1 style walking cardio workouts are the bare **minimum** when it comes to improving fitness and heart health for the majority of athletes, young, and middle aged people.

**Young** people and anyone wanting to ascertain an **aesthetic** physique will need to burn calories more effectively and generally will have the **incentive** to push themselves further than this stage of cardio.

This is because most young people want to efficiently burn more calories in their day... If they only have 30 minutes in the gym after work, they know they can **jog** for 30minutes and burn more calories than if they were to walk for an hour.

When we **picture** what would be considered an actual cardio session for a capable exerciser, Zone 1 would likely be considered as some extra movement as part of our day, instead of treated as an actual **session** of cardio.
For those over 60, an **hour** of walking and Zone 1 exercise can be counted as a cardio session, but **other types** of cardio should usually still be included in your week for overall fitness.

There is doing the **minimum** to be "healthy" ie **surviving**, and then there is doing what is **necessary** to be **fit**!

As a more **active** person, to make this style of cardio **challenging**, you could climb a mountain. It wouldn't need to get you out of breath, but the calories burned in 2 - 6 hours of such uphill movement would add a lot to your day.

## Basic Zone 2 Cardio

This is our **basic** cardio session. Zone 2 is the type of cardio that **most** people generally do when they go to the gym.

Think a half an hour to an hour session on the treadmill or any of the other cardio machines in the gym.

You are breathing **slightly** heavy with this style of exercise, and may have a **slight** sweat when finished, but you are not pushing yourself to the limit.

Examples of this workout -

Light Jog For Half An Hour / 1 Hour
Morning Jogs Outside
Sunset Jogs In Evening
Using Any Cardio Machine In The Gym
For 30Min - 1Hour

When you do this type of cardio, as long as you don't push beyond around a 7 out of 10 intensity, it can be a very **relaxed** way of losing weight.

My favourite forms of Zone 2 are **morning jogs** in **nature**, jogs across the bridges in the city at **sunset**, and if I use the cardio machines in the gym I love to watch movies or listen to audiobooks whilst I do the cardio.
This makes it way more fun and you can **combine** a habit that you really enjoy with the workout to make yourself enjoy it even more.

You can feel more **motivated** to workout using movies and books to **reward** you to get to the gym, and the **intensity** is not too much to deal with on these simple, repetitive machines, therefore you are able to **focus** your mind on other tasks fairly easily.

Try to **push** your **duration** of how long you do Zone 2 cardio for each week. Once you hit half an hour or an hour, try to then improve the **mileage** you do on each machine within those times, write your times down and constantly improve your fitness levels.

Zone 2 cardio is also called Long Slow Duration (LSD) cardio. It should be at a pace where you can speak easily and feel at about 5 out of 10 intensity for **most** of the workout.

Try and start this type of workout slowly, and reach a maximum of around a **7 / 10** intensity around **3 quarters** of the way through your workout, and then slowly bring yourself back **down** before the end.

This is the workout that a personal trainer will start most **beginners** on the treadmill when they first join the gym.

## General Interval Training

After a person can hit **half an hour** of Zone 2 cardio a few times a week, they may wish to progress and push further.

Enter **Interval** Training. This is **great** on most cardio machines. For general Interval Training you want to cycle between a 4/10 intensity and a 7/10 intensity in intervals of 30 seconds each.

One interval is a WORK interval (the 7/10 one) and one interval is a REST interval (4/10.) Switch between the WORK and REST intervals every 30 seconds for the **entirety** of your cardio workout.

This is a style of training that is meant to carry over into **sports**. If you don't hit a **7/10** intensity in your intervals you aren't really getting a workout that will translate over into sports, and if you go

**8/10** and above it starts to become high intensity interval training.

For the **general** cardio training of an athlete or a casual gym goer, we can use this technique.

Interval Training improves **overall general** cardio, think about a football player that just needs the **general** cardio to perform their best. They often make 30 second sprints when they chase the ball all the way across the pitch and back.

They are mostly running around at a 7/10 intensity (**work**) and back down to about a 4/10 (**rest**) as they rest once they catch and pass the ball.

General Interval Training reflects what goes on in general in their sport.

Sometimes an athlete will sprint **hard** for a ball, or exert large amounts of

**power**, and this is why we train High Intensity Interval Training too, this is **separate** from general Interval Training, as it is more **intense**, and will be explained in a later section.

Standard Interval Training is simply designed for **general** cardio. The interval times don't **matter** as much in this stage, as they do when you specialise for sports in High Intensity Interval Training explained later on.

Athletes use general cardio to move around and naturally move between efforts of 4/10 to 7/10 when playing their sport, such as chasing balls around at different speeds, and it's not always in **exact** 30 second or 40 second intervals.

In General Interval Training we do not need to be as **accurate** and setting a 30 second work 30 second rest, will likely

give you similar results to a 40 second work 20 second rest.

For this reason I set my clients a very simple **30 second** work at **7/10** intensity and a **30 second** rest at **4/10** intensity.

You can also do **3 mins** work at **7/10** intensity x **3 mins** rest at **4/10** intensity if you wish to hit a slightly longer cardio range for sports where you run for longer periods of time.

Those two are just **easy** to understand for all involved.

Beginner: 20 - 30 minutes
Intermediate: 30 - 40 minutes
Athlete: 40 min - 1 Hour

## Low Intensity Interval Training

These can be the **light** shadowboxing and circuit based lighter workouts you

see often on YouTube that get your pulse raising, but never let you reach **max** intensity. You can search for the term LIIT on YouTube.

LIIT has **low intensity**, **low impact** movements, and is not highly intense. This makes it easy for beginners.

Sure, the calorie burn is **less** than the higher intensity styles, but you can perform LIIT workouts for a **longer** period of time with **less stress** to your body and still burn calories.

This is an easier and more relaxed workout than High Intensity Interval Training and **great** for beginners.

## General Cardio / YouTube Circuit Workouts

Sometimes it is nice to just switch things up when you get bored, and put

on a half an hour to an hour YouTube video.

There are so many **cardio circuit** workouts on YouTube nowadays. Sometimes it is nice to train the body in new ways, and get yourself out of breath in new ways.

It is a breath of fresh air to train in the style of a **different** trainer or personality.

I find these style of workouts really good for **home workouts** when you cannot get to the gym.

## Boxing Cardio

The reason I suggest **boxing** and **kickboxing** to my clients is just because I believe in the **results** it gets.

Firstly, of all the sports, it burns one of the **most** amount of calories in the **least** amount of time.

Whenever I see a person do even a **few** sessions a week of kickboxing, I notice that they have a really **great** physique.

Due to all the **cardio** they do, boxers and kickboxers always remain lean, **flexible** in most cases, never get "too big" from weights, as all the cardio, repeated punches and kicks from the sport tends to keep them at a **healthy weight**.

The high amount of cardio, the focus on running, the focus on pushing your body to exhaustion through punches

and kicks, gives the body a certain slim and hard look.

People who train these sports **consistently** nearly always see abs.

They also build a lot of **rotational** power, and people with a lot of rotational power tend to have strong abs and larger amounts of muscle in the area called the **serratus** muscle, which makes the upper torso look more athletic.

Someone who just **bodybuilds** or powerlifts can tend to have a more balloon type look to their muscles.

Whereas someone with explosive power, who is capable of multiple explosive kicks and punches without getting tired, just gets a certain **powerful** and aesthetic look.

Those that combine a few kickboxing or mma sessions a week with bodybuilding tend to build great bodies.

They have the muscle mass from the **bodybuilding**, the leanness from the high cardio sport, as well as the full body look of power that I think is unique to these type of sports that put your entire body through powerful **explosive** movements.

These sports also work the **whole body**. For example, fighters do Push Ups, and Punches for their upper body.

They do Squats, Kicks and Knees for their lower body, and so the sport is very balanced, unlike some sports that are more upper or lower body focused.

If you want to start a cardio session of kickboxing, I wholeheartedly believe you should work it into your routine starting from the basics.

Here is a basic routine:

Skipping 2 Minutes (If you can't skip take the 2 minutes to learn to skip.)

6 3 Minute Rounds On Punch Bag (Focused Work - Learn A New Punch Or Combo Each Time)

Treadmill - If you are in need of a finisher, you can wear yourself out on the treadmill for 10 minutes.

## Sprints x 10

At some stages in our fitness programming, it is **beneficial** for our body to simply run **as fast as we can.** Sprints release a large amount of **hormones** that are great for building muscle.

Sprints are close to **maximum** effort, so they hit a different energy system than jogging does. That is to say, they keep us fit and benefit our body in a different way than something like long distance running.

It is good to be fit in different **ranges** of fitness as each different range has different amazing benefits for the body.

For example, **sprinting** tends to keep our heart capable of beating more powerfully. This allows our heart to handle high stress events better and perform better under **illness** or times of high exertion.

Slower forms of running tend to be better for our **blood pressure**, and how well your heart **performs** when pumping blood around your body.

To cut a long story short, both slow runs and sprints will be of benefit to your

overall health and sprints are **amazing** to include in a programme for young, able individuals.

A simple setup is to do **ten** 15 second sprints as fast as you can. In terms of rest, there is no set rest time, just wait until your heart rate returns to **normal**, so that you won't be at all affected or tired for your next sprint.

You rest until you **know** you can go for the next sprint with 100% energy and nothing less.

Sprinting is one of the most **effective** exercises for raising our VO2 max. VO2 max is the speed that your body can take in and use oxygen at once for exercise.
Increasing it is one of the **biggest** predictors of living longer, as well as helping elderly people get less **fatigued** on the stairs and performing difficult tasks.

Improving your VO2 max will literally increase your **heart** health, **lungs** health, and overall health.

Beginners: 6 x 15 second sprints
Advanced: 10 x 15 second sprints

You can do this instead of a Speed Cardio workout in the AG4 programme, as working on sprints counts as Speed Work.

You can also run sprints on a **treadmill** in the gym. Treadmills take a longer time to get up to the speed you want to sprint at, there is a delay as you increase the speed up to the desired result.

For this reason on your treadmill, do periods of light jogging and then do sprints of 25 seconds instead of 15seconds.

This extra 10 seconds accounts for the time that you build up to the required speed as the treadmill builds speed, as if you started sprinting outdoors you would reach this speed a lot quicker.

Start counting the **moment** you start to press the button to increase your speed.

## High Intensity Interval Training (HIIT)

High Intensity Interval Training is a very **popular** workout. You do have to be careful as many of the workouts on YouTube are marketed as HIIT.

But are actually LIIT (Low Intensity Interval Training)

What makes a workout HIIT (High Intensity) is that some of the sets involved have to take you to a really high intensity.

They have to take you to 80 - 90% of your heart rate, which is **very close** to maximum effort.

For example, if the HIIT workout has 25 second work periods and 25 second rests, at least some of those work periods should have you almost **completely exhausted** as the 25 seconds come to an end.

A lot of the YouTube workouts will have really easy, **light** exercises for the first 15 minutes or so aimed at **beginners**.

Then usually push some **harder** exercises towards the end. You must note, to get the **benefits** of HIIT, you must actually push some sets within these workouts to near **complete** failure.

A good coach or video will explain this to you, but sometimes it is up to **you** to realise this, as HIIT is now a marketable "trend" on YouTube and you need to make sure what you are doing is **actually** HIIT.

If you are doing 30 minute YouTube workouts and not a single one of the exercises brings you close to **maximum** effort where you cannot possibly do another repetition, then it is not really HIIT.

Good HIIT workouts will usually have exercises that will allow you to push yourself really hard, such as burpees, jumping squats, high knee sprints, fast mountain climbers and medicine ball swings.

Movements that will take you to an 8 or 9 / 10 level of intensity. If you spend a 30 minute workout **marching** on the spot and **stretching**, and it doesn't challenge you, then it is Low Intensity Interval Training.

When designing HIIT, you can use WORK intervals of 30 seconds or 15 seconds work. Both work different energy systems called glycolytic systems.

It is easier to go to **true** maximum power effort in 15 seconds and this energy system is ideal for athletes that train for explosive power. Short punch

combos, quick sprints to tackle someone in football, 100m sprints, long jumps, high jumps, and short swims.

You can reach **maximum** effort of your heart rate in 30 seconds too with reduced power, because of the increased time under tension, and the 30 second WORK intervals are better for power produced over a slightly long period.

Think long powerful **exchanges** in boxing or wrestling, **200meter** sprints, **chasing** the ball across the field and back again in football as hard as you can.

Both training methods are **beneficial**.

You can do a 10 minute HIIT session at 15 seconds work with 45 second rests for the **fast**, power focused athlete.

Or a 20 minute session at 30 seconds work with 90 seconds rests for the **medium range,** power focused athlete.

A **beginner** could do a 20 minutes HIIT workout: 20 seconds of work with 2 minutes of rest as their heart rate will stay raised longer than an athletes.

A beginner will need more **recovery** to perform consecutive max effort periods than an athlete.

Nowadays, HIIT workouts on YouTube will sometimes be half an hour long. Note that it is very hard for even an **advanced** athlete to sustain **true maximum effort** for more than 10 minutes, let alone half an hour.

These workouts are likely **mislabeled** circuits, or sometimes are HIIT but the first 10 - 20 minutes are designed to be warm ups and light movements, with the **actual** HIIT portion in the middle 10 minutes, and the last 10 minutes are usually designed to be a **cool down** with lighter movements once more.

At the end of the day, the **length** of the workout you follow doesn't really **matter**. All that matters is the workout contains at least one 10 - 20 minute period where you work close to your true maximum **multiple** times.

**Intense** exercises like Jump Squats and Burpees allow you to do this.

Anything else outside of this **intense period** is just a warm up and extra cardio.

Your rest periods can be **active rests** meaning you use lighter and easier exercises that bring your heart rate back down.

## Fartlek Training

This is a training lasting 20 - 60 minutes in duration where the coach

exercises the client at a 7 - 8 out of 10 of their maximum effort.

Once they reach 9 out of 10, the coach will bring them back down until they reach about a 5 or a 6 in effort.

Then the coach will bring them back up repeatedly to the 7-9 out of 10 range and back down each time.

The aim is to improve the ability to sustain maximum effort for longer periods of times, as well as **improving recovery** times between max effort bursts of energy.

To explain it simply, the coach is not **timing** each interval or exercise with a **calculator** or with **numbers**, they are simply going with the flow, by your facial expressions and the **reactions** of your body, pushing you to where you need to be and back down.

This is based off estimation and is an effective and **flexible** way to train.

Where would this be used? For example in kickboxing, a coach will make you hit the pads softer at first, with single strikes. At the **end** of each round of pads, the coach will make you do 10 hard kicks on each leg, which will bring you to **close** to **exhaustion**.

During the **break** in between pad rounds, you are just doing some light movements and bouncing, drinking water, bringing you back to an effort of around **5 - 6.**

Then you restart another pad round, and your coach gets you back up to an 8-9. You go **back** and **forth** like this for 20 - 60 minutes.

Another way to do this is simply **running** on a treadmill, using periods of sprinting and periods of slower jogging,

alternating between a 5 effort and a 9 effort for 20 - 60 minutes.

There is no **direct timing** involved, Fartlek Training requires a good coach who is able to adjust **intensity** based on the reactions of your body.

## Long Distance Runs

**Depending** on if you are a beginner or not, these runs can be anywhere from 3K, up to 5K, 10K, 15K to a marathon and beyond. K means **kilometers**.

Some people run for **meditation**, **reflection** and **mindfulness**, and can use running to relax them and think about life. They usually just run alone with their thoughts. This is usually more **achievable** on the easier runs.

There are times where doing a challenging run can get hard, & some

people prefer to use **distractions** to get through the **challenging** areas of a run. Such as listening to **audiobooks** or running with friends.

I have had success with **both** methods depending on how challenging a run is.

My favourite ways to do a running workout is out in nature, or in interesting places with good views, usually during **sunset** or **nice** weather.

Having a great **playlist** of good tunes can really enhance the **runners high** you feel.

I also enjoy listening to David Goggins audiobooks whilst running, these workouts can be really **inspirational** and amazing.

Sometimes you can simply run to the sound of your own **thoughts**, going on

**positivity runs** where you think about all the things you are thankful for.

Once you get through the first **month** or so of running, you get in the flow and mindset of **appreciating** the good moments, the pain you associate with running is **replaced** with pleasure.

You end up able to go for a 20 minute jog and it actually relaxes you more than taxes you like it did when you first started. You don't get that feeling of **absolutely dying**, it's a lot more **manageable** and enjoyable.

It becomes very normal and the feeling of dying is just replaced with a manageable sweat, the feeling of a **runners high** and when you reach this stage, you can get a lot out of running and have some great workouts.

With the right **music** or **audiobook** playing, in **nature**, with positive thoughts, going on a run can be a **manageable** and **great** workout.

Don't give up at the **first hurdle** before you reach the reward of feeling great!

The great thing about exercise is that with practice, you can turn what you first considered a struggle into the **highlight** of your day.

Of course, there are times you can greatly challenge yourself through running, but it can overall be an **enjoyable** and **relaxing** sport once you ease into it.

## Speed vs Power Cardio

The difference between **Speed** and **Explosive Power** is simple. **Speed** is around 5 repetitions, performed as **fast**

as you can with **zero** or **very little** resistance.

The **zero or minimal** resistance means you hit **maximum** velocity as there is no weight **stopping** you from reaching your full speed.

**Explosive Power** is where you perform movements as fast and explosively as you can, with a **medium** amount of resistance.

That means doing the movements **against** weights. You hit a **medium** to **high** level of **velocity**.

## Speed

**"Move as fast as you can, under zero or little resistance."**

- 5 reps
- Very light loads or bodyweight
- Maximal velocity
- Shorter rest periods

**Examples:**

- Speed squats
- Speed bench
- Fast push-ups
- Sprint drills
- Fast med ball throws with lighter balls
- Fast punches for 10 seconds

- Light Sled Pushes

In my **speed** sessions I perform reps at the highest possible speed. I do my main muscle gain session first lifting in the rep ranges of 8-12 to build muscle.

Then I perform my speed reps at the end of the session in sets of 5 repetitions.

5 repetitions allows for us to go as fast as we can as past 5 repetitions we tend to slow down, and it doesn't become **true** speed training.

The rest period associated with speed is **not a number**, the rest period is however long it takes for you to recover fully so you can perform the next 5 repetitions at 100% speed again.

# Power (Strength × Velocity)

**Power is done under heavy load.**

Typical characteristics:

- 1–6 reps
- Moderate to heavy loads (30–85% 1RM depending on intent)
- Maximal intent every rep
- Rest periods (2–5+ min)
- High fatigue cost

Examples:

- Olympic lifts
- Heavy jump squats

- Trap bar jumps (loaded)
- Med ball throws with heavy balls
- Heavy sled pushes
- Box jumps - your body weight is very heavy to launch up high so its power

For example: Use heavy medicine balls for 6 reps and slam them as **hard** as you can. Do your jumping exercises **loaded** with dumbbells. Do **heavy** Sled Pushes. The rest period for power is 2 - 5 minutes.

## AG Speed Cardio Day

After your speed related Push Day, I have created a great workout to build up your overall **speed**. Speed can come in

many forms, such as your punching speed, how fast you can run and **turn**, and how **fast** you can use your body in various situations.

True speed can only be worked by doing a repetition as fast as we can. Therefore, we do sets of 5 reps or so and then leave time for **recovery**. Any more than 5 or so reps and we remove from our ability to do the reps as fast as possible and actually train our speed.

I have designed a cardio workout where we do 5 really fast speed reps of specific exercises, and then take an **active rest** break in order to **recover** our ability to perform more speed reps.

An **active rest** is a break where we are doing **lighter movements** to still burn calories as part of our cardio session, whilst we are **recovering** our muscular capacity to perform our speed repetitions at **top** speed.

These movements work really well after your Speed Related Push Day.

This results in a session that allows you to work speed in your **weightlifting** session whilst also building speed into your **cardio** session after, to fully **focus** your day on speed techniques.

As we are doing movements as **fast** as we can, this can be a great cardio session, but we are also working our speed movements.

We get two benefits at once. This is a great session for athletes once again.

**Beginners Speed Cardio Workout**

Finish your normal push day with:

Speed Bench 3 Sets Of 5

Speed Overhead Press 3 Sets Of 5

Then explosive circuit:

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest)
(Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)

5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot
(Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)

5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot
(Repeat combination 3 times and move on)

Shadowboxing Punch Flurries 5 seconds

30 seconds light high knees
(Repeat this combination 3 times then finish)

**Advanced Speed Cardio Workout**

This one is for the more **serious** athlete, requiring a gym environment and more equipment.

The schedule is:

Post workout:

Speed Bench 5 sets x 5 reps
Speed Overhead Press 5 sets x 5 reps
Plyo Push Ups 3 sets x 5 reps

Punch Bag Workout -

6 x 2 Minute Rounds On The Bag
(At the start of every round, throw 5 heavy speed hooks each hand. And 5 heavy kicks each leg) 2 Min rest between rounds.

Explosive Finisher:

5 speed squats
30s light high knees (active rest)
(Repeat this combination 5 times and move on)

5 speed burpees
30second skipping on the spot
(Repeat this combination 2 times and then move on)

5 speed left hand punches
5 speed right hand punches
30 seconds marching on the spot

(Repeat combination 3 times and move on)

5 reps plyo push ups
30 seconds light skipping on spot
(repeat combination 2 times and move on)

Shadowboxing Punch Flurries 5 seconds
30 seconds light high knees
(Repeat this combination 3 times and move on)

5 Light Med Ball Slams
20seconds light skipping on spot
(Repeat this combination 3 times and move on)

Light Sled Pushes (load 10 - 25% of bodyweight) x 5 sets

Optional (Agility Ladder Drills x5sets with 30 second active rest)

Single Leg
Double Leg
In In Out Out
2 Foot In 2 Foot Out Hops
Ali shuffles.

The sled pushes are scientifically **proven** to improve sprint speed.

The speed punches will increase your **punching speed** for sports such as boxing.

The agility ladder will increase your **foot speed**, and the jump squats will increase your **jump speed** for sports such as basketball.

Overall this workout will turn you into a very **capable** athlete.

You can also replace your Speed Cardio days with Sprints on a Treadmill or outside, as getting **faster** at sprints is a part of Speed Training.

## AG Power Cardio Day

Lots of athletes need Power training. You can start at one session per week if you do any type of sport and want to build a **powerful** body.

Here's an **effective** power session that will work for so many sports. It will increase your **vertical** jump, your punching, kicking, twisting and overall ability to **explode** and **rotate** your body through common sports movements:

Bodyweight Hopping 15 reps each stance (left foot forward then right foot forward)
Bodyweight Hopping Flying Knees 15 reps each stance.
Med Ball Knees x 6 reps each knee

Dumbell Hops x 6 reps left foot forward

Dumbell Hops x 6 reps right foot forward

Med Ball Twist Slams x 6 reps each side

Plank Leg Ups 8 - 10 reps per leg

Med ball uppercut 10 reps each stance
Kettlebell Rotational Swings 14 - 20 reps
Floor Squat Jumps x 6 reps
Plyometric Lunges x 12 reps
Roundhouse Kicks x 6 reps per leg 3 sets
Single Hand Dumbbell Bench Press 6 reps per arm.

For a **detailed** video of this workout, visit the AG4 YouTube Channel, for the video titled: “How To Increase Your Physical Power.”

I love to train Power cardio on my Power weight training days as I believe in having trait based days where my

clients give **100% effort** to one aim, instead of 50% effort or less to multiple different aims!

This Power Cardio workout has a lot of loaded explosive movements and a bit of **lifting** too, but it is so **fast paced** that it feels like cardio and will burn calories as such.

This is a session for **advanced** lifters and athletes and is not an every day session. Only carry it out 1 -2 times per week max.

Try and take as **little rest** between the exercises as you feel you can, to make the session more **cardio** based! Push yourself!

## Battle Ropes Power Cardio

This is best done **after** a shoulder focused push day. This is because the battle ropes really start to target your shoulder muscles, holding up the ropes works your shoulder **endurance** greatly.

With this workout we push our shoulders even **further** to failure within our cardio session even after already working them to **failure** in the weights session.

As your Shoulders are already **fatigued** from the weights, the ropes provide an extra level of fatigue and stress. You will squeeze out that **last bit of exhaustion** from your muscles.

This **painful** last squeeze in our workouts is usually when the **most growth** happens, because this is where

more muscle fibers are recruited and where more metabolic stress happens.

We want to increase metabolic stress in **new** and **exciting** ways, tire our muscles in new ways, and with **different** challenging intensities.

Therefore, this workout is the **Shoulder finisher**:

1kg Dumbbell Shoulder Presses +
1kg Explosive Dumbbell Shoulder Push Outs For 1 Minute.
Battle Rope Waves
Battle Rope Slams

For an example of this workout check out the Achieve Greatness YouTube, for the video titled “Battle Ropes Workout.”

## Zone 5 Cardio Focus

This is a form of High Intensity Interval Training. It is the most **intense**, and one of the more advanced cardio workouts on here.

When I trained on kickboxing camps in Thailand, this is the type of workout the fighters would do.

Zone 5 really pushes you to your **limit** like never before. It is good for athletes who need to perform well in situations where they need **short bursts of power**, which is the case in many sports.

The idea is that you take 15 seconds of working **as hard as you possibly can.** And then 30 seconds of active rest before the next interval. Then you repeat.

Some people will claim to do 30 seconds of max effort work, but I believe that when a person is truly going full force, the type where your coach is really screaming at you pushing you to your limit, it is hard to truly **maintain** true max effort for more than 15 seconds.

Actual truthful **max effort** is really hard, and therefore these sessions will not last for 30 minutes like the youTube "HIIT" videos.

They will last 15 minutes, where you will set a **timer** and go **max effort** into active rest for the whole time.

A sample workout could be:

Exercise bike 15 seconds **max effort**
Exercise bike 40 seconds **active rest** (pedalling very slowly)

However, my favorite version of this workout I find most effective is the modified kickboxing fight camp version.

You do **max effort** for 15 seconds on an Exercise Bike or Ski RG machine.

Then you go over to the punching bag, quickly put your gloves on, and throw a jab cross hook combo as hard and fast as you can for another 15 seconds.

Then you go back to the exercise bike and repeat. The little period where you take off the boxing gloves and walk between the machines counts as your **rest** interval.

Do this for 10 - 15 minutes and you will see **extremely good results** in your **athletic** ability.

You can of course **substitute** the boxing bag for other exercises relevant to your sport, but I find the above workout

great for anyone, it can really get you in the zone of pushing yourself because you hit your **lower body** with the Exercise Bike and then the **upper body** with the Boxing.

Something about this flow allows me to push people I train to their absolute limits. But this is **definitely** a workout for athletes that have a strong will to improve, as it is not easy at all!

Zone 5 is done at 90 - 95% intensity, beyond just HIIT where you go to **near** max effort, this is where you actually go to max effort, where you physically **think** you can't anymore, and then you push even **past** that!

If you feel your legs are tired before this day, you can switch out the Exercise Bike for the Ski RG machine and the Punch Bag for Battle Ropes.

## How To Progress Your Cardio Effectively

As you may have seen, I have more or less **ordered** these types of cardio by their difficulty.

In terms of an average progression, you could expect a beginner to start with some Zone 2 exercise sessions. Progressing **10 minutes** to **30 minutes** and then to **3 x 30 minute** sessions a week.

Intermediates may begin to use **intervals**, or try out some boxing, some sports and classes.

For most people even doing 5 half an hour sessions a week of general cardio is a massive **achievement** for themselves.

Some are happy to stay and **maintain** that level and others will want to take it **further**.

From here, you have the option to move onto **advanced** training like HIIT, Zone 5, Power and Speed Training, and Fartlek.

**Variety** is often the key to the enjoyment of cardio. I used to be a person that stayed on the punch bag for a year straight. I did exactly the same thing and it was **rewarding** to learn boxing, but I was sometimes **bored**.

There is so **much more** to cardio. Especially because our bodies get used to the same cardio sessions, we won't even **burn** the same calories once our bodies get **used** to a certain type of cardio session, so just like in weight training it is **good** to switch things up!

Don't be the person to just face the **same** wall, doing the **same** treadmill in the **same** gym! Find out what you love, experiment, and make cardio fun over all else.

I have given you many **types** of cardio in this section, in the hope that you may see there is a wide world out there.

Having such a variety can hopefully make you see that cardio is far from the **boring** "30 minutes on the treadmill" that you have to do every week.

I hope you can start to see it as fun, or at least **pair** cardio with something fun. When I am in the mood for a challenge, I love to do the Power, Speed or Zone 5 sessions with 100% focus.

When I am in the mood to learn something new and be intellectual, I love to practice **new combos** on my 6 rounds on the punch bags.

When I am in the mood to chill, I love to do stair climber or treadmill because I can go at a **steady pace** and watch my movies and TV.

When I want an **adventure** I will go on a hike or climb a mountain, or try a new sport.

Cardio is **great** and I want you to shift your mind into it not being a chore, or the "thing you have to do."

Because the moment you are able to view cardio as something you enjoy, you are able to find a **passion** for life that will always help you and reward you, in both body, mind and soul.

# AG4 Training Library

In the workouts in the programmes above, you will notice you are **encouraged** to select some exercise techniques from this library.

The techniques have been given **names** such as AG Lateral Raise Dropset. Or Triceps Buster 1. Or Triceps Buster 2.

Some workouts will tell you to select an Abs Day from this library or some supersets and further techniques.

This is the **library** that holds these techniques.

## AG4 Abs Days

## AG 6 Minute Abs Workout

30 seconds lying leg raises
30 seconds flutter kicks
30 seconds plank
30 seconds plank ups

Beginner - 1 round
Intermediate - 2 rounds
Advanced - 3 rounds

For an example of this workout search on the Achieve Greatness YouTube - 6 Minute Abs Workout.

## Abs 1 (Hypertrophy)

5 Minutes of Roman Chair Sit Ups
Abs Machine 3 Sets Of 20

## Abs 2 (Speed)

4 Sets Of 50 Crunches As Fast As You Can

Advanced version of Abs 2:

Decline Sit Ups 3 x failure
Ab Wheel Rollout 3 x failure
Speed Sit Ups As Fast As You Can 3 x failure

## Abs 3 (Bodyweight)

3 sets of 12 Leg Raises
5 L Sit attempts

## Abs 4 (Hypertrophy)

Decline Sit Ups with a weight plate until failure
Into Ab Wheel Rollouts until failure
Into Fitness Ball Sit Ups until failure
Perform 3 rounds.

## Abs 5

Hanging Leg Raises 3 Sets Of 12
Ab Wheel Rollouts 3 Sets Of 12

## Abs 6 (Explosive)

Decline Sit Ups Explosively Pushing A Barbell Into The Sky 3 Sets Of 12
Captains Chairs Leg Raises With A Dumbbell On Your Feet (until failure)

Go as **fast** as you can on the Captains Chair Leg Raises, do 5 repetitions and then try to **launch** the dumbbell out of your feet as far as you can each time. Then keep going until **failure**.

Picture each repetition as though you are trying to launch the dumbbell as far as you can. That is how you get **explosive** with this exercise.

For an example of this workout, see the video entitled “Explosive Decline Sit Ups” on the Achieve Greatness Youtube.

### Abs 7

Gravity Sit Ups 3 x failure
Stability Ball Sit Ups 3 x failure
Medicine Ball V Ups 1 x failure
Decline Sit Ups With BarBell Explosive 3 x failure
Abdominal Curl Machine 3 x 12

## Push Day AG4 Technique Library

### Triceps Mega Set

Start at the cable machines for the triceps pushdown, set it to head height.

Do 12 reps of tricep pushdown, then with **no break,** lower the weight and go straight into behind the head cable Tricep extensions for another 12 reps.

You don't need to **readjust** the height of the machine between exercises. After the behind the head extensions, walk straight to a bench to do your reverse tricep dips on the bench.

Do these until failure, then finally **go straight** to the machine triceps extension and do 12 reps with 2 second pauses at the bottom.

I hear some people say they never "feel" it in their triceps when they do normal exercises. If you use this **mega set**, you won't have that problem.

## Triceps Buster 1

Triceps Machine 3 x 15 reps into 3 x 15 behind head cable extensions. Into 3 x 15 single arm dumbbell extension and finally 3 x 15 standing dumbbell kickbacks.

## Triceps Buster 2

Triceps Machine SS Standing Dumbell Kickbacks. Do one path one session and one path the next session.

## AG Lateral Raises Dropset

Take a pair of dumbbells and do 15 repetitions of lateral raises. Once you get tired, wait 10 seconds, and pick up some slightly lighter dumbbells, and do 15 more repetitions. Repeat this for 3 sets.

# Leg Day AG4 Technique Library

## Calves Destroyer

This is the type of movement that you feel alright in during the moment. And then the next day you really feel it!

Machine 1: Seated Calve Raise Machine
Machine 2: Standing Calve Raise Machine
Machine 3: 45 Degree Leg Press Calve Raises
Free weight Exercise: Standing Dumbell Calve Raises

Hit all these machines **one after the other**! You don't even have to do more than one or two sets of each, as long as you squeeze the rep for 4 seconds at the top of the movement, and go slowly back down, the burn will add up by the end.

Aim to go to failure at around the 15th rep in each set.

## Booty Builder 3000

Go on the Hip Abduction Machine. Do **3 sets**. Your first set should be **normal form**. Your second set you should do **7 pulses** (partial reps) at the top of the movement.

You know the part where your legs are **furthest** out and really pushing against the pads?

This is the part that is the **hardest** part of the machine, and therefore it will get you a lot of growth. Do a set where you do 7 pulses at the top of your repetitions, for 10 repetitions.

In your last set, you will perform **static holds** at the top of the repetition, for 7 seconds. Hold it in place and then do more repetitions. For 10 repetitions total.

## Barbell Hip Thrust - Constant Tension Method

This works well for Barbell Hip Thrusts. Load the barbell with smaller plates.

This way there won't be a **gap** at the bottom of the movement where there is no tension.

The barbell will always be pressing against your legs and this will ensure a very hard set with **constant** time under tension.

Don’t use olympic bumper plates for this where a 5kg is the same height as a

20kg, use the **normal** weight plates and don't use plates larger than 10kg in your stack, because they will be too big to use this method.

You will need to **lower** the total weight that you usually use for your Barbell Hip Thrust, and this method works best when you do sets of 20.

It will **burn**, but the gains and time under tension you receive using this method will be worth it.

## 20 Reps Of Pain

This is one of those random techniques that I learned in the gym from overhearing a conversation.

I was in the gym and I heard a guy say to his friend: "are you good bro?" His friend replied: "No! I'm completely dying man, I just finished my leg day

with 20 reps in a row on the hack squat machine, I'm dead!"

After I heard him say this, I tried it myself on the end of all my leg days. I started with no weight at all, just the machine. It worked very well, even though I had to start low. Just do 1 set of 20 reps. Or more sets if you are brave enough...

## Pull Day AG4 Technique Library

### AG Military Dropset

I learned this from a military man. Take an EZ bar and do 15 repetitions. After this, drop off some weight plates, try to remove about **50%** of the weight, take

no rest and do another 15 repetitions. Do 3 sets of this.

Try and load the bar with **smaller** plates to make it easier to drop the weight by 50% each time. For example set 1 could be 10kg with a bunch of 2.5kg plates, and then set 2 you would drop off a plate from **each side**, leaving the weight on each side halved and weighing 5kg.

## Forearm Finisher 1

Do Barbell Reverse Curls, and then pick up a lighter barbell and do Wrist Curls forwards and backwards whilst holding the weight out in front of you.

Do one single Wrist Curl forwards and then one backwards, and do this repeatedly until it burns and you fail. Do 3 sets of the Reverse Curls into the Wrist Curls.

# AG Back Tri Set

A real **time saver**. Start in a rack and perform Barbell rows for 10–12 reps.

Then, lift just **one end** of the same barbell with the weight still on it for T-bar rows and hit 15 reps without **changing** the weight or **resting**.

Finish with One-Arm Dumbbell Rows, 12 reps per arm, placing your free hand on the nearby rack for support.

It's a **quick** way to train your back with **three** exercises without leaving the rack.

Alternatively: go from Barbell Rows → Standing Dumbbell Rows → Inverted Bodyweight Rows on a racked bar (chest height, knees bent) for a fast, effective sequence.

# Pull Ups Improvement Protocol

In terms of Pull Ups, many people struggle with feeling like progress is **steady**. Pull ups can be less **forgiving** in terms of progress because they are a very demanding lift to perform and recover from.

They involve a lot of muscles, and on **one day** you can get 15 whilst the **next** you can get 12.

Other lifts tend to be more **consistent**, and with Pull Ups I find that your programming makes all the difference. There are simply so many days that you won't perform your **best** on the standard 3 x 12 of Pull Ups.

Most people just end the exercise here for the day here and call it a bad day. Maybe they go to **arms** to finish.

But I found it's the people that decide to hit the extra **angles**, and who work some **creative** assistance exercises afterwards who tend to grow **consistently** in this area.

Pull ups are a main, **compound** lift for your back. Once you treat Pull Ups like the main lift you want to improve on in your Back and Pull Day, you will make more progress.

Focusing on machines like rows and lateral pulldowns will get you a **stronger** back, but they will get your body more **used** to machines.

You won't increase your **bodyweight** Pull Ups fast without dedicating Pull Up focused sessions.

This is why I always start my Pull Day workouts with Pull Ups. If you have a day where you are not hitting your 3 sets of Pull Ups for at least 3 sets of 8 - 12, then use **resistance bands** to help get you there.

I find that calisthenics athletes have strong pull ups, because they spend **time** on the bar, not just **machines**.

They would rather do **another** set of Pull Ups, and then **banded** Pull Ups when they can't do anymore regular Pull Ups, and then **negatives** when they can't do any more band pull ups, and then **isometric** holds.

What I am saying is they would rather do another set of Pull Ups, hitting different angles, tempos and styles rather than focus on going straight to the **machines** after the first set. This is why they have **high numbers** on this lift.

So focus on Wide Pull Ups, Normal Pull Ups, Chin Ups, Commando Pull Ups, Muscle Ups, Chest To Bar Pull Ups, slow reps, banded reps, isometric holds, jumping negatives.

Go for 100 rep sessions on the assisted machine. Push your body to failure in many **different** ways and then you will see growth.

**Isometric holds** are what really jumped up my reps. I did them after every pullup session and added 2 reps the first few weeks then 1 a week for a while.

The rest times were sometimes quite high for my bodyweight pull ups - 3 to 4 minutes. My weighted pull ups were around 5 minutes.

Breathe **in** on the way down, breathe **out** on the way up. Grip the bar tight. This will activate more forearms and the smaller extensor muscles to assist you.

I like my first set to be **unassisted** and I just go for as many as I can.

Then I can do **weighted** 3 x 8... until the 8 turns into 12. And then continue to up the weight when it does.

After this I can hit a few **different grips**, banded or assisted machine, some iso holds and then onto the **rest** of the back day.

## Advanced Training Systems

Welcome to the Advanced Training Systems! Once you have been training for a **few months** to a year, you will see in my intermediate and advanced programmes section that I ask you to pick a few of these **training systems** to use in your workouts.

I'm going to give you both the **techniques** and the **exercises** the techniques work best on. These are

taken not just from my own coaching experience, but techniques from bodybuilding **champions** and 20x champion producing **international** coaches.

## Why Use Advanced Training Systems?

People ask me what makes a **successful** bodybuilding session.

You should ideally have **progressed** some compound lifts in the amount of sets, repetitions or weight used.

You should always find ways to make each session more **intense** than the last, by using **variety** to tear the body in new ways.

When you do this successfully, you should feel a **pump**, this is an indicator

that you have worked yourself to a reasonable level and shocked the body enough.

You can pretty much feel that you have worked the muscle enough when you have a pump. It's very **apparent**. Yes some people say that you can still gain without a pump, and that may be **true**.

But it is a good indicator of growth. I like to simply **progress the numbers** of my main compound lifts for the day, and then focus on the **pump** for my isolation exercises. I like to do **both**.

The science still remains that taking each set to failure, for natural lifters, is the most efficient way to grow. And the pump is a solid indicator you have taken things to failure.

You can simply feel that you have ripped your muscle in many different

ways and to the maximum for maximum growth.

You should leave the session satisfied that you have **thoroughly** worked your body.

If you don't "feel it" for multiple sessions in a row? I guess if your lifts are still going up each week, I can't say you are in a **terrible** spot!

But it does **indicate** that you could be pushing harder for maximum growth. Especially for advanced lifters, you can only make progress for so long until you need more variety and stimulus.

The pump is a **sign** that you are training in a style that is **supporting** prolonged fibre tension (especially if you are able to maintain a pump throughout your workout it signals you are good at keeping your fibres under constant tension.)

It also signals high motor unit recruitment, and local fatigue, or to put it **simply** without the big language, it signals you know how to train your body in a way that will cause a **lot** of growth.

Knowing how to train your body for growth is actually very important, beginners can get by on **standard** progression programmes, even those that do performance enhancing drugs can too, but **advanced** natural lifters will simply need to learn how to really shock the body to progress.

With the AG4 Advanced Training Techniques, I can always find a way to "feel it" and feel like I have **worked** my muscles to failure after a session.

Not everyone has made these discoveries...

I want to arm you with the many different training systems I use with my clients that will allow you to feel that pump and continue progressing your training.

Use these methods and **combine** them with taking multiple sets to failure within your programme, failing within the 8 - 12 rep range for 3 to 4 sets.

Combined with a **good diet** and a good cardio session that day, you will **grow** no doubt.

## Running The Rack / Stripping Method

This was a **technique** that Arnold Schwarzenegger talked about in his book: “The Encyclopedia Of Modern Bodybuilding.”

In this method, you start on the Dumbbell rack at a **heavy** weight and lift the weight until you can't anymore.

Move down the rack to the next set of dumbbells that are a **little lighter**. Lift these until failure.

Go all the way down the rack lifting lighter and lighter dumbbells until you finish the very **lowest** weight on the rack.

You can also use the Stripping Method on the Barbell Bench Press or Squat where **2 friends** stand either side of the bar and take off weight plates from

each side when you reach failure so you can do more weights. Keep **stripping** weights until you are left with just the bar! Then do 20 reps of just the bar!

The best exercises for this are:

Dumbbell Shoulder Press (Run The Rack)
Arnold Press (Run The Rack)
Lateral Raises (Run The Rack)
Bench Press (Stripping Method)
Machines where your partner can pull out the pin and lower the weight.
EZ Bar Curl
Bent Over Barbell Row
Cable Row
Leg Curls

Do the Stripping Method or Running The Rack on your last set not your first set.

## Partial Reps

This is where you do **partial** repetitions around the **bottom 25%** of the rep only. They are great at the end of a set to really burn you out.

They are almost like mini "bounces."

These work well on:

The Bottom Of The Bench Press
The Bottom Of The Bench Press Machine
The Bottom Of The Shoulder Press Machine
The Bottom Of The Leg Press Machine
The Bottom Of The Leg Extension Machine
The Top Of The Hip Abductor Machine
The Bottom Of Front Raises
The Bottom Of Cable Front Raises
The Bottom Of Lateral Raises
The Top Of The Lying Leg Curl Machine

You can do around **3 partials** per rep for the **last set** of an exercise.

## Negatives

This is where you take an exercise like the Barbell Curl and your partner uses their hand to **help** you lift the weight to the top of the repetition.

Then your partner lets go of the weight and you simply do the **negative** portion of the repetition. You can do a whole set like this, or just the last 5 repetitions or so.

Especially with Bicep Curls where the most growth happens in the **negative** portion of the lift, this is a good technique to use.

Most people in the gym when they have a partner don't make use of them or get

in the habit of **asking for help**, but once you learn to ask for help you can **supercharge** your workouts with techniques such as this.

## Static Holds / Pause Reps

This is where you **pause** your weight at the top of the movement and hold it there without moving at all.

You resist against gravity and feel the muscle working. The best times to make use of these include times where there is a lot of **tension** on the muscle. You can do these on every repetition in a set.

Including:

Bottom Of A Squat (4 Seconds)
Bottom Of The 45 Degree Leg Press Machine (4 Seconds)

Bottom Of Lateral Pulldown Machine (4 Seconds)
Top Of Leg Extension Machine
Top Of Any Calves Movement (Squeeze)
Top Of Cable Lateral Raises (5 Seconds)
Top Of Shoulder Press Machine (4s)
Bottom Of Bench Press (4 Seconds)

Typically I would do these for every rep of a set, or at the last rep of a set.

## Isometric Holds

These are like Static Holds, but I picked some holds that work especially well that you can hold for **longer** periods of time.

Do them at the very **end** of your **last set**, once you have hit failure. These are single or double use only. Do not do these for 10 repetitions straight.

**Lateral Raises** - Raise the dumbells 5 inches away from your thighs and **hold** them there for a minimum of 30 seconds until failure, resisting gravity.

**Chin Ups** - Pull yourself only 5 inches up towards the bar from the dead hanging position only, and then hold there for 10 seconds in the bottom half of the movement.

**Multi Stage Pull Ups Isometric Hold** - Pull yourself up so your chin clears the bar, and hold this position first with the bar at chin height for 10 seconds.

Then, drop down a little and perform another hold with the bar at **forehead** height, for 10 seconds. Then drop down to **normal** hangs and hold for a final 10 seconds.

**Front Raises** - When you hit failure, grab a lower weight and hold at the top of a front raise for 30 seconds minimum.

## Pre Exhausting

This is where you hit an ***isolation*** lift first and then a ***compound*** lift. You use the pre-exhaustion technique when you feel like other muscles are taking over and failing first in your compound lifts.

Essentially other muscles taking over and failing **first** mean that you cannot work your target muscle to failure.

For example, the Biceps can give out **first** before the Back in Lateral Pulldowns.

The Triceps can give out **before** the Chest in Bench Pressing or Shoulder Pressing.

In this case, if we **wear out** our target muscle with an isolation exercise first, it becomes more likely to be worked to complete **failure** in our compound.

Do 3 sets of this technique. Do the isolation first, and then the compound.

Take ***no rest*** between the isolation and the compound lift! But, wait one minute each between your 3 repetitions of this technique.

Some common examples of the **Pre Exhaust** technique are:

Dumbell Fly Into Bench Press
Leg Extension Into Squats
Lateral Raise Into Shoulder Press
Dumbell Pullover Into Lat Pulldown

## Post Exhausting

This is where you hit a muscle with a ***compound*** first and then an ***isolation*** second.

The idea is to hit the muscle with the strong compound lift first, but some other muscles may fail in this compound lift before your **target** muscle.

So then you zone in on it like a **sniper** and finish it off with an **isolation exercise** that precisely targets the muscle.

Different combinations of Pre and Post exhausting work better on particular exercises and machines.

For **Post Exhausting** you can try:

Cable Row x Bent Over Rear Delt Dumbell Fly

(The biceps and forearms usually fatigue first on the Cable Row, so the Rear Delt DB Fly can help focus towards the upper back muscles more)

Cable Row x Cable Pulldown
(The biceps and forearms again fatigue before we work the back fully, so the pulldowns help work the overall back more)

Leg Press Machine x Leg Extension
(The quads sometimes don't reach full fatigue because the glutes and hamstrings assist, so finishing with leg extensions allows the quads to be fully targeted)

## Matrix Sets

You may hear these referred to as '21's'. With Matrix Sets, you split up your set into **different ranges** of motion.

Start by doing your set with 7 partial repetitions of only the **bottom 50%** of the movement. Then, with no rest you hit the **upper 50%** of the movement. Finally, with no rest taken, you hit the **full**, **100%** range of motion for 7 reps, giving you a total of "21" repetitions.

You can do this for **one set** or **all** of your sets.

Matrix training works well with any Biceps Curl exercise, whether that be with dumbells, barbells, machines or cables.

It also works really well for **Lateral Raises**, get someone to hold out their hands so that their hands stop you from going any **higher** than the first 50% of the movement.

Then, after 7 repetitions, get their hands to **block you** from coming down any lower than the top 50% of the movement. Do 7 more partial repetitions in this upper range.

Then, for the final 7 repetitions, they **remove** their hands as a barrier, and you can do 7 full repetitions.

The Machine Row for your Back is also a great machine to use this technique on.

## Super Sets

Supersets hit two ***different*** exercises in a row, with no break in between. These sets can work the same muscle (agonist supersets) or different muscles. (complex supersets).

Working two ***different muscles*** for supersets tends to be easier for ***beginners.*** It is more time efficient and improves your stamina to do multiple sets at once.

***Same muscle superset***s (agonist supersets) are tolerated better by intermediate and ***advanced*** lifters. Same muscle supersets can give you some epic growth!

***Some*** of my favorite supersets are:

Bicep Blast - Bicep Curl Machine 12 reps into EZ Bar Curl 21s.

Bicep Blast 2 - DB Hammer Curls 12 reps into Bicep Curl Machine 12 reps

Rear Delts Blast - Rear Delts Fly into Standing Bent Over Dumbbell Skis.

Shoulder Press x Lateral Raises

Dumbbell Shoulder Press x Barbell Shoulder Press

## Tri - Sets

3 exercises one after the other with no rest. My favorites include:

AG Shoulders Tri Set -

Shoulder Press Machine 12 Reps into
Plate Front Raises 15 Reps into
Barbell Upright Row 10 Reps

AG Triceps Tri Set -

Triceps Cable Pushdown
Triceps Cable Extension
Triceps Dumbbell Extension

AG Traps Tri Set -

Dumbbell Shrugs
Upright Row
Behind The Back Barbell Shrugs

AG Back Tri Set -

Barbell Row
T - Bar Row
One Arm Dumbell Row

This one is a **time saving technique** I use on back day. Position yourself in a rack. Start with your barbell row. Hit 10 - 12 reps on this exercise.

Then pick up one side only of the same barbell and use it as a T - Bar row.

As you are only lifting one half of the barbell, you can do **more** repetitions than before. Therefore, hit 15 repetitions of this exercise.

Then take a **dumbbell** that you keep nearby, and use the nearby surface of the rack to rest your hands against, and perform one-arm dumbbell rows for 12 reps each arm.

This is a really fast way to hit **3 different** back exercises rapidly on a busy day in the gym, and all you need to do is to stay within **1 rack.**

As an **alternative** to this technique, you can also do a Standing Barbell Row, straight into a Standing Dumbbell Row, straight into an Inverse Bodyweight Row on a barbell racked in a rack, at about chest height, with your knees bent for a lower and more challenging angle.

AG Chest Tri Set -

I learned this one in my Personal Training school. Set up **two** benches, one flat or decline, and one incline.

Hit the flat / decline bench first with a DB Bench Press, then hit the Incline DB Bench Press, before finally hitting the Incline DB Fly.

Get at least 8 - 10 repetitions for each set in the superset. Don't put **new** clients through this system!

## Giant Sets

These are supersets with **4 or more** exercises. You take **no rest** apart from the travelling between the machines and hammer each set to failure.

My favorites include:

Triceps -

Triceps Cable Pushdown
Triceps Cable Extension
Triceps Bench Dip
Dumbell Tricep Extension
Dumbell Kickback

Traps -

Dumbbell Shrugs
Upright Row
Behind The Back Barbell Shrugs
Farmers Carry

**Giant sets** increase **time under tension** to the maximum, when we do supersets we are limited to only 2 sets and we usually fatigue **fast** on them.

**Giant sets** mean we can keep switching to easier exercises when we fatigue, keeping the **tension** on the muscle for a lot longer!

## Drop Sets

Drop sets are used when you get to your **last set** for an exercise. Let's say you do 3 sets of 12.

On your last set, aim for the 12 reps. You are now going to perform 3 **drops.** With **no rest,** drop the weight instantly by 10% for lower body and 5% for upper

body. Hit 8-10 reps of this new weight and drop the weight again. Do this 3 times.

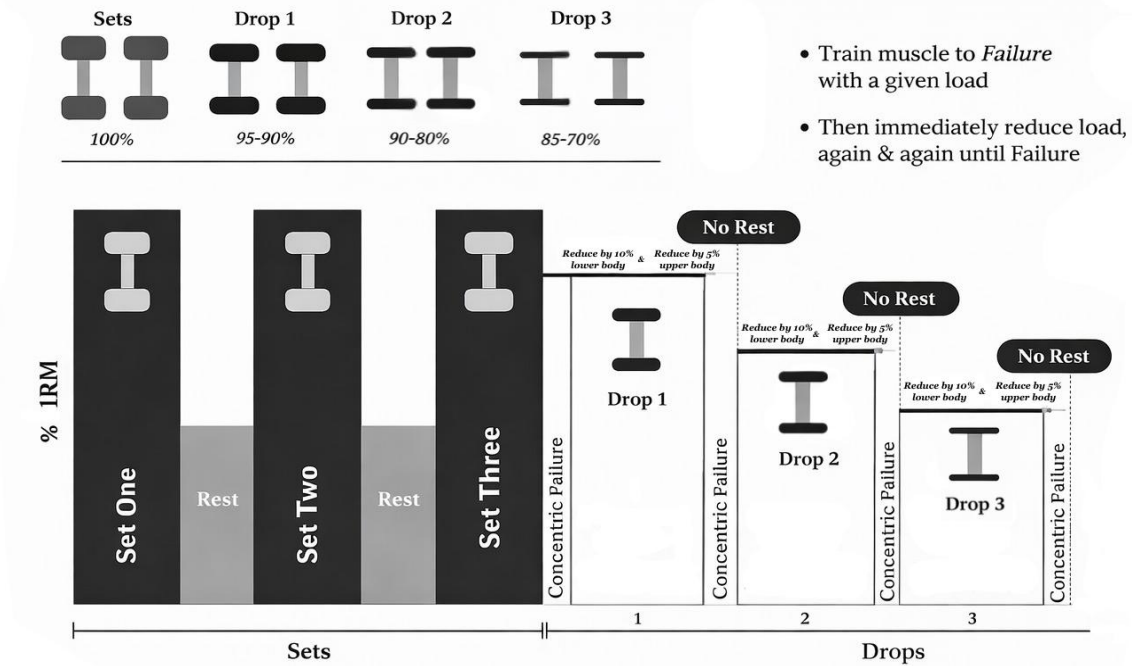
Try to get 8 - 10 reps each **drop**, but don't worry if you don't get 10, because you can expect to see a decrease of around 2 reps per drop. By the **last** drop you should be getting around 6 - 8 reps if you started at 12 reps.

Drop Sets work **well** on **cable machines**, such as on Tricep Cable Extensions, and Bicep Cable Curls. They also work well for Dumbbell exercises such as Hammer Curls.

If you line up 3 pairs of dumbbells in a row from **heavy** to **light**, on your last set you can simply hit each pair of dumbbells until failure.

On the next page, I will include a **diagram** of Drop Sets so you can execute them correctly.

# DROP SETS


Sets
Drop 1
Drop 2
Drop 3
100%
95-90%
90-80%
85-70%
• Train muscle to *Failure* with a given load
• Then immediately reduce load, again & again until Failure
% 1RM
Set One
Rest
Set Two
Rest
Set Three
No Rest
Reduce by 10% lower body & Reduce by 5% upper body
Drop 1
Concentric Pailure
No Rest
Reduce by 10% lower body & Reduce by 5% upper body
Drop 2
Concentric Pailure
No Rest
Reduce by 10% lower body & Reduce by 5% upper body
Drop 3
Concentric Pailure
1
2
3
Sets
Drops

## Forced Reps

During Forced Repetitions, you will exercise with a weight you can do for about 8 - 12 reps until failure.

Once within this range, when you do fail, your partner is going to **help you** get 3 - 5 extra repetitions where they **assist**.

If you want to explain this process to someone who is new to forced reps, you can tell them:

*"I'm just going to initiate forced reps on the last few reps so your body can experience that volume and adapt to it."*

Explain the **benefits** that by **working together**, you can achieve a greater workout and **pump** to your muscles.

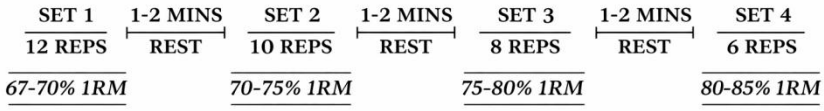
Forced Reps are great on the Chest Press Machine, the Dumbell Shoulder Press and Dumbell Lateral Raises.

## Pyramid Training

Pyramid Training is where you take a weight and slowly pyramid up or down in the amount you lift, over the course of 4 sets.

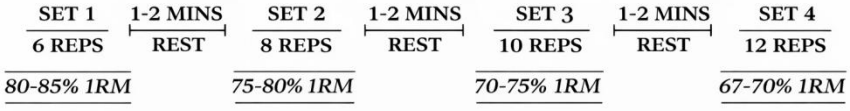
We can use both **ascending** or **descending** pyramids. Pyramids are good for hitting multiple rep ranges, for example on your “heavy days” you can use a **pyramid** to start in the 6 rep range and work your way into the 10 and 12 ranges after.

## ASCENDING PYRAMID




*(I like to use an ascending pyramid on the squat, the benefits of an ascending pyramid is you can do a heavier weight whilst being safely warmed up from the previous sets)**

## DESCENDING PYRAMID




*(I like to use descending pyramids on my incline dumbbell presses on my heavy push days to get some work in the heavy ranges whilst still focusing on bodybuilding)**

## Power - Eccentrics

This requires a **training partner**. On average, our body can lift **20% more** weight in the eccentric (lowering the weight) portion of the lift. We can use this to our **advantage**. Especially on our heavy days.

In this technique, ***use 120%*** of your 1rep maximum.

Go **really** heavy, 120% is a **massive** amount for you to lift, so get someone to **help you** with the concentric (raising the weight) and then they let you handle the eccentric, **lowering** the weight for 3 - 5 seconds, for 3-5 reps, and 3-5 sets.

I can show you where to use this training method:

With Pull Ups, you can get someone to push you up to the top of the bar, and let you **lower** yourself slowly back down.

On the Lateral Pulldown machine, you can get someone to help you pull the bar **down** to your chest, and then you slowly **raise** the bar back up for 3 - 5 seconds.

On the DB Shoulder Press, get someone to push the weight **up** under your elbows, until it is fully raised, and then you slowly **lower** the weight for 3 - 5 seconds.

On the Leg Extension Machine, get a partner to **pull** the weight up by holding the roller pad with hands on each side. Then you handle the **lowering** of the weight.

Do these **eccentrics** as SLOW as you can for maximum blood pumped into the muscle.

You will **definitely** feel a pump and soreness the next day if you do this method correctly.

Eccentrics are an **advanced** version of Forced Reps where you go extremely heavy and only focus on the **eccentric** portion of the repetition.

You also only do 5 repetitions. With Forced Reps you would do 10 repetitions to failure and **then** Forced Reps, with a weight that is a lot more **manageable** and focusing on squeezing all areas of the lift, not just the negative.

## Negatives

This is not the same as the Power Eccentrics technique, where you only do 5 repetitions per set at **120%** of your 1 rep max.

With Negatives, you take a weight you can do 10 - 12 reps with, and once you hit **failure** at those reps, your **partner** will lift the weight up for you, and allow you to handle just the negative portion of the lift for a further 3 - 5 repetitions.

It is like Forced Reps, but your partner handles the concentric portion of the lift and leaves only the **negative** portion of the lift to be done by you.

You focus on slowly bringing the weight down, for 3 - 5 seconds, and your partner will bring it back up.

This works great with Rope Cable Hammer Curls and the Bench Press.

## Power Reps

You can perform sets of 1-4reps. For 4-5 sets. Power reps are simply very heavy powerful lifts.

Another way of doing this in a more **bodybuilding** fashion is explosive strength reps.

You take a weight you can **usually** do 10 reps with, lower it normally, pause at the bottom for a second, then explode up.

You will **only** be able to get around 7 reps if you do the rep with the pause in this style.

It is not strictly **Power**, due to the rep range, but the pausing and exploding at such a heavy load (your 10 rep max) it still works strength and power, and slight bodybuilding too.

## High Rep Training

There are a few specific lifts where **high repetitions** work well for. High Rep Calisthenics can give you great results in **building muscle** fast.

High repetition **Dips** in sets of 50 for example are very effective at growing the Lower Chest.

High Repetition **Push Ups** can also work in sets of 30 - 50.

High repetition Pull Ups will get you a massive back if you have the strength and endurance to be **consistent** with them.

And finally high repetition **Cable Flys** of around 35 reps have been used as a finisher by professional **bodybuilders** to pump a lot of blood into the chest.

## 1 - 10 Method

After a **warm up** set or two, find a weight where you are only able to get 1 rep. Then pick up a weight you can only get 2 reps. From there, do the same for 3 reps and then 4 reps. Repeat this pattern going all the way to 10.

The only rest you get is when you are unloading and adjusting the weights.

## 5 Count Method

This is where you lower the weight for a count of **5 seconds**. Simply slow down the motion. It works really **well** on Leg Extensions, Shoulder Press Machines, EZ Bar Barbell Curls, and Lying Lateral Raises.

If you have a set of 3, do one **normal** set, one set of **partials** or **paused repetitions**, and one set of **slow repetitions**. I like to

do the slow repetitions last or as the **middle** set as I find that gives a great pump.

## Super 28 Method

This is like the 21s method in the matrix sets section on steroids. The **order** is slightly different.

You do 7 **full** reps, 7 **slow** reps(really slow up and down) 7 **top half** reps, and then finish with 7 **bottom** reps. It works great for the Biceps Curl exercises.

## German Volume Training (GVT)

German Volume Training is a style of training that is better placed into your programme **once every 4 - 5 weeks** or so.

I don't programme GVT every session, as it can be **time consuming** and

**exhausting** to do 10 sets of the same compound exercise in a row.

Some athletes train in this manner, but I have found more growth from **occasional use** of the technique.

For the **average person**, recovery from 10 sets of the same compound exercise will be an **issue** in the coming days.

Therefore, use German Volume Training as an **occasional** "shock" to the system. I like to use it with the Bench Press to occasionally replace a Push Day.

## Bench Press GVT Push Day -

Do 10 sets of your **compound** exercise (Bench Press) with a 1 minute rest in between.

Go for **10 repetitions** in your earlier sets, then expect a slight reduction of repetitions in the later sets.

Always aim to get a **minimum** of 6 repetitions, which you can expect to get in the final few sets.
This is because your **strength** will naturally drop off. An example repetition structure would be: 10 10 10 9 9 8 8 7 6 6.

After 10 sets of your **compound** lift, take 1 minutes rest, and hit 3 sets of your isolation lift.

Your **isolation** lift is light Incline Dumbbell Flies (which is an isolation related to the compound lift)

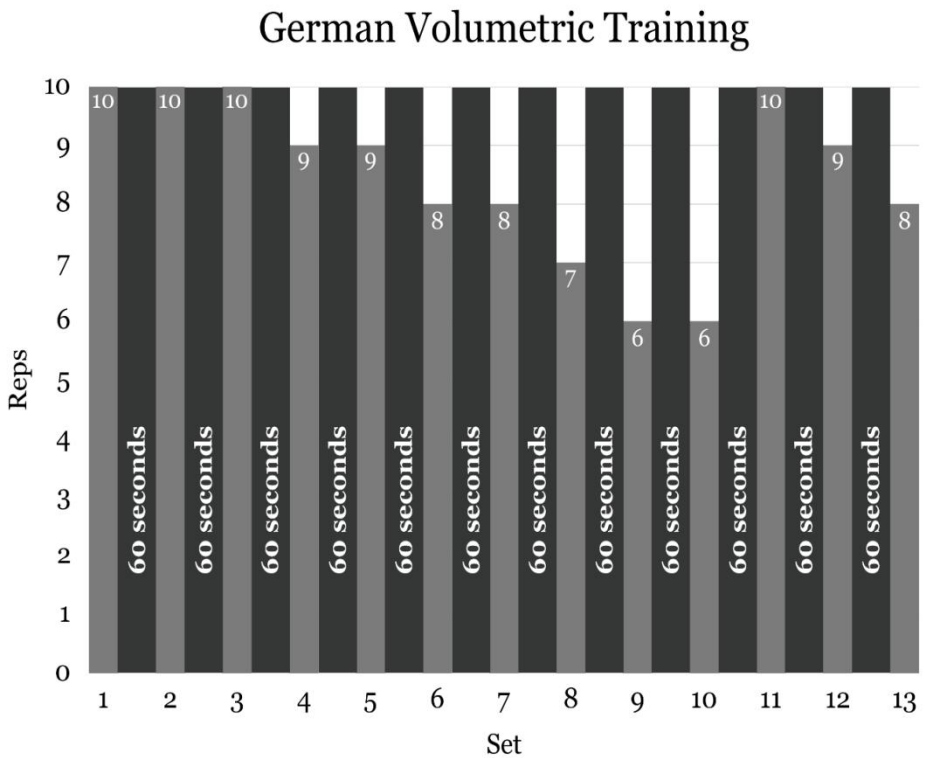
Aim for 12 reps each, but again expect to see drop offs. For example:

Set 1 - 12 reps
Set 2 - 10 reps

Set 3 - 8 reps

**Track** your numbers, and **repeat** the workout every 4 weeks under the same conditions. Once all **compound** sets reach 10 reps and all **isolations** reach 12 reps, you up the weight.

This portion of the workout should take around **25 minutes**.




**Used For:**

- Hypertrophy
- Volume
- Conditioned Clients
- Plateau Buster
- Isolation Exercise 67-70% 1rm
- Compound Exercise 70% 1rm

After GVT is **complete**, you may move on to some of the other lifts present in your Push Day.

## AG GVT Push Day -

Bench Press - 10 Sets GVT
Incline Dumbell Fly - 3 Sets GVT
Machine Shoulder Press 3 x 12
Triceps Cable Pushdown 3 x 12
5 Minutes Of Crunches

*(This method of training should be used by **advanced** and confident lifters.)**

## Figure of 8 Method

This advanced training method is for your **Abs**. When you lie on the floor, **raise** your feet off the ground, and start

to draw the number 8 sideways with your legs, without them touching the ground.

In this case the 8 you are drawing with your legs is like a sideways 8, or an **infinity** symbol: ∞

Do this very slowly, taking around 12 seconds to complete the full figure of 8. Keep repeating this movement until you can no longer hold your legs up.

## Pause Reps

Pause Reps are very **effective** to increase time under tension.

I find them to be **effective** in the bottom portion of a Wide Bench Press for 4 seconds, or the bottom of a Wide Push Up for 4 seconds.

This **stretches** and applies **focus** to the **outer** part of your Chest muscles, the part which connects your Lower Chest to under your armpit, which looks very **aesthetic** for male lifters.

I also find Pause Reps to be effective for 4 seconds at the **top** of a Pull Up, or the **bottom** of a Lateral Pulldown machine. Really fight to hold your repetitions here to feel the **squeeze** on your back.

Finally, watch a few training videos from the trainer Hany Rambod, training bodybuilders using his **FST7** method.

You will notice that if he gives 3 sets of an exercise, **at least one** set is usually taken to failure using Partials, or Forced Reps (techniques I mentioned above) and in at least one set he nearly always uses **Pause Reps**.

This is usually done on the **very last** repetition of a set. Hany will get his

lifter to pause the weight at the hardest part of the movement, at the peak of the repetition, when they are already exhausted, and get them to **pause** it there even though they can barely pause it for a single second.

Then he will tell them to resist the weight on the way down as they slowly **fight** against it coming down, for a period of around 4- 8 seconds. This technique is **excellent** for going to complete and absolute **failure**.

Pause Repetitions can be done on the last repetition, but also for every rep of a set for 4 seconds each repetition.

## Old School Bodybuilding Secrets

In this section I am going to cover the **secrets** of the **old school** bodybuilders.

The older generation of bodybuilders had a **classic shape** to them which we can learn a lot from.

The old school guys were not just strong, but they **competed** year after year, and are always releasing books with their techniques.

These people are not just people who got strong **once** for a photoshoot, but **consistently** for a lifetime.

They have **more years** in the game than most of us, and even if science has come a long way, and some techniques and modern science has been improved upon, their techniques are **not** to be taken lightly.

Taking the advice of someone who has built a great body for **multiple competitions** for multiple years consistently, is wise and is advice **worth** listening to.

The reason I like to apply these old school techniques is because the AG Program is based around building a great looking **natural** body.

Even though drugs have always been involved in bodybuilding competitions, I feel the modern bodybuilders take things too far and are on a **cocktail** of drugs.

For creating a **great** looking **natural** body you simply cannot train in the same way that someone would if they were on drugs.

I like to use the techniques that Arnold Schwarzenegger used & **documented** in his books, especially the workouts he used to use as a **teenager** and in his early years.

You can see he built some natural looking mass in the early days, and I

find his principles to be in line with how a body **naturally** grows.

I tend to reduce all my **set amounts** down to the amount that would suit a **natural** lifter and not a competition bodybuilder.

It is a lot better to use a training system such as the AG4 System when you are trying to build a natural body, or systems used by bodybuilders who compete in **natural** drug tested competitions, to get a better idea of the reality.

If you listen to the standard advice of a drug taking modern bodybuilder telling you to: “do 7 sets of each exercise” you will soon burn out!

I take a lot of inspiration from the **supersets** and **training systems** used by old school bodybuilders, and apply it to

**natural** bodybuilding with less sets in my programmes, and it works wonders.

## Arnold Workouts

These workouts are taken directly from the books and works of Arnold Schwarzenegger himself with some minor **adjustments** to suit natural lifters.

These workouts allowed me to add a great **shape** to my body. If the workouts in your programme are looking like the ones below, you can tell your on the right track to an aesthetic body.

This section is going to give you an idea of how the old school bodybuilders trained, as documented by a **champion**.

## Arnold's Home Workout

This is the **home** bodyweight workout Arnold recommended in his biography book.

He actually recommended that a beginner should train with this workout first for a few months, before going to the gym and loading the body with weights.

This is a **home** workout that Arnold claimed got him his base size and flexibility as a teenager before he started going to the gym to use machines.

Arnold claims that if you successfully complete the workout below and build yourself up to reach the repetition amounts stated in the program, you can actually add a reasonable amount of size to your body with **just** the basics.

If you are in need of a home workout programme that still **builds size**, this can be very useful.

**Equipment needed:**

**Two chairs** - to create a parallel surface for the dips.
**A broom** - to use as a bar, slotted in between two chairs for body rows. To use behind your back for the body broom twists.
**A chin up bar** - to connect to your doorframe for chin ups.
In terms of **home workouts**, this would be a great home workout for a beginner to progress through.

What Arnold says about working out through bodyweight exercises first, in order to get **stable** and **flexible** joints before loading up weights in the gym, is actually a reasonable path to follow.

Chin Ups on the bar do tend to be hard for beginners, so I would recommend a set of **resistance bands** to assist you.

PUSH UPS x 50 beg 100 int 150 adv

DIPS BETWEEN CHAIRS 5 x 20

HORIZONTAL BODY ROW WITH BROOM BETWEEN CHAIRS 50 total

SIT UPS WITH LEGS PINNED DOWN 200 TOTAL

BENT LEG RAISES 50 TOTAL
BENT OVER BROOM TWISTS 50 TOTAL

SQUATS 70 REPS

CALF RAISES 50 REPS

CLOSE GRIP BICEP CHIN UPS 30 TOTAL

## Arnold's 3 X A Week Full Body Workout

(From his book the education of a bodybuilder)

This is also a workout that Arnold said got him a lot of size as a teenager. This was a time when gyms were very **basic** in terms of equipment.

If you look at photos of Arnold as a teenager, he was already extremely well built.

The old school bodybuilders got very big off of the basic compound movements, dumbbell flys, and basic machines available at the time.

If you are a person that plays other **sports**, and you do not have time to bodybuild 4-7 days a week, then this kind of programme would be a **great**

start for you, allowing you to go to the gym 3 times a week, hitting the basic old school **compound** movements.

In my opinion, this programme has a few **missing** elements, such as Dumbbell Flys, and Lateral Raises.

These would help grow and shape the chest and shoulders a little more. The trap muscles are also not being hit in this workout.

It may be worth looking into learning this workout **first** as a beginner, and then **supersetting** some **isolations** with some of the **compound** lifts.

For example: you could hit Dumbbell Flys alongside your Bench Presses, and Lateral Raises alongside your Military Presses.

BENCH PRESS 8 8 6 6 6
WIDE GRIP CHINS 3 x 10 (or 30 total)

MILITARY PRESS 3 x 10
BARBELL CURL 3 x 10
FRENCH PRESS 3 x 10
SQUATS 3 x 10
LEG CURLS 3 x 10
CALVES MACHINE 5 x 15
DECLINE SIT UPS 3 x 50
WRIST CURL 3 x 10

**Arnold's 3X A Week Full Body (AG version)**

This is the AG Training version of the above workout, with a more **complete** coverage of the traps muscles, the rear and side delts, and total coverage of the abdominal muscles)

BENCH PRESS 8 8 6 6 6 (Superset with dumbell flys)
WIDE GRIP CHINS 3 x 10 (or 30 total)

MILITARY PRESS 3 x 10 x Superset with lateral raises)
BARBELL CURL 3 x 10 (Superset with AG Traps Giant Set)
FRENCH PRESS 3 x 10
REAR DELT MACHINE 3 x 15
SQUATS 3 x 10
LEG CURLS 3 x 10
DECLINE SIT UPS 3 x 50 OR
BACK EXTENSIONS 3 x 12

For this workout, each day you **alternate** your abs exercise. Perform Decline Sit Ups one day, and Back Extensions the next.

This lets you hit both the front and back side of your core for **equal development**.

You can use **weight plates** to **progress** both core exercises. The substitutions made to this workout will develop your full body in most of the **aesthetic** areas, whilst giving less **priority** to areas such as Calves.

## Chest Day - Beginner Arnold Workout

Flat Barbell Bench Press - 5 Sets
(12,12,10, 8, 6 reps)
Incline Barbell Bench
(12 - 15 reps, 5 sets)
Weighted Dips
(3 x 15)
Dumbell Flys
(25 reps, 10 reps, 10 reps)

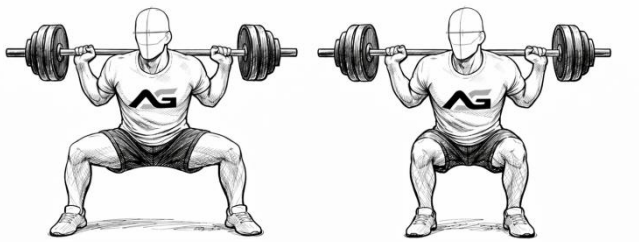
## Arnold's Legs and Chest Workout

On the occasion that you find yourself hitting your Legs and Chest together on the same day, this is an **excellent** workout.

For **maximum aesthetics,** try to mix different widths on your squats each set.

Your **Quadriceps** muscle has an inside sweep which is closer to your groin area and an outer sweep which is on the outside of your legs.

The **inside sweep** is worked by a sumo squat stance (legs wide) with your toes pointing outwards by around 30 degrees.
The **outer sweep** is worked by bringing legs close together (shoulder width) and pointing the toes directly forward.



*Sumo stance, toes out 30°*



*Normal stance, toes forward*

Squats 8 8 6 6 6

Leg Extension 5 x 12
(Pause at the top of the repetition,
squeeze and do a slow 4 second descent)

Lying Leg Curls 5 x 8

Calf Raise 5 x 15
(Go HEAVY. Heels can touch the floor
for extra stretch.)

Bench Press 88666

Dumbbell Fly 5 x 15

Sit Ups Knees Bent 6 x 35
(Hook your feet under some form of
weight for better form and leverage)

Bent Knee Leg Raises 200reps

## Old School Bodybuilding Secrets

In this section, I am going to show you many **high level** bodybuilding techniques.

These really helped me to build my body to its best possible point. They are taken from the **works** of old school bodybuilders, mostly Arnold Schwarzenegger, as well as some other IFBB professionals.

I am going to take you through each of the major muscle groups and give you **bodybuilding style** techniques for each of them, so you can rapidly improve your progress in the gym.

## Shoulders

Shoulders are the **centerpiece** of a great physique. Often males focus so much on their Chest, when they don't realise the Shoulders are important too.

They may work Shoulders on a Push Day, where they are **competing** with the Chest muscles and giving more attention to the Chest.

But when we look at the **best** physiques, they take their Shoulders **seriously**, finding a way to give them **equal** treatment.

Whether that is doing a small amount of Shoulder work **after** every session to bring up the **weakpoint**, or dedicating an extra day to Shoulders, or putting it alongside Leg Day, what's **important** is you take them seriously!

It is important to work all **3 heads** of the shoulder muscle: the front, back and middle. When working the shoulders, every machine has its own strengths.

Let me run you through some **advanced ideas** to hit your Shoulders effectively.

## Push Press

Push Press is the first 5 x 5 **power exercise** for the shoulders. Push Press is where you do an Overhead Press but use a slight bend in your legs to explode up and help "cheat" the weight up.

When going heavy, a technique you can use is to do 5 heavy repetitions of the Push Press, and then as you lower the weight down from the top of the movement each rep, do Slow Negatives where you resist the heavy weight for as long as you can.

## Arnold Press

Arnold Press is the **second** of the 5 x 5 Power exercises for the shoulders. Doing it heavy will cause the shoulders to grow immensely.

### Arnold Press Superset

Do the last few reps of your Arnold Press as a normal Dumbbell Shoulder Press when you get tired. This will usually let you **squeeze** out a few more repetitions.

Then when you can't do anymore normal Shoulder Press, **switch** your grip to the grip where your **palms face** each other, which will let you go for a few more Shoulder Press repetitions.

### Seated Smith Machine Press

This machine is very good for **heavy** reps without cheating the weight.

Try not to go to **lockout** on this machine, stop just before your arms fully straighten at the top of the movement to keep the tension on your shoulders.

## Upright Row

This is another good exercise for going **heavy**. I often use it in supersets to hit my shoulders directly with another exercise after as I find this gets the best burn.

Some example supersets are -

Wide grip upright rows x lying side laterals (all sets of 8 - 10)

Heavy Upright Rows with Bent Over Rear Delt DB Flys.

## Machine Shoulder Press

The machine shoulder press is **excellent** at the end of a workout, it allows you to go lower in weight than with a barbell. Here is a 3 set pattern you can use:

**Set 1** - normal repetitions
**Set 2** - 4 second pause reps at top and slow 4 second negatives.

**Set 3** - Hit a few partials at the bottom of your reps near your chest. Go for 8 reps. When you hit failure, use the **Run the Rack method** by lowering the weight on the machine, pulling the pin out and moving it down each time.

Keep going until you can't do any more reps at each weight, and until you get to the lightest possible weight on the stack.

You can also use this machine at the start of a workout, using the **1 - 10 method.** Start with a weight you can only get 1 rep of, set the pin to a lower weight and try to get 2. Take no rest in between these sets. Then 3. All the way up to 10.

Then, if you are really **hardcore**, keep going after 10, until you are at the lowest possible weight on the machine.

Rep that out until **failure**.

## Overhead Press



**Overhead Press Tri Set**

First, do 3 normal heavy sets of your overhead press. Work in the ranges of 8 - 12. After you are **exhausted**, we will do one more set.

Pick a lighter weight and do a really **high repetition** Barbell Shoulder Press of 25 repetitions, followed by Cable Lateral Raises for 12 repetitions.

Finally grab some dumbbells and perform Lying Side Lateral Raises and fight against gravity for 5 seconds when you are lowering the dumbbells after lifting them to the sky.

The set looks like this:

Barbell OHP - 25 Reps
Cable Lateral Raise - 12 reps
Lying Side Laterals - 12 reps (Use 5 Count Method)

## Dumbell Shoulder Press

Using the Running The Rack method is **great** for the Dumbell Shoulder Press. For example, you press with some 25s.

Then down to 20s. Then 15s, 10s, 5s. Then, lateral raise the 5s. Then when you **exhaust** from the lateral raises, bend over forwards and bend over lateral raise the 5s...

This is all in **one** set, before you even put the weight down or rest. Your shoulders will be screaming!

## Shoulder Press DB x BB Superset

Do your dumbbells and lay out a lighter barbell about 50% less heavy in front of the seat, pick it up and rep out with it after your Dumbbell Press.

**Dumbbell Shoulder Press x One Arm Cable Cross Body Lateral Raise**

This is a **superset** Arnold did when preparing for his competitions. Try and set up your seat for the Dumbbell Presses near a cable machine so you can **switch** quickly between them.

## Front Raises

**Front Dumbbell Raises x Bent Over Cable Laterals**

This is a superset that Arnold did in his competition programmes when he was preparing for a competition.

## Lateral Raises

**AG Lateral Raises Drop Set** - This is the superset that I used for over 2 years to develop my side delts. The side delts are what makes your Shoulders look **wide.**

You are going to take a dumbell, for example I use a 10kg dumbell. You are going to do 15 reps, because this is when you start to feel the burn.

Then, reduce the weight by about **20–30%**, wait 10 seconds, and do 15 more reps with the lighter weight. For example, I drop from 10 kg to around 7.5 kg.

Do 3 sets of this 15 x 15 method with a 1 minute rest in between the sets.

**Lateral Raises Isometric Holds**

After every set of lateral raises, grab a heavier weight and hold it out as far to the side as you possibly can, for as long as you can.

Try and go for a minimum of ***30 seconds***. This is really hard to do with a weight that's **heavier** than what you just

went to failure with, especially for 30 seconds.

But this kind of focus on pushing through the pain is what brings you results.

**Lying Side Lateral Raises**

Lie on a bench and do lateral raises into the sky. Arnold would do 10 sets of these, on each arm per day when he woke up in the morning, whether it was shoulder day or not.

Whilst I'm not saying you have to do that amount, I will give you some tips.

Arnold recommended to use the 5 second method for 12reps x 4 sets for a normal lifter.

Lift the weight fast on the way up, and then slowly take 5 seconds to lower it.

**Resist** the weight against gravity and this will really hit your side delts in a different level of intensity.

### Cable Lateral Raises Burnout

Complete 3 sets of 8 - 12. Pause for 4 seconds at the top of the last 2 reps for each set. You can really feel the resistance of the cable machine working your side delts in your shoulders.

### Lying Face Down Rear Delt Dumbbell Raises

Go on a 45 degree bench and lie facing forward with your chest flat on the bench. Turn your **pinky** finger to the sky at the top of each repetition. Once you fatigue from the normal repetitions, switch to a rowing or skiing motion to

really squeeze out the last few repetitions.

This is how you maximize your sets of rear delt dumbbell raises. For this exercise you can hit 5 sets in the repetition range of 30 , 12, 10 , 8 , and 6.

**Lateral Raise x Rear Delt Raise Superset 3 x 10**

Do 3 sets of Lateral Raises where after each set of Lateral Raises you go straight into another set of Rear Delt Raises just by leaning more forwards.

Finally, on the last set, once you hit failure on the Rear Delt Raise, use the Run the Rack Method where you keep picking up **lighter** dumbells and performing repetitions, until you get right to the **lightest** dumbbell and fail with that.

**Rear Delt Fly Sitting On End Of Bench**

Sit on the end of a bench, and use the quarter rep method where you do 1 **full repetition**, and then just the **bottom quarter** of the next repetition, before another **full** rep. Once you have done 10 full reps for 4 sets your Rear Delts should be burning.

## Chest

Old school bodybuilders worked the Chest through **different ranges** to get development in the upper, middle and lower fibres of the chest.

There is also the inner chest "line" to work on, as well as the outer region where the lower chest **connects** to under your armpit.

Depending on which **grip** and which **height** you set your seat, you can shift the focus to work different areas of the chest:

**Outer chest -** Use **wide** grips and pause repetitions, as well as Partial Reps on the lower portion of the movement.

You can also work the Three Quarter Rep Bench Press technique. Dips assist with the **lower outer** chest.

Outer pecs really make the pecs look bigger from the front and connect your chest to the armpit, with a nice defined line.

**Inner chest -** Narrow grip bench with pauses and squeezes at top, fly and cable movements with **pauses** and **squeezes** at the **top** of the movement for inner chest.
This can give you that solid **line that goes through the middle** of your chest,

although you also need to have low body fat to display this.

**Upper Chest -** Incline Benches above 30 degrees work well here to hit your upper chest, giving it a **shelf** that looks amazing. Low To High Cable Flys also help.

**Mid Chest -** standard Bench Presses and Dumbbell Flys work great, as well as **mid height setups** on Cable Crossovers.

**Lower Chest -** Dips and Decline Bench Press, as well as High To Low Cable Flies, will work on the lower chest, giving you a solid line **under** your chest which **chisels** it and **separates** it from your abs.

**Barbell Bench Press**

The Barbell Bench Press is your **Power** movement. Whilst I feel dumbbells do produce more **growth**, as you are able to lift them lower than a bench press and get more of a stretch on the muscle, I do recommend one **heavy** day on the barbell bench press per week, or every fortnight at least.

I use **dumbbells** on my more frequent "growing" 8 - 12 repetition days as I have found focus in the 8 - 12 rep range seems to grow people more, but **barbells** for my heavy days.

Heavy days become so important at an **advanced** level of lifting.

This is because at an advanced level, we need to add more **shocks** to our system to keep our 8 - 12 rep range going up in weight.

**Beginners** don't need to worry about this too much, as they will go up in

weight weekly on the dumbbell press **regardless.**

But after some time, once it becomes difficult to progress, heavy **power style days** become more effective.

Especially when you are about to move up in weight on your Dumbbell press, a good **heavy day on the bench** a few days before hand can really allow you to handle the increase.

I haven't found as much growth when sticking solely to power days, but the **combination** of power days and hypertrophy (8 - 12 repetition range growth days) really work well to keep us **progressing at an advanced level.**

As long as the power days are used as a tool and not as the primary focus of the programme, they are extremely effective. My general rule of thumb is **30% strength work, 70% hypertrophy work.**

## Bench Press Stripping Method

Put on a **heavy weight** for your first set, get friends to remove plates as you go. All the way down to the bar and then lift the bar for 20 repetitions.

## 3 Quarter Reps On Bench Press

Do a set where you only do the **bottom three quarters** of the repetitions on your bench press.

Stop before your arms **lock out** fully straight. What this does is it takes out the triceps from the movement, and works the chest more. Within months you will see an extra hardness to your chest.

## Pause Reps

I suggest doing sets of Pause Reps from time to time on the Bench Press. Perform them with a wide grip.

You can grip the bar with a really **wide grip**, and **pause** at the bottom portion of the repetition for 3 - 5 seconds.

This will maximise the stretch in your outer chest, **building up** the portion of your chest where your lower chest meets the bottom of your armpits. This looks very **aesthetic**.

## Incline Dumbbell Bench Press

Put the bench at a height that is slightly **above flat**, around 30 - 45 degrees should suffice.

**Variation 1 - Reverse Pyramid Set**

Start with your heaviest weight and go for 8 - 12 repetitions. No need for long pauses at the bottom, just get the weight up as it is heavy.

**Variation 2 - Pause Repetitions**

Do Pause Repetitions at the bottom of the movement, for 3 - 5 seconds. Note that you will need to use a lower weight for pause reps.

**Variation 3 - Half Press, Half Fly**

In the first, lower part of movement, press the weight up with normal form.

But slowly **transition** your palms to face each other at the top of the movement.

The end **position** is like the ending of a Dumbbell Fly.

An example of this can be found on the Achieve Greatness YouTube titled "Incline Dumbbell Press Variations."

**Triple Dumbbell Incline Bench Dropset**

**Line up three sets of dumbbells** in a line in front of the seat of your bench. The closest to you is the **heavy** weight, followed by the **medium** weight , followed by the **lighter** weight.

Do 12 repetitions and without stopping, pick up the next set of dumbbells.

Complete all 3 sets of dumbbells without stopping.

**Incline Press x Cable Crossovers Superset**

Park an incline bench near a cable machine with the pulleys set to the **low**

**height**, and do incline bench cable crossovers after a set of Incline Dumbbell Press.

### Pec Fly Machine x Clap Push Ups Superset

This one is for **advanced** lifters, when you use the pec fly machine, do some clap push ups until failure in between the sets. Aim for 12 - 15 repetitions on each exercise.

### Chest Finisher Tri Set

Finish your workout with with Dumbbell Flys, Dips and then Cable Crossovers, this pumps an enormous amount of blood into the area.

## All Inclines Dumbell Bench Press

This is a variation where you start on a high Incline Bench Press and lower the incline on the seat for each set.

## Double Incline Chest Technique

If your gym has an Incline Chest Press machine, warm up with that for 3 sets. Then go on the Smith Machine on an Incline Bench setting.

Do Smith Machine Incline Bench Press for 4 sets of 12. On the fourth set, lighten the weight.

Do 10 speed reps as fast as you can, count your reps 1 up to 10. And then count back down from 10 to 1 doing 4 second Pause Reps paused at the bottom of the movement.

So in total your last set contains 20 repetitions, (10 speed reps, 10 pause reps)

**Cable Crossovers**

These are excellent for the inner chest line. I love the **high to low** crossovers.

Work up to a **heavy** weight with this exercise and squeeze when your hands meet each other in the middle.

Try to hold the middle position for 3 to 5 seconds. **A trick to get even more growth** out of this exercise is to keep crossing your hands even further after hands meet.

Cross your hands over and under each other, **switching** which hands go under and over on each rep. Go further past the middle point of your hands clapping together, and into a **deeper** stretch

where you actually cross your arms, almost like you are **hugging** someone.

If you just clap your hands together and hold them there, you are not getting the **complete** stretch.

Alternate which hands cross the other for balanced growth and go **further** into your crossover, squeeze for 3 - 5 seconds per rep in the **deep crossed over** position.

An example of Cable Crossovers can be seen on the YouTube channel titled: "Cable Crossovers Technique."

## Chest Finishers

These are good **finishers** for your chest.

**The Chest Press Of Pain Tri Set**

This set uses the Pec Fly Machine into the Chest Press Machine and then the Close Grips on the Chest Press Machine.

Some Chest Press machines have **multiple handles**.

If you get a Chest Press Machine with a **horizontal wide grip** and a **vertical close grip**, you can perform this superset.

Start on the Pec Fly Machine, hit 15 around repetition until failure. Then go straight to the Chest Press Machine, and hit it for 15 further repetitions on the wide handle.

Without resting, finally continue repping out until failure on the close grip handles.

This superset requires the type of gym where the Chest machines are all

organised to be somewhat close to each other.

An example of this Tri set can be seen on the Achieve Greatness YouTube channel, titled “The Chest Press Of Pain Tri Set”

**Chest Press Machine**

This is a great **finisher** exercise. It is a **great** machine to make use of the Forced Reps technique.

Get someone to help you push past failure for a few more repetitions by **grabbing the handles** of the machine and pulling them as you push them.

I find this machine hits the best in sets of 15 repetitions at the end of a workout.

## Chest Power Day

For your one heavy power day per week, you can follow Arnold's rep ranges.

**Bench Press** 20 10 5 3 1 2 1 2 1 10
**Incline Press** 20 10 5 3 1 2 1 2 1 10
**DB Fly** 20 10 5 3 1 2 1 2 1 10

Notice how you start in a high repetition range, then you go down to heavy powerlifting style repetitions for a few sets.

At this heavy range, you should be getting around 1 - 2 repetitions, before going back up to a higher rep range of 10 to finish.

On **Power day**, try to focus on your outer chest. You have more leverage with a wider grip and at the bottom portion of the movement to grow the outer muscles with heavier weights.

You can use the Pec Dec Fly machine for this as you are able to hit Partials at the **start** of the rep too where your arms are **outstretched**, and as you are sitting down with your back supported you are able to do very heavy weights.

I have found the Pec Dec Machines are good for heavy power days, and for the **outer chest** as well as the **inner chest**, depending on where you **pause** the reps, Partials and Pause Reps in the region where you have arms **outstretched** will lead to more outer chest growth, and pauses where your hands meet in the **middle** grow the inner chest more.

For the Cable Crossover, I find its **strength** is the inner chest. You can really squeeze it hard in the middle of the motion. You can go heavy with the Cable Crossover too and really **squeeze** it to hit your inner chest.

I do not think the Cable Crossover is **as effective** at building the outer chest, I don't like to do Partials in the arms **outstretched** portion of the movement, because something about the cables does not feel as stable, and I find you can lift more weight when using Partials on the Pec Fly Machine in this region.

**Alternative Power Day**

This is another power day you can use. If you don't want to hit **heavy 1 reps** all the time, due to **injury concerns,** there is the option to hit some different ranges instead.

You can work the **power range**, at around 4 sets of 2 - 4 reps.

Your workout will consist of:

**Wide Bench press** (power range)
**Barbell Shoulder press** (power range)
**Weighted Dips** 5 x 5

**Pec Fly Machine** (use a heavy weight, for every one full repetition do 3 partial repetitions at the arms wide portion of the movement, for 8 reps total)

**Cable Crossovers** with a heavy weight and squeeze for 3 seconds as your arms cross each other. Do 3 sets of 8 repetitions.

**Lateral Raises** 3 x 12 with a focus on heavier weight.

Another rep range that you can use in the strength and power category, which is a bit more focused on muscle building, is the 8 8 6 6 6.

You can do all sets from the workout given directly above in this range if you prefer.

Arnold used this **rep range** often. This is where you do the first two sets of 8 as warm up sets with reasonably light

repetitions. Then go into three sets of 6 which really **push** you to the limit.

You can rotate the different power **schemes**, and use one that works for your **current level of energy** and time.

Here are the Power schemes:

20 10 5 3 1 2 1 2 1 10

4 x 2 - 4 reps

8 8 6 6 6

Use these power rep ranges to incorporate power days into your programme.

# Back

## Heavy T Bar Rows

These are a great **Power** exercise. Use them once in a while instead of normal Barbell Rows. Really focus on going heavy and getting that "slamming the bar to your chest" feel.

## Deadlifts

This is another **Power** exercise. I find them to build a large amount of **fatigue**, so I do them rarely, but I implement Romanian Deadlifts on Leg Day.

In terms of **aesthetics**, a **woman** can benefit from Deadlifts more than a **man**, and will often do them more often.

Romanian Deadlifts are often **preferred by women** due to their focus on the

Hamstrings and Glutes instead of the Quads.

**Upper Lats**

Work your upper lats with **Wide Grip Pull Ups** and **Wide Grip Rows.**

**Lower Lats**

These are worked with Close Grip exercises that bring your **elbows close** to your **sides**.

A lot of people tell you to just "do everything with a wide grip" to get a **wide** back.

But **Close Grip** exercises should be hit because they work your Lower Lats. Your Lower Lats is actually the section where your back **connects** to under your arms, forming the "V line."

Neutral and Close Grip **vertical pulling** movements, and Neutral and Glose Grip Cable Rows will help here.

One Arm Rows also help, try to really focus on pulling your elbow close to your sides and back behind you.

**Lower Lats Mega Set**

Close Grip Chin Ups,
Close Grip Lateral Pulldown,
One Arm Cable Rows
One Arm Dumbbell Rows.
(No rest between them!)

This mega set adds to the v taper from the front view of your body.

**Rhomboids and Mid Back Line**

The mid back line that runs along your **spine** looks very built up when you do

exercises where you bring your elbows further **behind** you and squeeze.

This includes using One Arm Dumbbell Rows where you bring your elbows slightly further behind your back and up high and **squeeze** the top position.

You can squeeze and **pause** the repetition at the top portion of a cable row with a two handled rope for your grip.

The two handled rope attachment allows you to pull your elbows further **behind your back** with your elbows to your sides, or pausing and squeezing at the **top** of a Barbell Row.

**Back Supersets**

Seated Cable Row 10 reps x Cable Straight Arm Pullovers 15reps

Seated Cable Row 15 reps x One Arm Dumbbell Row 12 reps

## Traps

Also known as **Trapezius**. Your trap muscles contribute to the look of a very **thick** upper back when you view your physique from the **back**, and also a larger neck when you view your physique from the front.

### Dumbbell Shrugs

These are a great exercise for going heavy and building your traps.

### Deadlifts

Deadlifts also contribute to the trap muscles.

### Heavy Upright Rows

These are **considered** a Shoulder exercise by **many**, but also work the Trapezius muscles.

### Farmer Carries

These are an excellent **finisher** exercise for the traps muscles. A trick is to shrug the dumbbells up and down as you are walking with them.

This introduces some extra motion and **instability** to the exercise.

### Traps Mega Set

This is a great **superset** to build your traps. Do 12 reps of dumbbell shrugs, and then with no rest go into 12 heavy

upright rows, into 12 reps of behind the back barbell shrugs.

When you finish **3 rounds** of this, do a Dumbbell Farmer Carry for 2 sets to **really** finish yourself off!

## Biceps

### Barbell Bicep Curl

A **popular** exercise to build your Biceps.

The secret is in the **form**, if your front delts are naturally strong and you use your back or rock back too much on this lift, then your **Front Delt** actually **takes over** the lift.

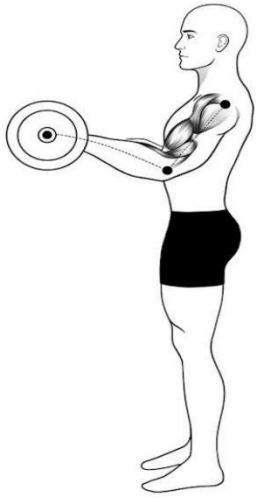
Keep your back straight and free from rocking.

Another thing that trips people up is **wrist** position.

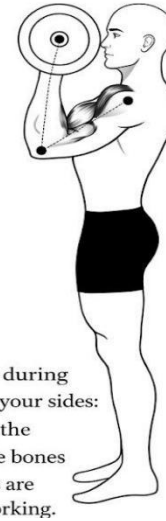
Keep your wrists **straight** and don't allow them to be **bent** downwards by the bar, or your Forearms will take over the lift.

Finally, keep your hands **shoulder** width apart and don't raise your elbows forward in front of your body at the top of the curl, keep your elbows **pinned** directly to your sides, or your front Shoulder muscles will take over the lift.

Try to do this exercise with your back against a wall to stop you from **cheating**.



Notice what happens when your elbows move upward during the Barbell Curl. Instead of isolating and really targeting the biceps, you engage the front deltoids, which compromises the purpose of the exercise.



Another issue when your elbows rise during the Barbell Curl instead of staying by your sides: At the end position of the movement, the forearms are now vertical, meaning the bones now support the weight, and the biceps are barely working.

*(Keep the elbows pinned to your sides instead of rising upwards on the biceps curl!)*

Some great **techniques** to use with your standard barbell curl are:

- **1-10 Method**
- **28 Method**

Bicep curls are excellent to build **overall** mass.

**Incline Seated Dumbbell Curl**

This exercise allows you to get more of a **stretch** on your biceps by bringing dumbbells behind your body, and working them against **gravity** in this position.

You will really feel a **great** stretch on your biceps with this exercise. This builds your lower bicep as well as your bicep width. Go for 4 sets of 12.

**Dumbbell Curl (Twisting Inwards)**

This exercise uses dumbbells. Unlike a barbell, this allows you to rotate your hands in various directions.

Twisting your little fingers to the sky with your palms slightly outwards is

going to hit a peak **contraction** of your Biceps.

Many people curl the dumbbells without focusing on this. **Squeeze** this area for maximum contraction in an area that you just cannot **reach** with barbells.

You can also do Cross Body Curls. The Dumbbell Curl builds mass and height.

Go **heavy** on this exercise.

**Outward Bicep Curl**



Aim the dumbbells to face **outwards** slightly. Keep your hands straight, and your elbows pinned to your sides. This works your **inner** biceps.

**Ez Bar Curl**

This gives you a grip that feels more **easier** and **comfortable**. This exercise is great for Forced Reps where your partner helps you lift more, and drop sets where you quickly slide weight off the bar.

**EZ Bar Curl Partner Set**

Grab a Bicep Curl EZ bar, and do as many repetitions as you can, instead of putting it down, **hand it** to your partner.

They will do their repetitions and then they will hand it **straight back**.

You will continue to **compete** with each other, doing your repetitions to failure and handing the barbell back and forth until one person gives up.

In the words of Arnold: "you should both repeat this process until your arms are **completely** done and it **hurts** to lift them!"

**AG Military Biceps Set With EZ Bar**

I saw a **military** man do this set in the gym. You load your EZ barbell with a lot of small plates.

Do not put **clips** on the end of the barbell to hold the weights in place. You are going to be **stripping** weights from the bar in the middle of your set.

Do 15 repetitions first, and then without resting, take off about 50% of the weight, and keep going for another 15 repetitions.

For example, if you have 5kg worth of weight plates in 2.5kg weight plates on each side, strip the 2.5kg plate off after 15 repetitions and keep going.

This will **reduce** the weight by **exactly half**, and allow you to keep going. Set your weight plates up in a way that allows you to **strip** the bar many times, such as by using **lots** of low weight plates instead of the heavier plates.

Do 3 sets of this technique, **halving** the weight each time, for the maximum burn.

### Preacher Curls

A good exercise for progressive overload, you are not going to **cheat** with your back as you are sitting down, so you can up the weight with **good form** each week,

instead of Barbell Curls where people tend to cheat once things get heavy.

This exercise works the **lower** bicep well.

### Preacher Curl Machine

Of all the Biceps machines, this is a good machine for progressive overload. It can be a main focus of your Bicep day.

The reason I like to focus on **progression** with this machine is because you are less able to **cheat** with your back once the weight gets heavy, as you are with Barbell Bicep Curls.

You are sitting down with your elbows supported, so you can **up** the weight you use with good form each week, instead of Barbell Curls where people tend to **cheat** once things get heavy.

The Preacher Curl Machine works the **lower Bicep** well. This machine is responsible for many IFBB pros that claim they added **inches** onto their arms fast by doing burns on this machine.

I find it works well in a **superset** with Dumbbell Hammer Curls!

Also, for the last 3-4 reps in a set, do **upper partials** where you lift the weight to the top of the movement, come down only a third of the way, and then back up again.

Do 3 or 4 **upper portion partials** like this.

**Cable Biceps Curl**

This exercise is great for the **21s method** or a simple or **3 sets x 8 reps**

Try to pause and **contract** your muscle for 1 second at the top of every repetition.

Perform this exercise in the **mirror** often so you can see how high you are bringing the bar and how **straight** you are keeping your back.

### Hammer Curls

Hammer Curls are great for your **forearms.** They work really well with the **dropsets** technique.

## Power exercises

### Cheat curls

Cheat Curls are your **power** exercise for Biceps. They should not make up more than 10% of your Biceps days.

Do 6 reps of Cheat Curls as a **power exercise** to get the biceps day started. Or do some chest curls after regular curls to keep the set going when you get tired.

Use heavy Cheat Curls sparingly, some people tear their biceps if they go ridiculously heavy, and **tendinitis** from Biceps **overuse** can happen too, so stick to the guidelines of using only a few of these per Biceps workout if you use them.

Try to always stay at **6 or above repetitions** when it comes to Biceps sets to avoid these types of tears.

Again, 6 reps total of **cheat reps** is all you want to aim for on biceps day, as you want to practice mostly good form.

**Behind The Back Barbell Wrist Curls** -

This is a **Power** exercise for your Forearms.

(Don't be shy to use lots of weight as you can handle more than you think on this exercise!)

**Concentration Curls**

This lift adds **height** to your biceps. It is great as a **finisher** at the end of biceps day.

Arnold Schwarzenegger used this lift at the end of his biceps day often.

During the top portion of the curl, **twist your little fingers into the sky** so they are higher than your thumb.

Curl the dumbbell to your **shoulder,** not your chest, to get even more range of motion, and then **squeeze** at the top of the movement as hard as you can.

Some good sets for Concentration Curls are:

**Concentration Curls 4 sets of 12 - 15** using **one and a half reps** where you do one repetition and then half of the next repetition and back down, do this 15 times in one set.

Superset **Concentration Curls** with **Seated Incline Two Arm Dumbbell Curls.** Go heavy, and hit 6 reps on both exercises. Do **5 sets** of each.

**Wrist Curls x Reverse Wrist Curls Superset**

Use a **heavy** weight and go for high reps.

Do 3 sets instead of a large amount of sets, but really hit the sets hard. When you're finally at **failure** on your last set, let the bar just hang in your hands as you **roll** it in your fingers slightly just to burn the last available muscle fibres.

## Reverse Curls

These are great for your **forearms.** You can use Pause Reps at the **top** of the movement and slow negative reps when bringing the bar down. Bring the bar to just **under chin height**.

Pause your repetition at the **top** and squeeze.

Reverse Curls also do not have to be performed with a barbell only. You can use your **imagination** with this exercise, because you can also use the Bicep Curl Machine with a **reverse** grip on the handles.

You can also use a cable machine with a **reverse** grip.

**Close Grip Barbell Curls**

This is a great exercise to develop the **thickness** of your outer biceps due to the closer grip.

**Close Grip Preacher Bench Curls**

Also a great exercise to develop the **thickness** of your outer biceps due to the closer grip.

**Triceps**

The Triceps are a muscle that can take a **few sets** to feel. This is because they **respond** well to **time under tension** before you can really feel them.

But don't worry, after you make use of the **techniques** below, you will be able to provide them with more than enough time under tension and stress!

**Standing French Press**

This is a compound **mass grower** for the Triceps. Place your hands on a barbell **10 inches** apart.

This is a great exercise because you can load it with a **heavy** barbell and it grows **all heads** of the tricep.

**Skullcrushers**

These are the **lying down** version of the French press where you lie on a bench and bring the barbell behind your head or to your forehead. Place your hands **10 inches** apart on the bar and use an EZ bar.

Be careful not to load this exercise too **heavy** as you can hurt your elbows. I prefer Cable Triceps Extensions as I find them **safer** on the elbows.

## Skullcrusher Tri Set

Whilst some people like to load the Skullcrusher exercise heavily, I prefer to use the exercise in a **different** way in the form of a **superset**, using more **moderate** weighs, to increase the time under tension and **burn** of the triceps.

When you are **lying** down on the bench after Skullcrushers, you have the advantage of lying on a bench, where you can **quickly** perform a superset with Close Grip Bench Press or a Dumbbell Close Grip Bench Press.

You can use the **same** barbell or pair of dumbbells you used for the skullcrushers across both exercises.

This is a **fast** and **efficient** way of working your triceps. As an extra addition, you can form a Tri-set with Lying Cross Face Dumbbell Triceps Extension.

An **example** of this exercise will be available on the Achieve Greatness YouTube channel under "Skullcrusher Tri Set."

**Dumbell Skullcrushers**

These are a good exercise because you can use the Run The Rack Method on them.

You can simply go down the dumbbell rack and keep picking up **lighter** weights when you fail.

Do 28 reps x 4 sets, and then use the Run The Rack Method on your last set.

**Dumbbell Behind Head Extensions / Cable Extensions**

A good technique for this exercise is to get a partner to help you with forced reps.

**Tricep Cable Push Downs x Tricep Behind The Head Cable Extensions**

This is my most **efficient** and most used Triceps superset. No adjustment is required for this set.

It is so easy to quickly switch from your Cable Push Downs to your Behind The Head Cable Extensions.

You don't even need to **change** the pulley **height** or the handle. Just switch exercises and change the weight if you need.

You can use a bar or a rope. Whichever you prefer. Have the pulley height set at around head height.

This is my number one **time saving** superset to hit two popular triceps exercises extremely fast.

Why pick one or the other when your short on time on Triceps day when you can just as easily do both with the **same grip** set to the same height?

**Standing One Arm Rope Pushdowns**

This is a good exercise to feel an extra **angle** of stretch to your Triceps.

Pause at the **bottom** for 2 seconds every repetition and really try to squeeze your triceps.

**Triceps Supersets**

BB Skullcrushers with Bodyweight Skullcrushers 5 x 15

Cable Bar Triceps Extensions SS Cable Rope Tricep Extensions 4 x 12

# Legs

In terms of building your legs, there are a few **key techniques** to get the most growth out of your workouts.

If you want to build the best legs possible, you must always ask yourself this question: **Is it true that I cannot really do another rep?**

Don't believe the "do 2 sets per exercise, and never take your sets to failure crowd" when it comes to legs.

You need to hit your legs **hard.** Maybe not as hard as a competition level body builder, but still hard enough to challenge yourself. Legs need lots of sets, volume, progressive overload, and muscular failure.

In the **bodybuilding** ranges of 8 - 12 repetitions, you can take each and every legs set to failure, and still recover and grow.

You can't do this as well with powerlifting and strength because that style of training tires your central nervous system, and that makes it difficult for your body to **recover.**

But with higher rep ranges you most definitely can recover. People telling a natural lifter should work at 7 / 10 intensity all the time because a "natural lifter" cannot recover, have got it backwards.

A natural lifter needs to **push** his or her body to grow. A natural body doesn't have the performance enhancing drugs to support it.

With performance enhancing drugs like steroids, you could work at 7 / 10 intensity and still grow massively due to the drugs in your system.

As a natural lifter, you need to push your leg sessions hard within the 8 - 12 rep ranges.

I'm not saying to be doing heavy sets of 5 repetitions all the time, for 2 hour sessions. Or 7 - 10 sets per exercise. This is where a natural lifter will fail to recover.

However, your legs session shouldn't be easy! Do between 3 - 4 sets per exercise and **push them hard.**

If you push hard in the correct range, for a reasonable amount of sets, you

won't have to worry about not recovering.

## Quads

### Squats

The squat is your power exercise for the legs.

For **Squats**, a good technique to push to your limits is to do your set to failure, and then pause with the bar on your back, take one or two deep breaths to recover slightly, and do one more repetition before racking it.

Squats work really well **supersetted** with the Leg Extension machine.

### Leg Extension

Leg Extension works really well when you apply **partial repetitions** at the

bottom of the movement, **pauses** at the top of the movement, and **forced repetitions** once you fatigue.

I would do one set of **each** training technique on this machine when I use it. You can get a friend to **help** you with your Forced Repetitions, or you can simply **pull** the lever on the leg roller with your **hand** towards you to assist your own repetitions on most Leg Extension machines!

**Leg Press**

This is a very **versatile** machine. Your foot placement on this machine can dictate which muscles are worked.

Taking your **legs wide with your toes pointed outwards** will work your inner thighs more.

Using a **narrow leg stance with your toes pointed forwards** will work your outer thighs more.

Placing your **feet high** will emphasise your glutes and hamstrings.

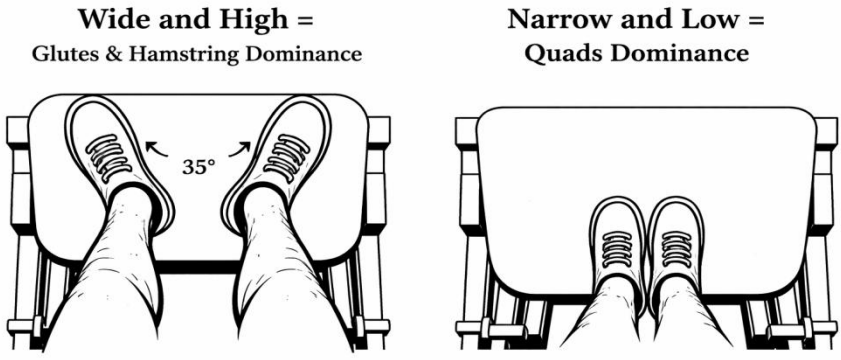
Placing your **feet low** will emphasize your quads.

Men tend to look more aesthetic with a wide outer quad sweep, this is the look that many men go for. **Low foot placement with the feet facing forward** may be focused on more by a **man.**

Women tend to look more aesthetic when they shift development onto their **glutes and hamstrings**, rather than building blocky quads.

Therefore, placing the **feet high, wide and pointing the toes out** can work very well in terms of **women** trying to maximise their aesthetic physique.

Here is a diagram to illustrate this to you:




**Hack Squat**

This is a great **finisher** exercise for the legs.

**20 Reps Of Pain**

Get on the **Hack Squat Machine** at the end of a workout, and simply do a set of **20 repetitions**.

Most people have to start with no weight added at all, this machine is no joke!

### 30 Reps Of Pain

This is like the **advanced version** of 20 reps of pain. You are going to do **30 reps in total** using the Stripping Method.

The 30 repetitions are to be divided into sets of 6 repetitions, with no rest between them. Load the machine up with lots of plates and strip the weight plates off the machine every 6 repetitions until 30 full repetitions are completed.

### Hack Squat x Lying Leg Curls Superset

Do 8 reps of a hack squat straight into 8 reps of a lying leg curl machine.

## Hamstrings

### Leg Curls

This machine works really well with forced reps, stripping method, slow negatives and partials!

The **Lying Leg Curl** will require a partner to help you with forced repetitions.

Focus on squeezing the top of the movement and holding it there.

Some gyms have **Seated Leg Curl** machines. I find high repetitions work well with the seated versions, especially closing your eyes, taking a deep breath, and doing drop sets on this machine down to the lowest possible weight, squeezing every repetition.

### Romanian Deadlifts

These are often a **preferred** form of Deadlift as they to keep the **tension** on the hamstring muscle in the deadlift.

Here is a **diagram** of how to pick up the bar with good form when you initiate a Deadlift movement.

It is **important** to do this lift safely.



*When you begin the Deadlift with your head up and back straight, you allow the glutei, leg muscles, and lower back to drive the bar upward with maximum force.*



*Starting a Deadlift with your back forward means that the lower back is going to have to do most of the initial work to get the bar moving. This is dangerous.*

## Calves

I don't train Calves as **often** because I think there are more muscles that take priority when it comes to looking good.

A lot of women already have calves, and men look more **aesthetic** when they focus on building other areas such as their torso, as long as the calves aren't "chicken legs" they don't need to be massive.

However, to not get "chicken legs" we still need to do at least **some** Calves work.

When I train the Calves, I like to train them super effectively with lots of **supersets** so that I do not have to train them as often.

When Arnold Schwarzenegger was training for his competitions, he would do a lot of supersets and mega sets.

Such as a **mega set** with:

**Standing Calve Raises** (with heavy dumbbells or heavy weights on the machine)

**Seated Machine Calf Raises**

**Dumbbell Calve Raises on a Fitness Step**

**Standing One Leg Bodyweight Calve Raises**

**45 Degree Leg Press Calve Raises**

When doing Standing Calve Raises, use a raised **block** that is just big enough so that your heels touch the floor when you are at the bottom of the movement. This is to get more stretch.

At the end of a workout, choose a weight that is around 20kg higher than what you can currently handle on Calves and try and get just 3-4 repetitions.

**Partials** at the **very top and bottom** of Calves Raises are very effective because the midpoint of the movement is where

our feet are flat and so is therefore not as effective.

**Why** is this?

Our feet are **flat** in every day life when walking, and so are designed to handle lots of load in this position, we lift our whole body on our flat feet all day, but we are **not designed** to take heavy loads on our **tip toes** or with our heels dipping **below flat** on an edge.

**Partials** in the ranges that the body is not **naturally strong** in are therefore really **effective** because our calves are less developed at these angles.

**Standing Calve Raise Machine**

Your heavy **power** exercise for Calves. When you can't do another repetition, do **partials** at the end of your set.

### Seated Calf Raise Machine

**Partials** are really effective on this machine, as well as **pause repetitions** in the top and bottom portions of the repetition.

Really **squeeze** at the top and bottom of your repetitions, and when you reach failure on the Seated Machine, stand up and do some **Bodyweight Calf Raises** with some **dumbbells** to get even more burn in this area.

I have found sets of 15 to work well on this machine.

## Abs

### Hip Flexors and Obliques

The **Hip Flexors** and **Obliques** are the muscles surrounding your V-lines — that defined, V-shaped area below your six-pack.

Twisting and Leg Raise movements build these muscles and push out the area for greater definition.

**Key exercises** include Leg Raises, Hanging Leg Raises, Russian Twists, and Bicycle Crunches.

In bodybuilding, the **Obliques** are typically **not a priority**, as overdeveloping them adds width to your hips when viewed from the side, which can works against the aesthetic goal of a slim waist.

If you want, **occasionally** throwing in some Russian Twists, Bicycle Crunches, and Twists With A Broom is all that's needed for Obliques.

Hip Flexors however, are more useful to work, especially because they **contribute** a lot to your V Lines, and a lot of Hip Flexor exercises carry over greatly to hit your Lower Abs too.

## Leg Raises

Target area: Hip Flexors, V-Lines.

Classic exercise for Hip Flexors and Lower Abs.

Start by performing your Leg Raises lying flat on the floor. As you **build strength,** progress to the Captain's Chair Leg Raises, and finally to Hanging Leg Raises.

Keep your legs as **straight** as possible and your spine flat throughout — this is what engages the Hip Flexors and develops the V-lines.

## Bicycle Crunches

Target area: Abs and Obliques.

Lie on your **back** and bring one knee in while rotating your opposite elbow to meet it, then **alternate** sides. Perform these **slow** and controlled — rushing the

movement removes tension from the muscles and turns it into a **cardio exercise** rather than a strength one.

### Russian Twists

Target area: Obliques.

Sit on the floor with your knees bent and lean back slightly to **engage** the Abs. Rotate your torso from side to side. Can be **progressed** by holding a weight plate or Kettlebell.

### Seated Twists With A Broomstick

Target area: Obliques.

Sit upright with a **broomstick** across your shoulders and rotate your torso from side to side in a controlled manner. Keep the movement coming from the waist, not the hips.

**Rectus Abdominis (Six-Pack)**

Leg Raises and Hip Flexor exercises do indirectly contribute to the **six-pack**, but what **primarily** develops the Rectus Abdominis is spinal **flexion** — movements like Crunches and Reverse Crunches.

It's the **rounding** and **curling** of the spine that directly targets the six-pack muscles. When the spine stays **straight** (as in standard Leg Raises), you're working the Hip Flexors and V-lines more than the Abs themselves.

That said, there is **carry-over** between all abdominal exercises. Assess your own physique and identify your **weak** areas.

If you find you have well-developed V-lines but underdeveloped Lower Abs, change your exercise style to incorporate more spine **flexing** exercises.

For example you can do Reverse Crunches instead of Leg Raises, which bend your spine more in a similar movement.

### Roman Chair Sit-Ups

When using the **Roman Chair**, focus on flexing the Lumbar Spine rather than hinging at the hips. This means bend your spine. Work through the top 45–70 degrees of the movement with a rounded back, rather than lowering all the way down to parallel with the floor.

Going too low on this movement flattens the spine and shifts the work to the Hip Flexors. Keep the back rounded to keep the **tension** on the Abs.

## Crunches

Target area: Upper Abs. Lie on your back with knees bent and hands behind your head.

Curl your upper body towards your knees, focusing on squeezing the Abs at the top.

Crunches can be **progressed** by holding a kettlebell across your chest, or performed on a Fitness Ball where the increased range of motion and **instability** intensifies the burn.

## Reverse Crunches

Target area: Lower Abs.

Lie flat on your back and bring your knees in towards your chest, curling your hips off the floor at the top of the movement.

Slow the descent down for maximum tension — the **negative** is just as important as the contraction. Can be progressed with ankle weights for added resistance.

### Knee-Ups

Target area: Lower Abs.

Hang from a bar or use the Captain's Chair and bring your knees up towards your chest.

Pause at the **top** of the movement to maximise the contraction. Can be progressed by holding a Dumbbell between your feet.

### Machine Crunches

Target area: Full Abs.

Sit in the Crunch Machine and pull the weight down by **curling** your spine, not by pushing with your arms.

Focus on a slow, controlled contraction and squeeze at the bottom.

### Seated Leg Tucks (Scissors)

Target area: Full Abs. Sit on the edge of a bench, lean back slightly and bring your knees in **towards** your chest while simultaneously crunching your upper body forward.

Extend back out slowly and repeat.

### Decline Bench Crunches

Target area: Upper Abs.

Perform Crunches on a decline bench for a greater range of motion.

Focus on rounding the spine rather than sitting all the way up, which would shift the load to the Hip Flexors.

### Cable Crunches

Target area: Full Abs.

Kneel in front of a cable machine with a rope attachment and pull the weight down by flexing your spine, curling your elbows towards your knees. Keep your hips stationary — all the movement should come from the Abs.

### Fitness Ball Crunches

Target area: Upper Abs.

Perform Crunches on a Fitness Ball. The instability and increased range of motion compared to the floor makes this a highly effective variation — you'll

feel the stretch and contraction more intensely.

### Ab Wheel Rollouts

Target area: Full Abs.

Kneel on the floor and grip the Ab Wheel. Roll forward **slowly** until your body is extended, then contract your Abs to pull yourself back.

Keep your core tight throughout and avoid letting your lower back sag.

### Hanging Reverse Crunches / Toes-To-Bar

Target area: Lower Abs, Hip Flexors.

Hang from a bar and bring your knees up towards your chest, then curl your hips upward at the top to add a spinal flexion component.

For the Toes-To-Bar variation, keep your legs straight and raise them all the way up to the bar.

### Figure-Of-8

Target area: Lower Abs, Obliques, Hip Flexors.

A full **burn** movement that hits the entire midsection. Hold a weight and move it in a figure-of-8 pattern around your legs while keeping your core braced throughout.

### Lower Back

(The Other Half of Your Core.)

Remember, your core has **two sides**, a front and back too.

The Erector Spinae — the muscles running along either side of your spine

— are just as much a **part of your core** as your Abs on the front side, and neglecting them creates an imbalance that affects both your posture and your physique.

If you do too much **Ab work** which is the front side of your core and neglect the lower back (the back muscles of your core) the stronger frontal muscles will pull your pelvis forwards and your posture will suffer. You develop **posterior pelvic tilt**. Your hips tip forward and your back rounds.

If you do too much Lower Back work and neglect your Abs, the stronger muscles of your lower back pull your pelvis backwards. You develop an **anterior pelvic tilt.** Your hips tip backwards.

Women on average, more than men, follow programmes that **frequently** contain exercises such as the Deadlifts and Glute Ham Extensions which

naturally develops the back side of their core — for this reason, make sure to include Ab work regularly in your programme as a woman to keep roughly a 50/50 balance between working the frontal muscles and back muscles of your core.

Men, on the other hand are often chasing a six-pack and frequently **neglect their lower back entirely**, therefore they should include more Lower Back work to work the back muscles of their core.

Men also do not like to work the Glutes muscles as it is sometimes seen as a feminine muscle, but this is also a mistake and can lead to anterior pelvic tilt.

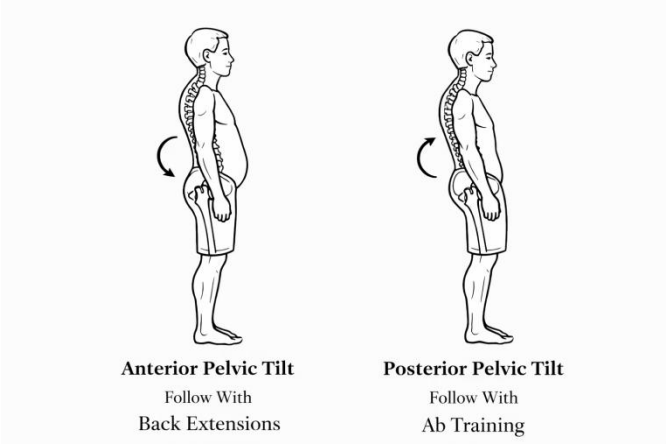
The fix is simple either way — balance your core training front to back and balance your training in general. Don't skip entire muscles thinking you don't need them.

On my Pull days, instead of a five minute **Abs circuit**, I swap it out for 3 sets of **Back Extensions.**

For women, if you train a lot of **Deadlifts, Rows and Glute Ham Raises,** and see your spine starting to shift backwards too much, then you may wish to increase the volume of your Abs training and decrease exercises such as Back Extensions.

If you generally include **both front and back** muscles in your training, at around a 50 / 50 ratio, and strengthen both to a reasonable level, you will likely develop a strong and balanced body that holds itself upright without any issues.

Here is a **diagram** to illustrate this:




**Back Extensions** can be **progressed** by doing them with kettlebells, dumbbells or barbells in your hands as you perform the exercise.

## Side Abs Workout

This is a good workout for developing your **Side Abs**, namely your **Obliques.**

Bodybuilders sometimes avoid working these muscles in excess, because larger obliques make the waist appear wider, which is not as **aesthetic.**

So why would you perform this workout? If you are a boxer or kickboxer, this workout can help you to take **body shots** more effectively.

You are building up muscle in the area where you are getting hit to the body.

The workout is:

Side Reaching Crunches

Side Plank Hip Lifts

Russian Twists

Bicycle Crunches

Standing Oblique Crunches

Windshield Wipers

Side V Ups

Side Mountain Climbers

X2

**Bonus Set**

If you still have energy. You add:

3 sets of 15 Side Plank Hip Lifts Until Failure

Russian Twists

Side Planks - Normal Form

Side planks - Explosive Bounces

Side planks - Holds At Top

Finish with 3 sets of Cable Wood Choppers.

Set a cable **above head height**. Keep your elbows slightly bent but mostly straight for this exercise, don't lock out your arms.

You need to pull the cable past your thigh in a **chopping motion** and hold it there in the lower position for a few seconds to feel the squeeze.

This resistance helps your **obliques** to grow.

For an example of this workout, search: Kickboxer Side Abs Workout on the Achieve Greatness YouTube.

Note: For strictly aesthetics, this workout is **not necessary.**

### Arnold's Abs Giant Sets

Arnold was the type of person to hit multiple sets of abs for **5 minutes straight.**

Instead of thinking of doing 3 strict sets of 12 reps for abs, why not set a timer for 5 minutes and **go as hard as you possibly can?**

You can hit abs **daily**, and will definitely see results from doing so. Many bodybuilders recommend it for growth.

In the AG programme, we recommend doing **5 minute blocks of Abs** for each session, pick between working either the front or back of your core.

For your **front** core days, you can work the Rectus Abdominis muscles and for your **back** core days you can work Back Extensions.

Hitting Abs often can definitely get **boring** or even **fatiguing** if you use the same workout day in and day out, so the below workouts will provide you with some variety.

## Arnold's Abs Giant Set

Hanging Straight Leg Raises - 20 reps

Hanging Knee Ups - 20 reps

Crunches - 50 reps

Seated Leg Tucks - 30 reps

Stick Twist - 100 reps

Do not take rest in this set!

## Arnold Advanced Abs 1

Crunches 3 x 25

Bent over twists with broom 100 each side

Machine crunches - 3 x 25 reps

Crunches - 50 reps finisher

**Arnold Advanced Abs 2**

Reverse crunches 4 x 25 reps

Seated Twists 100 each side

Decline Bench Crunches 4 x 25

**Arnold Advanced Abs 3**

5 mins Roman chair sit ups

Hanging reverse crunches 4 x 25

Seated leg tucks 4 x 25

Bent over twists 100 reps each side

**Arnold Advanced Abs 4**

Decline bench crunches 4 x 25

Seated twists 100 each side Superset

Cable crunches 4 x 25

Hyperextensions lower back 3 x 10

**Arnold Advanced Abs 5**

Crunches - 30 reps

Seated Leg Tucks 30 reps

Hanging Reverse Crunches 30 reps

Seated Broom Twists 50 a side

## Modern Bodybuilding Secrets

I have taken some leading techniques from newer coaches who are producing top physiques, such as IFBB olympic champions.

These are **not** techniques from **Instagram influencers**, they are from

coaches who have **multiple years in the game, training high level people.**

Coaches such as Hany Rambod, who has coached **multiple champions across multiple divisions**.

I have taken the techniques that are suitable for **natural, aesthetic muscle gain,** and collected them together in this book.

**Shoulders FST7**

Here is a **collection** of Shoulders techniques used by the coach Hany Rambod. He has coached many **industry** physiques.

## DB Shoulder Press

When you do your Dumbell Shoulder Press, do Slow Negatives of around **5 seconds**. 3 sets of this will really work your shoulders efficiently.

## Lateral Raises

You first Lateral Raises set should consist of Pause Reps for 5 seconds.

Progress to a **heavier** weight, and do another set, this time with 3 Partial Repetitions at the bottom of the movement for every 1 normal rep.

For the third set, pick up a **heavier** weight again, and do a combination of the pause reps and partials, 3 partials at the bottom, then a 5 second **hold** at the very top of the full repetitions.

Finally, do a fourth set. Pick a heavier weight and do **cheat** reps where you use a bit of movement in your back and **brute force**, and once you can **barely** lift the weights high any longer, do some partial repetitions at the **bottom** of the movement until complete failure.

### Dumbbell Front Raises

Do a set of Dumbbell Front Raises and when you get tired, **turn** the dumbbells on the **side** so that your **thumbs** face the ceiling and keep repping.

This change of position can allow you to squeeze out a few **more** repetitions.

On your second set of Front Raises, start with the dumbbells at the top range of the movement.

Pause one arm at the top of the movement, **resisting gravity** whilst repping out 5 reps of Front Raises on the other arm.

Then **switch** arms every 5 repetitions so that one arm is doing the repetitions and the other arm is **resisting gravity** and still getting worked.

On your final set, do normal Front Dumbell Raises, but do Pause Reps where you pause for **5 seconds** at the top of the movement with both arms.

## Cable Front Raises

When you do Cable Front Raises, focus **less** on pausing at the **top** of the movement.

Focus on **squeezing** at the **bottom** of the movement where the position of the

cables really seem to be giving your shoulders some great resistance.

You can focus on Partial Repetitions in this area, and when you get to your last set, resist gravity and do half repetition partials until you cannot lift the ropes anymore.

That is how to truly take Front Raises to failure.

### Plates Front Raises

This is a **superset** you can do where you take a weight plate, do 1 rep of a front raise and 1 rep of an upright row back to back with the same plate. Do this for as many repetitions until you fatigue.

Keep your chest **up** and lean back.

## Shoulder Press Machine

When you use the Shoulder Press Machine, for your first set you can use the Drop Sets method where you pull out the **pin** and keep going for more repetitions at a lower weight without rest.

Your second set you can use **slow 5 second** negatives on each repetition.

Your third set, you can use 3 second Pause Reps at the **top** of each press.

For the fourth set, you can do partial **bounces** for 3 repetitions every full rep at the bottom of the movement.

## Smith Machine OHP

Do 3 sets of 8 repetitions on the Smith Machine. You can go quite **heavy** on this machine, it is great for building **strength** and **power**.

Do all sets with no **lockout**, this means stopping just before your arms fully extend. This keeps the **tension** on your Shoulders and works really well on this machine.

## FST7 Legs

Here are some Legs Techniques to apply to train your legs to **ultimate** failure.

## Legs Tri Set

Leg Press 12 reps

6 Walking Dumbbell Lunges each Leg
walk over to the:

Leg Extension Machine 15 reps

Go **between** these machines 3 times.

## Seated Leg Curl Machine

Do Slow Negatives for 4 Seconds.

## Leg Extension

Do **4 second** pauses at the **top** portion of the movement where your legs are fully extended for a set, then when you reach failure do 8 - 10 partials at the bottom of the repetition.

Really **resist** the weight pushing down on your legs on the partials for as long as you can.

### Hip Abductor Machine

This machine is a **classic** to build a feminine sweep on a woman's glutes. My favourite way to use this machine involves doing 3 sets with a different **technique** each time.

For your first set, you do Slow Negatives. This is where you do slow **7 second** negatives of the repetition and resist the weight as it squeezes your legs back together. Do 12 reps of this.

For the second set, when you reach the **outermost** point of the exercise where your legs are spread wide, do **quarter reps** in this position. Sometimes known as "pulses" or pulse repetitions. Do 7 pulses per repetition for a total of around 12 reps.

For the third set, we do Static Holds for **7 seconds**, at the outermost part of the exercise. Instead of pulses we are **holding** that outer position steady, again do this for a total of 12 repetitions.

**Pistol Squats**

Start doing Pistol Squats with a **chair** or **surface below** you to catch you. Once you get better at the exercise, remove the chair.

If you can work up to 3 sets of 12 for each leg, you will have reasonably **athletic** legs. For aesthetic purposes you may not need to do much **more** than just **maintain** this if you are a male.

Males usually spend more time on their torso for **aesthetics**. Pistol Squats are a very functional exercise. You can **progress** Pistol Squats by holding weights and kettlebells out as you do them.

## FST7 Back

### Pull Ups

Do **slow reps** with Isometric Holds at the end of each set.

### Chin Ups

Do 3 sets to failure, take a 5 second **pause** and then go back to more reps.

### Back Tri Set

Bent Over Rows - 8 - 10 reps

Seated Cable Rows - 15 reps, hold your last rep for 5 seconds with a straight lower back and lean back whilst holding the weight to your abdomen.

Dumbell One Arm Row - 12 - 15 reps

**Row Machine**

Pause Rep Rows on the Row Machine are super **effective**, pause for **4 seconds** at the contraction of the movement.

On your **last** repetition of your **last set**, resist the weight down all the way as it tries to drag your arms back towards the machine.

**Lateral Pulldown**

Do 2 sets with an **overhand** grip, 1 set **underhand** grip. Pull the bar down with force, but then resist the weight on the way up with slow **4 second** negatives.

**Machine Lateral Pulldown**

Sit on the seat **back to front**, with your back facing the machine. Grip the handles and do **bounce** Partial Reps on the top portion of the repetition for 3

bounces on the last few repetitions near the end of your set.

The bounces should be at the **top** where your hands are held high.

Then sit the **normal way** round on the seat and do Pause Reps for 4 seconds at the bottom of every repetition. The bottom is where you have pulled the handles down and are **squeezing** your elbows into your sides.

### Barbell Row

Do 2 sets **overhand** grip, 1 set **reverse**. Hold the Barbell Rows at the top squeezed against your **abdomen** for 1-2 seconds.

### One Arm Dumbbell Row

Do the Pause Reps technique for **4 seconds** at the **top** of this exercise. Chris

Bumstead made use of these to train for his Olympia title.

### Chest Supported Row

Do 2 sets of the **normal** grip and one set of the **commando**. Pause at the **top** for 2 seconds and squeeze. Superset these with Rope Pullovers. Chris Bumstead supersetted these training for his Olympia titles.

### Cable Row Machine

Use a **split rope attachment** on your Cable Row to pull the handles out to the **sides** of your body, bringing your elbows as far as you can behind your body.

**Pullover Machine**

Pause at the **bottom** of the repetition for 4 seconds.

**Reverse Fly Machine**

Do your Reverse Fly and **superset** with Face Pulls or Dumbbell Rear Delt Fly. Chris Bumstead supersetted these often training for his Olympia titles.

**IFBB Full Chest Workout**

This is a crazy workout I learned from an IFBB **champion** that hits **all** upper middle and lower portions of your chest in one workout!

Upper chest:
Incline DB Press 4 x 12
Incline Chest Machine - Pause at the top of each repetition for 4 seconds. 3 x 12

Smith Machine High Incline Bench 3 x 12
Low To High Cable Fly 35 rep Burnout - this hits any muscle fibres that weren't crushed with the heavier weight. Use a light weight to reach all 35.

Mid Chest
Bench Press 3 x 12
Dumbbell Bench Press 3 x 12
Mid Cable Fly - 35 rep burnout

Lower Chest
Chest Press Machine with your bum above the seat and the seat really high. You can almost Squat above the seat and not sit on it, to get a higher angle to press down on this machine.

The higher you are the more you work the Lower Chest.

Dips with a Pause at the bottom of the movement.

High To Low Cables 35 rep burnout

## Exercise Form

If you want a detailed document showing you the correct form for all exercises in the gym, please visit our website at:

achievegreatness.gumroad.com

You can download a PDF document to print out and learn from under the "Form For All Exercises" page.

We also have a video library of the form for all exercises and the Advanced Training Systems in our video courses to help you learn more by video.

## Fitness Book Summary

This book has taught you everything I learned as a PT about **fitness**, as well as the advanced exercise libraries & training programs I use with my clients.

It is an absolute **encyclopedia** of techniques. You have also learned how to **warm** up safely and how to perform every style of cardio.

Congratulations — in a **short** period of time, you have learned more than 95% of the world about fitness. You will make **gains** and completely run laps around other beginners in the gym who did not invest in learning about their training.

You should be **proud** of yourself for reading this book.

Of course, there is only so much you can **learn** from a book.

I'd like to invite you to join my **community** if you want to learn more. I create training programmes that are accessible across the **world**.

The **video** programmes and **courses** we offer go deeper — they cover secret techniques and advanced methods that I have never written down anywhere, things I only teach visually and reserve for my clients.

The video courses can really **benefit** someone who wants a PT guided fitness system that teaches them how to get an **aesthetic** body, with the **form** for all the exercises covered.

These courses are some of the **only** courses I have seen that offer complete beginner - advanced timetables and progressions, **supersets** and **advanced**

techniques, as well as **form** for **all** exercises all in one.

We also offer 1-on-1 online coaching and personalised training through the Trainerize app, where I work with you **directly** on your nutrition, your workouts, and your form.

If any of that **interests** you, just send us a DM on Instagram @achievegreatnesstraining

Reach out if you need further **help** with your fitness!

## How Does This All Tie Together To Create My Best Self?

**By now in this book series,** I have started to take you through the **3 pillars** that I teach my clients. Positive Mindset, Nutrition, and Fitness.

Once you have a good gym **programme**, healthy eating **habits**, positive morning and evening **routines** set for yourself with the correct non-negotiable mindset habits set for yourself, your **mentality** is going to become great!

This is because you took **action**, consistently and daily, instead of just **wishing** for positivity, you **implemented** many things and created a lifestyle of positivity for yourself.

You **reinforced** positivity within your mind, and your body too.

Strive to:

- Be **healthy** every day
- Consider your **goals** every day
- Manifest **positivity** every day

Surround yourself with positive people that want to go to the **gym** and do **better** for themselves.

Start this **journey** within yourselves, and I will see you in my next book. Step up, work hard and achieve a great level of fitness. Keep on pushing new skills and techniques daily.

Once you put the information in this book together consistently for a few years, you will achieve fitness mastery.

There won't be many skills you aren't capable of learning, you will be able to play nearly every sport and do amazing things with your body. People will look up to you. Ultimately you will look back, as a stronger version of you beyond your wildest dreams.

Just remember to enjoy the journey. One workout at a time.

Until next time, I leave you with two quotes:

“For me, life is continuously being hungry. The meaning of life is not simply to exist, to survive, but to move ahead, to go up, to achieve, to conquer.”

*- Arnold Schwartznegger*

“Exercise is king. Nutrition is queen. Put them together and you've got a kingdom.”

*-Jack LaLanne*

**“The only person you are destined to become is the person you decide to be.” ~ Ralph Waldo Emerson**

**“Go confidently in the direction of your dreams.” ~ Henry David Thoreau**

**“Small disciplines repeated with consistency every day lead to great achievements gained slowly over time.” ~ John C. Maxwell**

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**TRAINING SYSTEM**

ISBN 9798160763446